Practice Test A – Reading

Question 1- 10

The conservatism of the early English colonists in North America, their strong attachment to the English way of doing things, would play a major part in the furniture that was made in New England. The very tools that the first New England furniture
Line makers used were, after all, not much different from those used for centuries – even
(5) millennia: basic hammers, saws, chisels, planes, augers, compasses, and measures. These were the tools used more or less by all people who worked with wood: carpenters, barrel makers, and shipwrights. At most the furniture makers might have had planes with special edges or more delicate chisels, but there could not have been much specialization in the early years of the colonies.
(10) The furniture makers in those early decades of the 1600' s were known as "joiners," for the primary method of constructing furniture, at least among the English of this time, was that of mortise-and-tenon joinery. The mortise is the hole chiseled and cut into one piece of wood, while the tenon is the tongue or protruding element shaped from another piece of wood so that it fits into the mortise; and another small hole is
(15) then drilled (with the auger) through the mortised end and the tenon so that a whittled peg can secure the joint – thus the term "joiner." Panels were fitted into slots on the basic frames. This kind of construction was used for making everything from houses to chests.

Relatively little hardware was used during this period. Some nails – forged by
(20) hand – were used, but no screws or glue. Hinges were often made of leather, but metal hinges were also used. The cruder varieties were made by blacksmiths in the colonies, but the finer metal elements were imported. Locks and escutcheon plates – the latter to shield the wood from the metal key – would often be imported.

Above all, what the early English colonists imported was their knowledge of,
(25) familiarity with, and dedication to the traditional types and designs of furniture they knew in England.

1. The phrase "attachment to" in line 2 is closest in meaning to

   (A) control of
   (B) distance from
   (C) curiosity about
   (D) preference for

2. The word "protruding" in line 13 is closest in meaning to

   (A) parallel
   (B) simple
   (C) projecting
   (D) important

3. The relationship of a mortise and a tenon is most similar to that of

(A) a lock and a key
(B) a book and its cover
(C) a cup and a saucer
(D) a hammer and a nail

4. For what purpose did woodworkers use an auger

(A) To whittle a peg
(B) To make a tenon
(C) To drill a hole
(D) To measure a panel

5. Which of the following were NOT used in the construction of colonial furniture?

(A) Mortises
(B) Nails
(C) Hinges
(D) Screws

6. The author implies that colonial metalworkers were

(A) unable to make elaborate parts
(B) more skilled than woodworkers
(C) more conservative than other colonists
(D) frequently employed by joiners

7. The word "shield" in line 23 is closest in meaning to

(A) decorate
(B) copy
(C) shape
(D) protect

8. The word "they" in line 25 refers to

(A) designs
(B) types
(C) colonists
(D) all

9. The author implies that the colonial joiners

(A) were highly paid
(B) based their furniture on English models
(C) used many specialized tools
(D) had to adjust to using new kinds of wood in New England

10. Which of the following terms does the author explain in the passage?

(A) "millennia" (line 5)
(B) "joiners" (line 10)
(C) "whittled" (line 15)
(D) "blacksmiths" (line 21)

Question 11 – 20

In addition to their military role, the forts of the nineteenth century provided numerous other benefits for the American West. The establishment of these posts opened new roads and provided for the protection of daring adventurers and expeditions as well as established settlers. Forts also served as bases where enterprising entrepreneurs could bring commerce to the West, providing supplies and refreshments to soldiers as well as to pioneers. Posts like Fort Laramie provided supplies for wagon trains traveling the natural highways toward new frontiers. Some posts became stations for the pony express; still others, such as Fort Davis, were stagecoach stops for weary travelers. All of these functions, of course, suggest that the contributions of the forts to the civilization and development of the West extended beyond patrol duty.

Through the establishment of military posts, yet other contributions were made to the development of western culture. Many posts maintained libraries or reading rooms, and some – for example, Fort Davis – had schools. Post chapels provided a setting for religious services and weddings. Throughout the wilderness, post bands provided entertainment and boosted morale. During the last part of the nineteenth century, to reduce expenses, gardening was encouraged at the forts, thus making experimental agriculture another activity of the military. The military stationed at the various forts also played a role in civilian life by assisting in maintaining order, and civilian officials often called on the army for protection.

Certainly, among other significant contributions the army made to the improvement of the conditions of life was the investigation of the relationships among health, climate, and architecture. From the earliest colonial times throughout the nineteenth century, disease ranked as the foremost problem in defense. It slowed construction of forts and inhibited their military functions. Official documents from many regions contained innumerable reports of sickness that virtually incapacitated entire garrisons. In response to the problems, detailed observations of architecture and climate and their relationships to the frequency of the occurrence of various diseases were recorded at various posts across the nation by military surgeons.

11. Which of the following statements best expresses the main idea of the passage?

(A) By the nineteenth century, forts were no longer used by the military.
(B) Surgeons at forts could not prevent outbreaks of disease.
(C) Forts were important to the development of the American West
(D) Life in nineteenth-century forts was very rough.

12. The word "daring" in line 3 is closest in meaning to

(A) lost
(B) bold
(C) lively
(D) foolish

13. Which of the following would a traveler be likely be LEAST likely to obtain at Fort Laramie?

(A) Fresh water
(B) Food
(C) Formal clothing
(D) Lodging

14. The word “ others” in line 8 refers to

(A) posts
(B) wagon trains
(C) frontiers
(D) highways

15. The word “ boosted” in line 15 is closest in meaning to

(A) influenced
(B) established
(C) raised
(D) maintained

16. Which of the following is the most likely inference about the decision to promote gardening at forts?

(A) It was expensive to import produce from far away.
(B) Food brought in from outside was often spoiled
(C) Gardening was a way to occupy otherwise idle soldiers.
(D) The soil near the forts was very fertile.

17. According to the passage, which of the following posed the biggest obstacle to the development of military forts?

(A) Insufficient shelter
(B) Shortage of materials
(C) Attacks by wild animals
(D) Illness

18. The word “ inhibited” in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) involved
(B) exploited
(C) united
(D) hindered

19. How did the military assists in the investigation of health problems?

(A) By registering annual birth and death rates
(B) By experiments with different building materials
(C) By maintaining records of diseases and potential causes
(D) By monitoring the soldiers’ diets

20. The author organizes the discussion of forts by

(A) describing their locations
(B) comparing their sizes
(C) explaining their damage to the environment
(D) listing their contributions to western life

Question 21 – 30

Anyone who has handled a fossilized bone knows that it is usually not exactly like its modern counterpart, the most obvious difference being that it is often much heavier. Fossils often have the quality of stone rather than of organic materials, and this has led to the use of the term "petrifaction" (to bring about rock). The implication is that bone, and other tissues, have somehow been turned into stone, and this is certainly the explanation given in some texts. But it is wrong interpretation; fossils are frequently so dense because the pores and other spaces in the bone have become filled with minerals taken up from the surrounding sediments. Some fossil bones have all the interstitial spaces filled with foreign minerals, including the marrow cavity, if there is one, while others have taken up but little from their surroundings. Probably all of the minerals deposited within the bone have been recrystallized from solution by the action of water percolating thru them. The degree of mineralization appears to be determined by the nature of the environment in which the bone was deposited and not by the antiquity of the bone. For example, the black fossil bones that are so common in many parts of Florida are heavily mineralized, but they are only about 20,000 years old, whereas many of the dinosaur bones from western Canada, which are about 75 million years old, are only partially filled in. Under optimum conditions the process of mineralization probably takes thousands rather than millions of years, perhaps considerably less.

The amount of change that has occurred in fossil bone, even in bone as old as that of dinosaurs, is often remarkably small. We are therefore usually able to see the microscopic structures of the bone, including such fine details as the lacunae where the living bone cells once resided. The natural bone mineral, the hydroxyapatite, is virtually unaltered too – it has the same crystal structure as that of modern bone. Although nothing remains of the original collagen, some of its component amino acids are usually still detectable, together with amino acids of the noncollagen proteins of bone.

21. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The location of fossils in North America
(B) The composition of fossils
(C) Determining the size and weight of fossils
(D) Procedures for analyzing fossils

22. The word "counterpart" in line 2 is closest in meaning to

(A) species
(B) version
(C) change
(D) material

23. Why is fossilized bone heavier than ordinary bone?

(A) Bone tissue solidifies with age.
(B) The marrow cavity gradually fills with water
(C) The organic materials turn to stone
(D) Spaces within the bone fill with minerals.

24. The word “pores” in line 7 is closest in meaning to:

(A) joints
(B) tissues
(C) lines
(D) holes

25. What can be inferred about a fossil with a high degree of mineralization?

(A) It was exposed to large amounts of mineral-laden water throughout time.
(B) Mineralization was complete within one year of the animal’s death.
(C) Many colorful crystals can be found in such a fossil.
(D) It was discovered in western Canada.

26. Which of the following factors is most important in determining the extent of mineralization in fossil bones?

(A) The age of fossil
(B) Environmental conditions
(C) The location of the bone in the animal’s body.
(D) The type of animal the bone came from

27. Why does the author compare fossils found in western Canada to those found in Florida?

(A) To prove that a fossil’s age cannot be determined by the amount of mineralization.
(B) To discuss the large quantity of fossils found in both places
(C) To suggest that fossils found in both places were the same age.
(D) To explain why scientists are especially interested in Canadian fossils

28. The word “it” in line 24 refers to

(A) hydroxyapatite
(B) microscopic structure
(C) crystal structure
(D) modern bone

29. The word “detectable” in line 26 is closest in meaning to

(A) sizable
(B) active
(C) moist
(D) apparent

30. Which of the following does NOT survive in fossils?

(A) Noncollagen proteins
(B) Hydroxyapatite
(C) Collagen
(D) Amino acid

Question 31 – 40

In the last third of the nineteenth century a new housing form was quietly being developed. In 1869 the Stuyvesant, considered New York's first apartment house was built on East Eighteenth Street. The building was financed by the developer Rutherfurd Stuyvesant and designed by Richard Morris Hunt, the first American architect to graduate from the Ecole des Beaux Arts in Paris. Each man had lived in Paris, and each understood the economics and social potential of this Parisian housing form. But the Stuyvesant was at best a limited success. In spite of Hunt's inviting façade, the living space was awkwardly arranged. Those who could afford them were quite content to remain in the more sumptuous, single-family homes, leaving the Stuyvesant to young married couples and bachelors.

The fundamental problem with the Stuyvesant and the other early apartment buildings that quickly followed, in the 1870's and early 1880's was that they were confined to the typical New York building lot. That lot was a rectangular area 25 feet wide by 100 feet deep – a shape perfectly suited for a row house. The lot could also accommodate a rectangular tenement, though it could not yield the square, well-lighted, and logically arranged rooms that great apartment buildings require. But even with the awkward interior configurations of the early apartment buildings, the idea caught on. It met the needs of a large and growing population that wanted something better than tenements but could not afford or did not want row houses.

So while the city's newly emerging social leadership commissioned their mansions, apartment houses and hotels began to sprout in multiple lots, thus breaking the initial space constraints. In the closing decades of the nineteenth century, large apartment houses began dotting the developed portions of New York City, and by the opening decades of the twentieth century, spacious buildings, such as the Dakota and the Ansonia finally transcended the tight confinement of row house building lots. From there it was only a small step to building luxury apartment houses on the newly created Park Avenue, right next to the fashionable Fifth Avenue shopping area.

31. The new housing form discussed in the passage refers to

(A) single-family homes
(B) apartment buildings
(C) row houses
(D) hotels

32. The word "inviting" in line 7 is closest in meaning to

(A) open
(B) encouraging
(C) attractive
(D) asking

33. Why was the Stuyvesant a limited success?

(A) The arrangement of the rooms was not convenient.
(B) Most people could not afford to live there.
(C) There were no shopping areas nearby.
(D) It was in a crowded neighborhood.

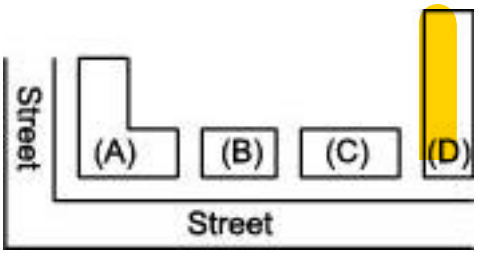
34. The word “sumptuous” in line 9 is closest in meaning to

(A) luxurious
(B) unique
(C) modern
(D) distant

35. It can be inferred that the majority of people who lived in New York’s first apartments were

(A) highly educated
(B) unemployed
(C) wealthy
(D) young

36. It can be inferred that the typical New York building lot of the 1870’s and 1880’s looked MOST like which of the following?



37. It can be inferred that a New York apartment building in the 1870’s and 1880’s had all of the following characteristics EXCEPT:

(A) Its room arrangement was not logical.
(B) It was rectangular.
(C) It was spacious inside.
(D) It had limited light.

38. The word “yield” in line 15 is closest in meaning to

(A) harvest
(B) surrender
(C) amount
(D) provide

39. Why did the idea of living in an apartment become popular in the late 1800’s?

(A) Large families needed housing with sufficient space.
(B) Apartments were preferable to tenements and cheaper than row houses
(C) The city officials of New York wanted housing that was centrally located.
(D) The shape of early apartments could accommodate a variety of interior designs.

40. The author mentions the Dakota and the Ansonia in line 24 because

(A) they are examples of large, well-designed apartment buildings
(B) their design is similar to that of row houses
(C) they were built on a single building lot
(D) they are famous hotels

Question 41 – 50

A snowfall consists of myriads of minute ice crystals that fall to the ground in the form of frozen precipitation. The formation of snow begins with these ice crystals in the subfreezing strata of the middle and upper atmosphere when there is an adequate supply of moisture present. At the core of every ice crystal is a minuscule nucleus, a solid particle of matter around which moisture condenses and freezes. Liquid water droplets floating in the supercooled atmosphere and free ice crystals cannot coexist within the same cloud, since the vapor pressure of ice is less than that of water. This enables the ice crystals to rob the liquid droplets of their moisture and grow continuously. The process can be very rapid, quickly creating sizable ice crystals, some of which adhere to each other to create a cluster of ice crystals or a snowflake. Simple flakes possess a variety of beautiful forms, usually hexagonal, though the symmetrical shapes reproduced in most microscope photography of snowflakes are not usually found in actual snowfalls. Typically, snowflakes in actual snowfall consists of broken fragments and clusters of adhering ice crystals.

Line
(5)
(10)
(15)
(20)

For a snowfall to continue once it starts, there must be a constant inflow of moisture to supply the nuclei. This moisture is supplied by the passage of an airstream over a water surface and its subsequent lifting to higher regions of the atmosphere. The Pacific Ocean is the source of moisture for most snowfalls west of the Rocky Mountains, while the Gulf of Mexico and the Atlantic Ocean feed water vapor into the air currents over the central and eastern sections of the United States. Other geographical features also can be the source of moisture for some snowstorms. For example, areas adjacent to the Great Lakes experience their own unique lake-effect storms, employing a variation of the process on a local scale. In addition, mountainous section or rising terrain can initiate snowfalls by the geographical lifting of a moist airstream.

41. Which of the following questions does the author answer in the first paragraph?

(A) Why are snowflakes hexagonal?
(B) What is the optimum temperature for snow?
(C) In which months does most snow fall?
(D) How are snowflakes formed?

42. The word “minute” in line 1 is closest in meaning to

(A) tiny
(B) quick
(C) clear
(D) sharp

43. What is at the center of an ice crystal?

(A) A small snowflake
(B) A nucleus
(C) A drop of water
(D) A hexagon

44. The word "adhere" in line 10 is closest in meaning to

(A) belong
(B) relate
(C) stick
(D) speed

45. What is the main topic of the second paragraph?

(A) How ice crystals form
(B) How moisture affects temperature
(C) What happens when ice crystals melt
(D) Where the moisture to supply the nuclei comes from

46. The word "it" in line 15 refers to

(A) snowfall
(B) snowflake
(C) cluster
(D) moisture

47. What is necessary for a snowfall to persist?

(A) A decrease in the number of snowflakes
(B) Lowered vapor pressure in ice crystals
(C) A continuous infusion of moisture
(D) A change in the direction of the airstream

48. How do lake-effect snowstorms form?

(A) Water temperature drop below freezing.
(B) Moisture rises from a lake into the airstream.
(C) Large quantities of wet air come off a nearby mountain.
(D) Millions of ice crystals form on the surface of a large lake.

49. The word "initiate" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) enhance
(B) alter
(C) increase
(D) begin

50. Which of the following could account for the lack of snowfall in a geographical location close to mountains and a major water source?

(A) Ground temperatures below the freezing point
(B) Too much moisture in the air
(C) Too much wind off the mountains
(D) Atmospheric temperatures above the freezing point.

Practice Test A – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	D	Medium	65%
2	C	Difficult	47%
3	A	Medium	74%
4	C	Medium	78%
5	D	Easy	86%
6	A	Difficult	40%
7	D	Medium	67%
8	C	Easy	88%
9	B	Medium	75%
10	B	Medium	63%
11	C	Easy	84%
12	B	Difficult	43%
13	C	Difficult	43%
14	A	Easy	82%
15	C	Difficult	45%
16	A	Medium	55%
17	D	Medium	80%
18	D	Difficult	48%
19	C	Easy	86%
20	D	Medium	75%
21	B	Medium	62%
22	B	Difficult	46%
23	D	Medium	58%
24	D	Medium	75%
25	A	Medium	71%
26	B	Medium	76%
26	A	Easy	83%
28	A	Easy	87%
29	D	Medium	57%
30	C	Medium	70%
31	B	Medium	80%
32	C	Difficult	45%
33	A	Medium	60%
34	A	Difficult	49%
35	D	Medium	58%
36	D	Medium	67%
37	C	Difficult	46%
38	D	Medium	65%
39	B	Medium	61%
40	A	Medium	68%
41	D	Medium	82%
42	A	Medium	74%

43	B	Medium	78%
44	C	Medium	69%
45	D	Medium	63%
46	A	Medium	80%
47	C	Medium	71%
48	B	Medium	71%
49	D	Medium	57%
50	D	Difficult	35%

Practice Test B – Reading

Question 1- 10

With Robert Laurent and William Zorach, direct carving enters into the story of modem sculpture in the United States. Direct carving – in which the sculptors themselves carve stone or wood with mallet and chisel – must be recognized as
Line something more than just a technique. Implicit in it is an aesthetic principle as well:
(5) that the medium has certain qualities of beauty and expressiveness with which sculptors must bring their own aesthetic sensibilities into harmony. For example, sometimes the shape or veining in a piece of stone or wood suggests, perhaps even dictates, not only the ultimate form, but even the subject matter.

The technique of direct carving was a break with the nineteenth-century tradition in
(10) which the making of a clay model was considered the creative act and the work was then turned over to studio assistants to be cast in plaster or bronze or carved in marble. Neoclassical sculptors seldom held a mallet or chisel in their own hands, readily conceding that the assistants they employed were far better than they were at carving the finished marble.

(15) With the turn-of-the-century Crafts movement and the discovery of nontraditional sources of inspiration, such as wooden African figures and masks, there arose a new urge for hands-on, personal execution of art and an interaction with the medium. Even as early as the 1880's and 1890's, nonconformist European artists were attempting direct carving. By the second decade of the twentieth century, Americans – Laurent
(20) and Zorach most notably - had adopted it as their primary means of working.

Born in France, Robert Laurent (1890-197Q) was a prodigy who received his education in the United States. In 1905 he was sent to Paris as an apprentice to an art dealer, and in the years that followed he witnessed the birth of Cubism, discovered primitive art, and learned the techniques of woodcarving from a frame maker.

(25) Back in New York City by 1910, Laurent began carving pieces such as *The Priestess*, which reveals his fascination with African, pre-Columbian, and South Pacific art. Taking a walnut plank, the sculptor carved the expressive, stylized design. It is one of the earliest examples of direct carving in American sculpture. The plank's form dictated the rigidly frontal view and the low relief. Even its irregular shape must
(30) have appealed to Laurent as a break with a long-standing tradition that required a sculptor to work within a perfect rectangle or square.

1. The word "medium" in line 5 could be used to refer to

   (A) stone or wood
   (B) mallet and chisel
   (C) technique
   (D) principle

2. What is one of the fundamental principles of direct carving?

   (A) A sculptor must work with talented assistants.
   (B) The subject of a sculpture should be derived from classical stories.
   (C) The material is an important element in a sculpture.
   (D) Designing a sculpture is a more creative activity than carving it.

3. The word "dictates" in line 8 is closest in meaning to

   (A) reads aloud
   (B) determines
   (C) includes
   (D) records

4. How does direct carving differ from the nineteenth-century tradition of sculpture?

   (A) Sculptors are personally involved in the carving of a piece.
   (B) Sculptors find their inspiration in neoclassical sources.
   (C) Sculptors have replaced the mallet and chisel with other tools.
   (D) Sculptors receive more formal training.

5. The word "witnessed" in line 23 is closest in meaning to

   (A) influenced
   (B) studied
   (C) validated
   (D) observed

6. Where did Robert Laurent learn to carve?

   (A) New York
   (B) Africa
   (C) The South Pacific
   (D) Paris

7. The phrase "a break with" in line 30 is closest in meaning to

   (A) a destruction of
   (B) a departure from
   (C) a collapse of
   (D) a solution to

8. The piece titled The Priestess has all of the following characteristics EXCEPT:

   (A) The design is stylized.
   (B) It is made of marble.
   (C) The carving is not deep.
   (D) It depicts the front of a person.

Question 9 – 19

Birds that feed in flocks commonly retire together into roosts. The reasons for roosting communally are not always obvious, but there are some likely benefits. In winter especially, it is important for birds to keep warm at night and conserve precious food reserves. One way to do this is to find a sheltered roost. Solitary roosters shelter in dense vegetation or enter a cavity – horned larks dig holes in the ground and ptarmigan burrow into snow banks – but the effect of sheltering is magnified by several birds huddling together in the roosts, as wrens, swifts, brown creepers, bluebirds, and anis do. Body contact reduces the surface area exposed to the cold air, so the birds keep each other warm. Two kinglets huddling together were found to reduce their heat losses by a quarter, and three together saved a third of their heat.

The second possible benefit of communal roosts is that they act as "information centers." During the day, parties of birds will have spread out to forage over a very large area. When they return in the evening some will have fed well, but others may have found little to eat. Some investigators have observed that when the birds set out again next morning, those birds that did not feed well on the previous day appear to follow those that did. The behavior of common and lesser kestrels may illustrate different feeding behaviors of similar birds with different roosting habits. The common kestrel hunts vertebrate animals in a small, familiar hunting ground, whereas the very similar lesser kestrel feeds on insects over a large area. The common kestrel roosts and hunts alone, but the lesser kestrel roosts and hunts in flocks, possibly so one bird can learn from others where to find insect swarms.

Finally, there is safety in numbers at communal roosts since there will always be a few birds awake at any given moment to give the alarm. But this increased protection is partially counteracted by the fact that mass roosts attract predators and are especially vulnerable if they are on the ground. Even those in trees can be attacked by birds of prey. The birds on the edge are at greatest risk since predators find it easier to catch small birds perching at the margins of the roost.

9. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) How birds find and store food
(B) How birds maintain body heat in the winter
(C) Why birds need to establish territory
(D) Why some species of birds nest together

10. The word "conserve" in line 3 is closest in meaning to

(A) retain
(B) watch
(C) locate
(D) share

11. Ptarmigan keep warm in the winter by

(A) huddling together on the ground with other birds
(B) building nests in trees
(C) burrowing into dense patches of vegetation
(D) digging tunnels into the snow

12. The word "magnified" in line 6 is closest in meaning to

(A) caused
(B) modified
(C) intensified
(D) combined

13. The author mentions kinglets in line 9 as an example of birds that

(A) protect themselves by nesting in holes
(B) nest with other species of birds
(C) nest together for warmth
(D) usually feed and nest in pairs

14. The word "forage" in line 12 is closest in meaning to

(A) fly
(B) assemble
(C) feed
(D) rest

15. Which of the following statements about lesser and common kestrels is true?

(A) The lesser kestrel and the common kestrel have similar diets.
(B) The lesser kestrel feeds sociably but the common kestrel does not.
(C) The common kestrel nests in larger flocks than does the lesser kestrel.
(D) The common kestrel nests in trees; the lesser kestrel nests on the ground.

16. The word "counteracted" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) suggested
(B) negated
(C) measured
(D) shielded

17. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as an advantage derived by birds that huddle together while sleeping?

(A) Some members of the flock warn others of impending dangers.
(B) Staying together provides a greater amount of heat for the whole flock.
(C) Some birds in the flock function as information centers for others who are looking for food.
(D) Several members of the flock care for the young.

18. Which of the following is a disadvantage of communal roosts that is mentioned in the passage?

(A) Diseases easily spread among the birds.
(B) Groups are more attractive to predators than individual birds are.
(C) Food supplies are quickly depleted.
(D) Some birds in the group will attack the others.

19. The word "they" in line 25 refers to

(A) a few birds
(B) mass roosts
(C) predators
(D) trees

Question 20 – 30

Before the mid-nineteenth century, people in the United States ate most foods only in season. Drying, smoking, and salting could preserve meat for a short time, but the availability of fresh meat, like that of fresh milk, was very limited; there was no way to prevent spoilage. But in 1810 a French inventor named Nicolas Appert developed the cooking-and-sealing process of canning. And in the 1850's an American named Gail Borden developed a means of condensing and preserving milk. Canned goods and condensed milk became more common during the 1860's, but supplies remained low because cans had to be made by hand. By 1880, however, inventors had fashioned stamping and soldering machines that mass-produced cans from tinplate. Suddenly all kinds of food could be preserved and bought at all times of the year.

Other trends and inventions had also helped make it possible for Americans to vary their daily diets. Growing urban populations created demand that encouraged fruit and vegetable farmers to raise more produce. Railroad refrigerator cars enabled growers and meat packers to ship perishables great distances and to preserve them for longer periods. Thus, by the 1890's, northern city dwellers could enjoy southern and western strawberries, grapes, and tomatoes, previously available for a month at most, for up to six months of the year. In addition, increased use of iceboxes enabled families to store perishables. An easy means of producing ice commercially had been invented in the 1870's, and by 1900 the nation had more than two thousand commercial ice plants, most of which made home deliveries. The icebox became a fixture in most homes and remained so until the mechanized refrigerator replaced it in the 1920's and 1930's.

Almost everyone now had a more diversified diet. Some people continued to eat mainly foods that were heavy in starches or carbohydrates, and not everyone could afford meat. Nevertheless, many families could take advantage of previously unavailable fruits, vegetables, and dairy products to achieve more varied fare.

20. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) Causes of food spoilage
(B) Commercial production of ice
(C) Inventions that led to changes in the American diet
(D) Population movements in the nineteenth century

21. The phrase "in season" in line 2 refers to

(A) a kind of weather
(B) a particular time of year
(C) an official schedule
(D) a method of flavoring food

22. The word "prevent" in line 4 is closest in meaning to

(A) estimate
(B) avoid
(C) correct
(D) confine

23. During the 1860's, canned food products were

(A) unavailable in rural areas
(B) shipped in refrigerator cars
(C) available in limited quantities
(D) a staple part of the American diet

24. It can be inferred that railroad refrigerator cars came into use

(A) before 1860
(B) before 1890
(C) after 1900
(D) after 1920

25. The word "them" in line 14 refers to

(A) refrigerator cars
(B) perishables
(C) growers
(D) distances

26. The word "fixture" in line 20 is closest in meaning to

(A) luxury item
(B) substance
(C) commonplace object
(D) mechanical device

27. The author implies that in the 1920's and 1930's home deliveries of ice

(A) decreased in number
(B) were on an irregular schedule
(C) increased in cost
(D) occurred only in the summer

28. The word "nevertheless" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) therefore
(B) because
(C) occasionally
(D) however

29. Which of the following types of food preservation was NOT mentioned in the passage?

(A) Drying
(B) Canning
(C) Cold storage
(D) Chemical additives

30. Which of the following statements is supported by the passage?

(A) Tin cans and iceboxes helped to make many foods more widely available.
(B) Commercial ice factories were developed by railroad owners.
(C) Most farmers in the United States raised only fruits and vegetables.
(D) People who lived in cities demanded home delivery of foods.

Question 31 – 40

The ability of falling cats to right themselves in midair and land on their feet has been a source of wonder for ages. Biologists long regarded it as an example of adaptation by natural selection, but for physicists it bordered on the miraculous. Newton's laws of motion assume that the total amount of spin of a body cannot change unless an external torque speeds it up or slows it down. If a cat has no spin when it is released and experiences no external torque, it ought not to be able lo twist around as it falls.

In the speed of its execution, the righting of a tumbling cat resembles a magician's trick. The gyrations of the cat in midair are too fast for the human eye to follow, so the process is obscured. Either the eye must be speeded up, or the cat's fall slowed down for the phenomenon to be observed. A century ago the former was accomplished by means of high-speed photography using equipment now available in any pharmacy. But in the nineteenth century the capture on film of a falling cat constituted a scientific experiment.

The experiment was described in a paper presented to the Paris Academy in 1894.Two sequences of twenty photographs each, one from the side and one from behind, show a white cat in the act of righting itself. Grainy and quaint though they are, the photos show that the cat was dropped upside down, with no initial spin and still landed on its feet. Careful analysis of the photos reveals the secret: As the cat rotates the front of its body clockwise, the rear and tail twist counterclockwise, so that the total spin remains zero, in perfect accord with Newton's laws. Halfway down, the cat pulls in its legs before reversing its twist and then extends them again, with the desired end result. The explanation was that while no body can acquire spin without torque, a flexible one can readily change its orientation, or phase. Cats know this instinctively, but scientists could not be sure how it happened until they increased the speed of their perceptions a thousandfold.

31. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The explanation of an interesting phenomenon
(B) Miracles in modern science
(C) Procedures in scientific investigation
(D) The differences between biology and physics

32. The word "process" in line 10 refers to

(A) the righting of a tumbling cat
(B) the cat's fall slowed down
(C) high-speed photography
(D) a scientific experiment

33. Why are the photographs mentioned in line 16 referred to as an "experiment"?

(A) The photographs were not very clear.
(B) The purpose of the photographs was to explain the process.
(C) The photographer used inferior equipment.
(D) The photographer thought the cat might be injured.

34. Which of the following can be inferred about high-speed photography in the late 1800's?

(A) It was a relatively new technology.
(B) The necessary equipment was easy to obtain.
(C) The resulting photographs are difficult to interpret.
(D) It was not fast enough to provide new information.

35. The word "rotates" in line 19 is closest in meaning to

(A) drops
(B) turns
(C) controls
(D) touches

36. According to the passage, a cat is able to right itself in midair because it is

(A) frightened
(B) small
(C) intelligent
(D) flexible

37. The word "readily" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) only
(B) easily
(C) slowly
(D) certainly

38. How did scientists increase "the speed of their perceptions a thousandfold" (lines 25-26)?

(A) By analyzing photographs
(B) By observing a white cat in a dark room
(C) By dropping a cat from a greater height
(D) By studying Newton's laws of motion

Question 39 – 50

The changing profile of a city in the United States is apparent in the shifting definitions used by the United States Bureau of the Census. In 1870 the census officially distinguished the nation's "urban" from its "rural" population for the first time. "Urban population" was defined as persons living in towns of 8,000 inhabitants or more. But after 1900 it meant persons living in incorporated places having 2,500 or more inhabitants.

Then, in 1950 the Census Bureau radically changed its definition of urban to take account of the new vagueness of city boundaries. In addition to persons living in incorporated units of 2,500 or more, the census now included those who lived in unincorporated units of that size, and also all persons living in the densely settled urban fringe, including both incorporated and unincorporated areas located around cities of 50,000 inhabitants or more. Each such unit, conceived as an integrated economic and social unit with a large population nucleus, was named a Standard Metropolitan Statistical Area (SMSA).

Each SMSA would contain at least (a) one central city with 50,000 inhabitants or more or (b) two cities having shared boundaries and constituting, for general economic and social purposes, a single community with a combined population of at least 50,000, the smaller of which must have a population of at least 15,000. Such an area would include the county in which the central city was located, and adjacent counties that were found to be metropolitan in character and economically and socially integrated with the county of the central city. By 1970, about two-thirds of the population of the United States was living in these urbanized areas, and of that figure more than half were living outside the central cities.

While the Census Bureau and the United States government used the term SMSA (by 1969 there were 233 of them), social scientists were also using new terms to describe the elusive, vaguely defined areas reaching out from what used to be simple "towns" and "cities." A host of terms came into use: "metropolitan regions," "polynucleated population groups," "conurbations," "metropolitan clusters," "megalopolises" and so on.

39. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) How cities in the United States began and developed
(B) Solutions to overcrowding in cities
(C) The changing definition of an urban area
(D) How the United States Census Bureau conducts a census

40. According to the passage, the population of the United States was first classified as rural or urban in

(A) 1870
(B) 1900
(C) 1950
(D) 1970

41. The word "distinguished" in line 3 is closest in meaning to

(A) differentiated
(B) removed
(C) honored
(D) protected

42. Prior to 1900, how many inhabitants would a town have to have before being defined as urban?

(A) 2,500
(B) 8,000
(C) 15.000
(D) 50.000

43. According to the passage, why did the Census Bureau revise the definition of urban in 1950?

(A) City borders had become less distinct.
(B) Cities had undergone radical social change.
(C) Elected officials could not agree on an acceptable definition
(D) New businesses had relocated to larger cities.

44. The word "those" in line 9 refers to

(A) boundaries
(B) persons
(C) units
(D) areas

45. The word "constituting" in line 16 is closest in meaning to

(A) located near
(B) determined by
(C) calling for
(D) making up

46. The word "which" in line 18 refers to a smaller

(A) population
(B) city
(C) character
(D) figure

47. Which of the following is NOT true of an SMSA?

(A) It has a population of at least 50.000.
(B) It can include a city's outlying regions.
(C) It can include unincorporated regions.
(D) It consists of at least two cities.

48. By 1970, what proportion of the population in the United States did NOT live in an SMSA?

(A) 3/4
(B) 2/3
(C) 1/2
(D) 1/3

49. The Census Bureau first used the term "SMSA" in

(A) 1900
(B) 1950
(C) 1969
(D) 1970

50. Where in the passage does the author mention names used by social scientists for an urban area?

(A) Lines 4-5
(B) Lines 7-8
(C) Lines 21-23
(D) Lines 27-29

Practice Test B – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	A	Medium	49%
2	C	Difficult	46%
3	B	Medium	59%
4	A	Difficult	41%
5	D	Medium	65%
6	D	Medium	71%
7	B	Difficult	39%
8	B	Medium	54%
9	D	Medium	60%
10	A	Medium	64%
11	D	Medium	57%
12	C	Difficult	47%
13	C	Easy	91%
14	C	Difficult	35%
15	B	Medium	65%
16	B	Difficult	43%
17	D	Medium	67%
18	B	Medium	68%
19	B	Medium	68%
20	C	Easy	82%
21	B	Easy	83%
22	B	Easy	84%
23	C	Easy	86%
24	B	Easy	88%
25	B	Medium	54%
26	C	Medium	68%
26	A	Medium	76%
28	D	Medium	71%
29	D	Easy	85%
30	A	Easy	82%
31	A	Medium	62%
32	A	Medium	62%
33	B	Easy	83%
34	A	Difficult	47%
35	B	Easy	84%
36	D	Easy	86%
37	B	Medium	68%
38	A	Medium	58%
39	C	Medium	65%
40	A	Easy	90%
41	A	Easy	79%
42	B	Medium	64%

43	A	Medium	52%
44	B	Easy	84%
45	D	Difficult	43%
46	B	Medium	68%
47	D	Difficult	40%
48	D	Medium	54%
49	B	Medium	61%
50	D	Medium	67%

Practice Test C – Reading

Question 1- 9

Around the year 1500, hunting people occupied the entire northern third of North America. They lived well from the animals with whom they shared these lands. Hunters of sea mammals had colonized the Arctic coasts of Canada and Greenland between four and five thousand years before. Land-hunting people had lived throughout much of the northern interior for at least 12,000 years.

Northern North America is part of a larger circumpolar ecological domain that continues across the narrow Bering Strait into Siberia and northern Europe. The overall circumpolar environment in the 1500' s was not very different from the environment of the present. This vast landmass had a continental climate and was dominated by cold arctic air throughout a long winter and spring season. Summer temperatures ranged from near freezing to the mid-20's Celsius, while winter temperatures were often as low as 40 degrees below zero Celsius.

Geographers divide the overall circumpolar domain into two zones, the Arctic and below it, the Subarctic. They refer to the landforms of these areas as tundra and taiga, respectively.

Temperatures in the northern lands were below freezing for eight or nine months of the year. Subsurface soil in the Arctic's tundra remained permanently frozen. Even when summer temperatures were above freezing and the top inches of earth became saturated with water, the soil below remained frozen into a permafrost, as hard as rock. When water flowed upon the surface of permanently frozen tundra, it made overland travel extremely difficult. Summer travel in the boggy lands, or muskeg country, of the Subarctic's taiga was also slow and arduous. Tracking animals was more difficult than it was during the winter when the swampy ground was frozen solid and covered with snow. In both tundra and taiga, hordes of mosquitoes and biting flies bred in the standing pools of water. Clothing lost its thermal efficiency when it became damp. Northern people looked forward to the turn of the season to bring the easier traveling conditions associated with cold weather. In the Arctic, they could haul food and supplies by dogsled while in the Subarctic, people could travel quickly and efficiently by snowshoes and toboggan.

1. The word "domain" in line 6 is closest in meaning to

   (A) temperature
   (B) period
   (C) region
   (D) process

2. Which of the following terms is used to describe the landforms of the Arctic region?

   (A) Subarctic
   (B) Taiga
   (C) Tundra
   (D) Muskeg

3. For how many months of the year were temperatures below freezing in the circumpolar region?

   (A) 4-5 months
   (B) 6 months
   (C) 8-9 months
   (D) 12 months

4. The word "saturated" in line 19 is closest in meaning to

   (A) enriched
   (B) dissolved
   (C) removed
   (D) soaked

5. The word "arduous" in line 22 is closest in meaning to

   (A) humid
   (B) difficult
   (C) indirect
   (D) unnecessary

6. The word "standing" in line 25 is closest in meaning to

   (A) not flowing
   (B) very deep
   (C) numerous
   (D) contaminated

7. All of the following are mentioned as having made travel in the summer difficult EXCEPT

   (A) insects
   (B) wet clothing
   (C) swampy lands
   (D) lack of supplies

8. The subsurface soil in the Arctic's tundra is most comparable to which of the following?

   (A) Cement
   (B) A bog
   (C) A pond
   (D) Sand

9. Where in the passage does the author mention a means by which people traveled in the northern lands?

   (A) Lines 2-4
   (B) Lines 6-7
   (C) Lines 20-21
   (D) Lines 27-29

Questions 10-19

Social parasitism involves one species relying on another to raise its young. Among vertebrates, the best known social parasites are such birds as cuckoos and cowbirds; the female lays an egg in a nest belonging to another species and leaves it for the host to rear.

The dulotic species of ants, however, are the supreme social parasites. Consider, for example, the unusual behavior of ants belonging to the genus Polyergus. All species of this ant have lost the ability to care for themselves. The workers do not forage for food. feed their brood or queen, or even dean their own nest. To compensate for these deficits, Polyergus has become specialized at obtaining workers from the related genus Formica to do these chores.

In a raid, several thousand Polyergus workers will travel up to 500 feet in search of a Formica nest, penetrate it, drive off the queen and tier workers, capture the pupal brood, and transport it back to their nest. The captured brood is then reared by the resident Formica workers until the developing pupae emerge to add to the Formica population, which maintains the mixed-species nest The Formica workers forage for food and give it to colony members of both species. They also remove wastes and excavate new chambers as the population increases.

The true extent of the Polyergus ants' dependence on the Formica becomes apparent when the worker population grows too large for the existing nest. Formica scouts locate a new nesting site, return to the mixed-species colony, and recruit additional Formica nest mates. During a period that may last seven days, the Formica workers carry to the new nest all the Polyergus eggs, larvae, and pupae, every Polyergus adult, and even the Polyergus queen.

Of the approximately 8,000 species of ants in the world, all 5 species of Polyergus and some 200 species in other genera have evolved some degree of parasitic relationship with other ants.

10. Which of the following statements best represents the main idea of the passage?

    (A) Ants belonging to the genus Formica are incapable of performing certain tasks.
    (B) The genus Polyergus is quite similar to the genus Formica.
    (C) Ants belonging to the genus Polyergus have an unusual relationship with ants belonging to the genus Formica.
    (D) Polyergus ants frequently leave their nests to build new colonies.

11. The word "raise" in line 1 is closest in meaning to

    (A) rear
    (B) lift
    (C) collect
    (D) increase

12. The author mentions cuckoos and cowbirds in line 2 because they

    (A) share their nests with each other
    (B) are closely related species
    (C) raise the young of other birds
    (D) are social parasites

13. The word "it" in line 3 refers to

    (A) species
    (B) nest
    (C) egg
    (D) female

14. What does the author mean by stating that “The dulotic species of lifts... are die supreme social parasites" (line 5) ?

    (A) The Polyergus are more highly developed than die Formica.
    (B) The Formica have developed specialized roles.
    (C) The Polyergus are heavily dependent on the Formica.
    (D) The Formica do not reproduce rapidly enough to care for themselves

15. Which of the following is a task that an ant of the genus Polyergus might do?

    (A) Look for food.
    (B) Raid another nest
    (C) Care for the young.
    (D) Clean its own nest.

16. The word "excavate" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) find
    (B) clean
    (C) repair
    (D) dig

17. The word "recruit" in line 20 is closest in meaning
    (A) create
    (B) enlist
    (C) endure
    (D) capture

18. What happens when a mixed colony of Polyergus and Formica ants becomes too large?

    (A) The Polyergus workers enlarge the existing nest.
    (B) The captured Formica workers return to their original nest.
    (C) The Polyergus and the Formica build separate nests.
    (D) The Polyergus and the Formica move to a new nest.

19. According to the information in the passage, all of the following terms refer to ants belonging to the genus Formica EXCEPT the

    (A) dulotic species of ants (line 5)
    (B) captured brood (line 13)
    (C) developing pupae (line 14)
    (D) worker population (line 19)

Questions 20-29

The Winterthur Museum is a collection and a house. There are many museums devoted to the decorative arts and many house museums, but rarely in the United States is a great collection displayed in a great country house. Passing through successive generations of a single family, Winterthur has been a private estate for more than a century. Even after the extensive renovations made to it between 1929 and 1931, the house remained a family residence. This fact is of importance to the atmosphere and effect of the museum. The impression of a lived-in house is apparent to the visitor; the rooms look as if they were vacated only a short while ago whether by the original owners of the furniture or the most recent residents of the house can be a matter of personal interpretation. Winterthur remains, then, a house in which a collection of furniture and architectural elements has been assembled. Like an English country house, it is an organic structure; the house, as well as the collection and manner of displaying it to the visitor, has changed over the years. The changes have coincided with developing concepts of the American arts, increased knowledge on the part of collectors and students, and a progression toward the achievement of a historical effect in period-room displays. The rooms at Winterthur have followed this current, yet still retained the character of a private house.

The concept of a period room as a display technique has developed gradually over the years in an effort to present works of art in a context that would show them to greater effect and would give them more meaning for the viewer. Comparable to the habitat group in a natural history museum, the period room represents the decorative arts in a lively and interesting manner and provides an opportunity to assemble objects related by style, date, or place of manufacture.

20. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The reason that Winterthur was redesigned
(B) Elements that make Winterthur an unusual museum
(C) How Winterthur compares to English country houses
(D) Historical furniture contained in Winterthur

21. The phrase "devoted to" in line 2 is closest in meaning to

(A) surrounded by
(B) specializing in
(C) successful with
(D) sentimental about

22. What happened at Winterthur between 1929 and 1931?

(A) The owners moved out.
(B) The house was repaired.
(C) The old furniture was replaced.
(D) The estate became a museum.

23. What does the author mean by stating "The impression of a lived-in house is apparent to the visitor" (line 7)?

(A) Winterthur is very old.
(B) Few people visit Winterthur.
(C) Winterthur does not look like a typical museum.
(D) The furniture at Winterthur looks comfortable.

24. The word "assembled" in line 11 Is closest in meaning to

(A) summoned
(B) appreciated
(C) brought together
(D) fundamentally changed

25. The word "it" in line 12 refers to

(A) Winterthur
(B) collection
(C) English country house
(D) visitor

26. The word "developing" in line 14 is closest in meaning to

(A) traditional
(B) exhibiting
(C) informative
(D) evolving

27. According lo the passage, objects in a period room are related by all of (he following EXCEPT

(A) date
(B) style
(C) place of manufacture
(D) past ownership

28. What is die relationship between the two paragraphs in the passage?

(A) The second paragraph explains a term that was mentioned in the first paragraph.
(B) Each paragraph describes a different approach to the display of objects in a museum.
(C) The second paragraph explains a philosophy of art appreciation that contrasts with the philosophy explained in me first paragraph.
(D) Each paragraph describes a different historical period.

29. Where in the passage does the author explain why displays at Winterthur have changed?

(A) lines 1-3
(B) lines 5-6
(C) lines 7-10
(D) lines 13-16

Questions 30-39

The modem comic strip started out as ammunition in a newspaper war between giants of the American press in the late nineteenth century. The first full-color comic strip appeared in January 1894 in the New York *World,* owned by Joseph Pulitzer. The first regular weekly full-color comic supplement, similar to today's Sunday funnies, appeared two years later, in William Randolph Hearst's rival New York paper, the *Morning Journal*.

Both were immensely popular, and publishers realized that supplementing the news with comic relief boosted the sale of papers. The *Morning Journal* started another feature in 1896, the "Yellow Kid," the first continuous comic character in the United States, whose creator, Richard Outcault, had been lured away from the *World* by the ambitious Hearst. The "Yellow Kid" was in many ways a pioneer. Its comic dialogue was the strictly urban farce that came to characterize later strips, and it introduced the speech balloon inside the strip, usually placed above the characters' heads.

The first strip to incorporate all the elements of later comics was Rudolph Dirks's "Katzenjammer Kids," based on Wilhelm Busch's *Max and Moritz,* a European satire of the nineteenth century. The "Kids" strip, first published in 1897, served as the prototype for future American strips. It contained not only speech balloons, but a continuous cast of characters, and was divided into small regular panels that did away with the larger panoramic scenes of most earlier comics.

Newspaper syndication played a major role in spreading the popularity of comic strips throughout the country. Though weekly colored comics came first, daily black-and-white strips were not far behind. They first appeared in the Chicago *American* in 1904. It was followed by many imitators, and by 1915 black-and-white comic strips had become a staple of daily newspapers around the country.

30. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) A comparison of two popular comic strips
(B) The differences between early and modern comic strips
(C) The effects of newspapers on comic strip stories
(D) Features of early comic strips in the United States

31. Why does the author mention Joseph Pulitzer and William Randolph Hearst?

(A) They established New York's first newspaper.
(B) They published comic strips about the newspaper war.
(C) Their comic strips are still published today.
(D) They owned major competitive newspapers.

32. The passage suggests that comic strips were popular for which of the following reasons?

(A) They provided a break from serious news stories.
(B) Readers enjoyed the unusual drawings.
(C) Readers could identify with the characters.
(D) They were about real-life situations.

33. To say that Richard Outcault had been "lured away from" the *World by* Hearst (line 10) means which of the following?

(A) Hearst convinced Outcault to leave the *World*.
(B) Hearst fired Outcault from the *World.*
(C) Hearst warned Outcault to leave the *World*.
(D) Hearst wanted Outcault to work for the *World.*

34. The word "it" in line 12 refer to

(A) The "Yellow Kid"
(B) dialogue
(C) farce
(D) balloon

35. According to the passage, the "Yellow Kid" was the first comic strip to do all of the following EXCEPT

(A) feature the same character in each episode
(B) include dialogue inside a balloon
(C) appear in a Chicago newspaper
(D) characterize city life in a humorous way

36. The word "incorporate" in line 14 is closest in meaning to

(A) affect
(B) create
(C) combine
(D) mention

37. The word "prototype" in line 17 is closest in meaning to

(A) story
(B) humor
(C) drawing
(D) model

38. The word "staple" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) regular feature
(B) popular edition
(C) new version
(D) huge success

39. In what order does the author discuss various comic strips in the passage?

(A) In alphabetical order by title
(B) In the order in which they were created
(C) According to the newspaper in which they appeared
(D) From most popular to least popular

Questions 40-50

Every drop of water in the ocean, even in the deepest parts, responds to the forces that create the tides. No other force that affects the sea is so strong. Compared with the tides, the waves created by the wind are surface movements felt no more than a hundred fathoms below the surface. The currents also seldom involve more than the upper several hundred fathoms despite their impressive sweep.

The tides are a response of the waters of the ocean to the pull of the Moon and the more distant Sun. In theory, there is a gravitational attraction between the water and even the outermost star of the universe. In reality, however, the pull of remote stars is so slight as to be obliterated by the control of the Moon and, to a lesser extent, the Sun. Just as the Moon rises later each day by fifty minutes, on the average, so, in most places, the time of high tide is correspondingly later each day. And as the Moon waxes and wanes in its monthly cycle, so the height of the tide varies. The tidal movements are strongest when the Moon is a sliver in the sky, and when it is full. These are the highest flood tides and the lowest ebb tides of the lunar month and are called the spring tides. At these times the Sun, Moon, and Earth are nearly in line and the pull of the two heavenly bodies is added together to bring the water high on the beaches, to send its surf upward against the sea cliffs, and to draw a high tide into the harbors. Twice each month, at the quarters of the Moon, when the Sun, Moon and Earth lie at the apexes of a triangular configuration and the pull of the Sun and Moon are opposed, the moderate tidal movements called neap tides occur. Then the difference between high and low water is less than at any other time during the month.

40. What is the main point of the first paragraph?

(A) The waves created by ocean currents are very large.
(B) Despite the strength of the wind, it only moves surface water.
(C) Deep ocean water is seldom affected by forces that move water.
(D) The tides are the most powerful force to affect the movement of ocean water.

41. The word "felt" in line 3 is closest in meaning to

(A) based
(B) dropped
(C) detected
(D) explored

42. The words "In reality" in line 8 are closest in meaning to

(A) surprisingly
(B) actually
(C) characteristically
(D) similarly

43. It can be inferred from the passage that the most important factor in determining how much gravitational effect one object in space has on the tides is

(A) size
(B) distance
(C) temperature
(D) density

44. The word "correspondingly" in line 11 is closest in meaning to

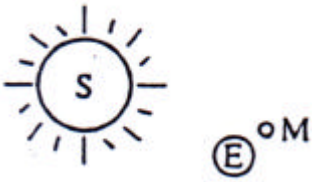
(A) unpredictably
(B) interestingly
(C) similarly
(D) unusually

45. What is the cause of spring tides?

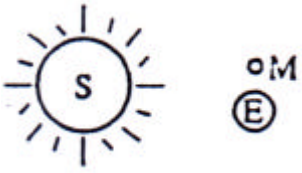
(A) Seasonal changes in the weather
(B) The gravitational pull of the Sun and the Moon when nearly in line with the Earth
(C) The Earth's movement around the Sun
(D) The triangular arrangement of the Earth, Sun, and Moon

46. Which of the following pictures best represents the position of the Sun, Moon, and Earth during spring tides?

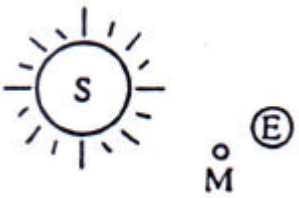
(A)



(B)



(C)



(D)



47. The word "configuration" in line 19 is closest in meaning to

(A) unit
(B) center
(C) surface
(D) arrangement

48. Neap tides occur when

(A) the Sun counteracts the Moon's gravitational attraction
(B) the Moon is full
(C) the Moon is farthest from the Sun
(D) waves created by the wind combine with the Moon's gravitational attraction

49. According to the passage, all of the following statements about tides are true EXCEPT:

(A) The time of high tide is later each day.
(B) Tides have a greater effect on the sea than waves do.
(C) The strongest tides occur at the quarters of the Moon.
(D) Neap tides are more moderate than spring tides.

50. Where in the passage does the author mention movements of ocean water other than those caused by tides?

(A) Lines 2-5
(B) Lines 10-11
(C) Lines 12-13
(D) Lines 17-20

Practice Test C – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	C	Easy	82%
2	C	Medium	64%
3	C	Easy	86%
4	D	Difficult	44%
5	B	Medium	76%
6	A	Medium	63%
7	D	Medium	54%
8	A	Difficult	46%
9	D	Medium	65%
10	C	Medium	69%
11	A	Medium	49%
12	D	Medium	66%
13	C	Easy	84%
14	C	Medium	55%
15	B	Medium	66%
16	D	Medium	53%
17	B	Difficult	27%
18	D	Medium	59%
19	A	Difficult	43%
20	B	Medium	72%
21	B	Medium	60%
22	B	Medium	62%
23	C	Medium	71%
24	C	Medium	65%
25	A	Medium	60%
26	D	Medium	61%
27	D	Easy	82%
28	A	Difficult	37%
29	D	Medium	72%
30	D	Medium	49%
31	D	Difficult	48%
32	A	Difficult	39%
33	A	Difficult	33%
34	A	Medium	68%
35	C	Medium	70%
36	C	Medium	64%
37	D	Medium	76%
38	A	Medium	58%
39	B	Medium	60%
40	D	Medium	64%
41	C	Medium	49%
42	B	Easy	86%

43	B	Medium	65%
44	C	Medium	68%
45	B	Medium	68%
46	D	Medium	65%
47	D	Medium	64%
48	A	Difficult	43%
49	C	Medium	56%
50	A	Medium	65%

Practice Test D – Reading

Question 1- 9

In the 1500's when the Spanish moved into what later was to become the southwestern United States, they encountered the ancestors of the modern-day Pueblo, Hopi, and Zuni peoples. These ancestors, known variously as the Basket Makers, the Anasazi, or the Ancient Ones, had lived in the area for at least 2,000 years. They were an advanced agricultural people who used irrigation to help grow their crops.

The Anasazi lived in houses constructed of adobe and wood. Anasazi houses were originally built in pits and were entered from the roof. But around the year 700 A.D., the Anasazi began to build their homes above ground and join them together into rambling multistoried complexes, which the Spanish called pueblos or villages. Separate subterranean rooms in these pueblos – known as kivas or chapels – were set aside for religious ceremonials. Each kiva had a fire pit and a hole that was believed to lead to the underworld. The largest pueblos had five stories and more than 800 rooms.

The Anasazi family was matrilinear; that is, descent was traced through the female. The sacred objects of the family were under the control of the oldest female, but the actual ceremonies were conducted by her brother, or son. Women owned the rooms in the pueblo and the crops, once they were harvested. While still growing, crops belonged to the men, who, in contrast to most other Native American groups, planted them. The women made baskets and pottery; the men wove textile and crafted turquoise jewelry.

Each village had two chiefs. The village chief dealt with land disputes and religious affairs. The war chief led the men in fighting during occasional conflicts that broke out with neighboring villages and directed the men in community building projects. The cohesive political and social organization of the Anasazi made it almost impossible for other groups to conquer them.

1. The Anasazi people were considered "agriculturally advanced" because of the way they

   (A) stored their crops
   (B) fertilized their fields
   (C) watered their crops
   (D) planted their fields

2. The word "pits" in line 7 is closest in meaning to

   (A) stages
   (B) scars
   (C) seeds
   (D) holes

3. The word "stories" in line 12 is closest in meaning to

   (A) articles
   (B) tales
   (C) levels
   (D) rumors

4. Who would have been most likely to control the sacred objects of an Anasazi family?

   (A) A twenty-year-old man
   (B) A twenty-year-old woman
   (C) A forty-year-old man
   (D) A forty-year-old woman

5. The word "they" in line 16 refers to

   (A) women
   (B) crops
   (C) rooms
   (D) pueblos

6. The word "disputes" in line 20 is closest in meaning to

   (A) discussions
   (B) arguments
   (C) developments
   (D) purchases

7. Which of the following activities was NOT done by Anasazi men?

   (A) Making baskets
   (B) Planting crops
   (C) Building homes
   (D) Crafting jewelry

8. According to the passage, what made it almost impossible for other groups to conquer the Anasazi ?

   (A) The political and social organization of the Anasazi
   (B) The military tactics employed by the Anasazi
   (C) The Anasazi's agricultural technology
   (D) The natural barriers surrounding Anasazi village

9. The passage supports which of the following generalizations?

   (A) The presence of the Spanish threatened Anasazi society.
   (B) The Anasazi benefited from trading relations with the Spanish.
   (C) Anasazi society exhibited a well-defined division of labor.
   (D) Conflicts between neighboring Anasazi villages were easily resolved.

Questions 10-19

Barbed wire, first patented in the United States in 1867, played an important part in the development of American farming, as it enabled the settlers to make effective fencing to enclose their land and keep cattle away from their crops. This had a considerable effect on cattle ranching, since the herds no longer had unrestricted use of the plains for grazing, and the fencing led to conflict between the farmers and the cattle ranchers.

Before barbed wire came into general use, fencing was often made from serrated wire, which was unsatisfactory because it broke easily when under strain, and could snap in cold weather due to contraction. The first practical machine for producing barbed wire was invented in 1874 by an Illinois farmer, and between then and the end of the century about 400 types of barbed wire were devised, of which only about a dozen were ever put to practical use.

Modern barbed wire is made from mild steel, high-tensile steel, or aluminum. Mild steel and aluminum barbed wire have two strands twisted together to form a cable that is stronger than single-strand wire and less affected by temperature changes. Single-strand wire, round or oval, is made from high-tensile steel with the barbs crimped or welded on. The steel wires used are galvanized – coated with zinc to make them rustproof. The two wires that make up the line wire or cable are fed separately into a machine at one end. They leave it at the other end twisted together and barbed.The wire to make the barbs is fed into the machine from the sides and cut to length by knives that cut diagonally through the wire to produce a sharp point. This process continues automatically, and the finished barbed wire is wound onto reels, usually made of wire, in lengths of 400 meters or in weights of up to 50 kilograms.

A variation of barbed wire is also used for military purposes. It is formed into long coils or entanglements called concertina wire.

10. What is the main topic of the passage?

(A) Cattle ranching in the United States
(B) A type of fencing.
(C) Industrial uses of wire.
(D) A controversy over land use.

11. The word "unrestricted" in line 4 is closest in meaning to

(A) unsatisfactory
(B) difficult
(C) considerable
(D) unlimited

12. The word "snap" in line 9 could best be replaced by which of the following?

(A) freeze
(B) click
(C) loosen
(D) break

13. What is the benefit of using two-stranded barbed wire?

(A) Improved rust-resistance
(B) Increased strength
(C) More rapid attachment of barbs
(D) Easier installation

14. According to the author, the steel wires used to make barbed wire are specially processed to

(A) protect them against rust
(B) make them more flexible
(C) prevent contraction in cold weather
(D) straighten them

15. The word "fed" in line 20 is closest in meaning to

(A) put
(B) eaten
(C) bitten
(D) nourished

16. The knives referred to in line 21 are used to

(A) separate double-stranded wire
(B) prevent the reel from advancing too rapidly
(C) twist the wire
(D) cut the wire that becomes barbs

17. What is the author's purpose in the third paragraph?

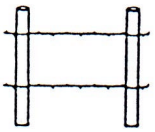
(A) To explain the importance of the wire
(B) To outline the difficulty of making the wire
(C) To describe how the wire is made
(D) To suggest several different uses of the wire

18. According to the passage, concertina wire is used for

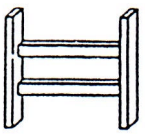
(A) livestock management
(B) international communications
(C) prison enclosures
(D) military purposes

19. Which of the following most closely resembles the fencing described in the passage?

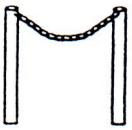
(A)



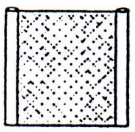
(B)



(C)



(D)



Questions 20-28

Under certain circumstances, the human body must cope with gases at greater-than-normal atmospheric pressure. For example, gas pressures increase rapidly during a dive made with scuba gear because the breathing equipment allows divers to stay underwater longer and dive deeper. The pressure exerted on the human body increases by 1 atmosphere for every 10 meters of depth in seawater, so that at 30 meters in seawater a diver is exposed to a pressure of about 4 atmospheres. The pressure of the gases being breathed must equal the external pressure applied to the body; otherwise breathing is very difficult. Therefore all of the gases in the air breathed by a scuba diver at 40 meters are present at five times their usual pressure. Nitrogen, which composes 80 percent of the air we breathe, usually causes a balmy feeling of well-being at this pressure. At a depth of 5 atmospheres, nitrogen causes symptoms resembling alcohol intoxication, known as nitrogen narcosis. Nitrogen narcosis apparently results from a direct effect on the brain of the large amounts of nitrogen dissolved in the blood. Deep dives are less dangerous if helium is substituted for nitrogen, because under these pressures helium does not exert a similar narcotic effect.

As a scuba diver descends, the pressure of nitrogen in the lungs increases. Nitrogen then diffuses from the lungs to the blood, and from the blood to body tissues. The reverse occurs when the diver surfaces; the nitrogen pressure in the lungs falls and the nitrogen diffuses from the tissues into the blood, and from the blood into the lungs. If the return to the surface is too rapid, nitrogen in the tissues and blood cannot diffuse out rapidly enough and nitrogen bubbles are formed. They can cause severe pains, particularly around the joints.

Another complication may result if the breath is held during ascent. During ascent from a depth of 10 meters, the volume of air in the lungs will double because the air pressure at the surface is only half of what it was at 10 meters. This change in volume may cause the lungs to distend and even rupture. This condition is called air embolism. To avoid this event, a diver must ascend slowly, never at a rate exceeding the rise of the exhaled air bubbles, and must exhale during ascent.

20. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The equipment divers use
(B) The effects of pressure on gases in the human body
(C) How to prepare for a deep dive
(D) The symptoms of nitrogen bubbles in the bloodstream

21. The words "exposed to" in line 6 are closest in meaning to

(A) leaving behind
(B) prepared for
(C) propelled by
(D) subjected to

22. The word "exert" in line 15 is closest in meaning to

(A) cause
(B) permit.
(C) need.
(D) change.

23. The word "diffuses" in line 19 is closest in meaning to

(A) yields
(B) starts
(C) surfaces
(D) travels

24. What happens to nitrogen in body tissues if a diver ascends too quickly?

(A) It forms bubbles.
(B) It goes directly to the brain.
(C) It is reabsorbed by the lungs.
(D) It has a narcotic effect.

25. The word "they" in line 21 refers to

(A) joins
(B) pains
(C) bubbles
(D) tissues

26. The word " rupture " in line 26 is closest in meaning to

(A) hurt
(B) shrink
(C) burst
(D) stop

27. It can be inferred from the passage that which of the following presents the greatest danger to a diver?

(A) Pressurized helium
(B) Nitrogen diffusion
(C) Nitrogen bubbles
(D) An air embolism

28. What should a diver do when ascending?

(A) Rise slowly.
(B) Breathe faster.
(C) Relax completely.
(D) Breathe helium.

Questions 29-38

Each advance in microscopic technique has provided scientists with new perspective, on the function of living organisms and the nature of matter itself. The invention of the visible-light microscope late in the sixteenth century introduced a previously unknown realm of single-celled plants and animals. In the twentieth century, electron microscopes have provided direct views of viruses and minuscule surface structures. Now another type of microscope, one that utilizes X rays rather than light or electrons, offers a different way of examining tiny details; it should extend human perception still farther into the natural world.

The dream of building an X-ray microscope dates to 1895; its development, however, was virtually halted in the 1940's because the development of the electron microscope was progressing rapidly. During the 1940's electron microscopes routinely achieved resolution better than that possible with a visible-light microscope, while the performance of X-ray microscopes resisted improvement. In recent years, however, interest in X-ray microscopes has revived, largely because of advances such as the development of new sources of X-ray illumination. As a result, the brightness available today is millions of times that of X-ray tubes, which, for most of the century, were the only available sources of soft X rays.

The new X-ray microscopes considerably improve on the resolution provided by optical microscopes. They can also be used to map the distribution of certain chemical elements. Some can form pictures in extremely short times; others hold the promise of special capabilities such as three-dimensional imaging. Unlike conventional electron microscopy, X-ray microscopy enables specimens to be kept in air and in water, which means that biological samples can be studied under conditions similar to their natural state. The illumination used, so-called soft X rays in the wavelength range of twenty to forty angstroms (an angstrom is one ten-billionth of a meter), is also sufficiently penetrating to image intact biological cells in many cases. Because of the wavelength of the X rays used, soft X-ray microscopes will never match the highest resolution possible with electron microscopes. Rather, their special properties will make possible investigations that will complement those performed with light- and electron-based instruments.

29. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The detail seen through a microscope
(B) Sources of illumination for microscope
(C) A new kind of microscope
(D) Outdated microscopic techniques

30. According to the passage, the invention of the visible-light microscope allowed scientists to

(A) see viruses directly
(B) develop the electron microscope later on
(C) understand more about the distribution of the chemical elements
(D) discover single-celled plants and animals they had never seen before

31. The word "minuscule" in line 5 is closest in meaning to

(A) circular
(B) dangerous
(C) complex
(D) tiny

32. The word "it" in line 7 refers to

(A) a type of microscope
(B) human perception
(C) the natural world
(D) light

33. Why does the author mention the visible-light microscope in the first paragraph?

(A) To begin a discussion of sixteenth-century discoveries
(B) To put the X-ray microscope in a historical perspective
(C) To show how limited its uses are
(D) To explain how it functioned

34. Why did it take so long to develop the X-ray microscope?

(A) Funds for research were insufficient.
(B) The source of illumination was not bright enough until recently.
(C) Materials used to manufacture X-ray tubes were difficult to obtain.
(D) X-ray microscopes were too complicated to operate.

35. The word "enables" in line 22 is closest in meaning to

(A) constitutes
(B) specifies
(C) expands
(D) allows

36. The word "Rather" in line 28 is closest in meaning to

(A) significantly
(B) preferably
(C) somewhat
(D) instead

37. The word "those" in line 29 refers to

(A) properties
(B) investigations
(C) microscopes
(D) X rays

38. Based on the information in the passage, what can be inferred about X-ray microscopes in the future?

(A) They will probably replace electron microscopes altogether.
(B) They will eventually be much cheaper to produce than they are now.
(C) They will provide information not available from other kinds of microscopes.
(D) They will eventually chance the illumination range that they now use.

Questions 39-50

Perhaps the most striking quality of satiric literature is its freshness, its originality of perspective. Satire rarely offers original ideas. Instead, it presents the familiar in a new form. Satirists do not offer the world new philosophies. What they do is look at familiar conditions from a perspective that makes these conditions seem foolish, harmful, or affected. Satire jars us out of complacence into a pleasantly shocked realization that many of the values we unquestioningly accept are false. *Don Quixote* makes chivalry seem absurd; *Brave New World* ridicules the pretensions of science; A *Modest Proposal* dramatizes starvation by advocating cannibalism. None of these ideas is original. Chivalry was suspect before Cervantes, humanists objected to the claims of pure science before Aldous Huxley, and people were aware of famine before Swift. It was not the originality of the idea that made these satires popular. It was the manner of expression, the satiric method, that made them interesting and entertaining. Satires are read because they are aesthetically satisfying works of art, not because they are morally wholesome or ethically instructive. They are stimulating and refreshing because with commonsense briskness they brush away illusions and secondhand opinions. With spontaneous irreverence, satire rearranges perspectives, scrambles familiar objects into incongruous juxtaposition, and speaks in a personal idiom instead of abstract platitude.

Satire exists because there is need for it. It his lived because readers appreciate a refreshing stimulus, an irreverent reminder that they live in a world of platitudinous thinking, cheap moralizing, and foolish philosophy. Satire serves to prod people into an awareness of truth, though rarely to any action on behalf of truth. Satire tends to remind people that much of what they see, hear, and read in popular media is sanctimonious, sentimental, and only partially true. Life resembles in only a slight degree the popular image of it. Soldiers rarely hold the ideals that movies attribute to them, nor do ordinary citizens devote their lives to unselfish service of humanity. Intelligent people know these things but tend to forget them when they do not hear them expressed.

39. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) Difficulties of writing satiric literature
(B) Popular topics of satire
(C) New philosophies emerging from satiric literature
(D) Reasons for the popularity of satire

40. The word "realization" in line 6 is closest in meaning to

(A) certainty
(B) awareness
(C) surprise
(D) confusion

41. Why does the author mention *Don Quixote, Brave New World, and A Modest Proposal* in lines 6-8?

(A) They are famous examples of satiric literature.
(B) They present commonsense solutions to problems.
(C) They are appropriate for readers of all ages.
(D) They are books with similar stories.

42. The word "aesthetically" in line 13 is closest in meaning to

(A) artistically
(B) exceptionally
(C) realistically
(D) dependably

43. Which of the following can be found in satiric literature?

(A) Newly emerging philosophies
(B) Odd combinations of objects and ideas
(C) Abstract discussion of morals and ethics
(D) Wholesome characters who are unselfish

44. According to the passage, there is a need for satire because people need to be

(A) informed about new scientific developments
(B) exposed to original philosophies when they are formulated
(C) reminded that popular ideas are often inaccurate
(D) told how they call be of service to their communities

45. The word "refreshing" in line 19 is closest ill meaning to

(A) popular
(B) ridiculous
(C) meaningful
(D) unusual

46. The word "they" in line 22 refers to

(A) people
(B) media
(C) ideals
(D) movies

47. The word "devote" in line 25 is closest in meaning to

(A) distinguish
(B) feel affection
(C) prefer
(D) dedicate

48. As a result of reading satiric literature, readers will be most likely to

(A) teach themselves to write fiction
(B) accept conventional points of view
(C) become better informed about current affairs
(D) reexamine their opinions and values

49. The various purposes of satire include all of the following EXCEPT

(A) introducing readers to unfamiliar situations
(B) brushing away illusions
(C) reminding readers of the truth
(D) exposing false values

50. Why does the author mention "service of humanity" in line 25?

(A) People need to be reminded to take action
(B) Readers appreciate knowing about it
(C) It is an ideal that is rarely achieved
(D) Popular media often distort such stories.

Practice Test D – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	C	Difficult	56%
2	D	Medium	70%
3	C	Easy	85%
4	D	Easy	91%
5	B	Medium	62%
6	B	Medium	57%
7	A	Medium	78%
8	A	Easy	88%
9	C	Medium	63%
10	B	Difficult	49%
11	D	Medium	74%
12	D	Difficult	55%
13	B	Medium	82%
14	A	Medium	60%
15	A	Easy	84%
16	D	Medium	83%
17	C	Medium	81%
18	D	Easy	89%
19	A	Medium	65%
20	B	Easy	84%
21	D	Difficult	52%
22	A	Medium	74%
23	D	Medium	71%
24	A	Medium	76%
25	C	Easy	90%
26	C	Difficult	55%
27	D	Medium	63%
28	A	Easy	88%
29	C	Difficult	56%
30	D	Medium	80%
31	D	Medium	80%
32	A	Easy	94%
33	B	Medium	58%
34	B	Medium	69%
35	D	Easy	84%
36	D	Difficult	54%
37	B	Difficult	40%
38	C	Difficult	54%
39	D	Medium	64%
40	B	Medium	67%
41	A	Medium	70%
42	A	Difficult	36%

43	B	Difficult	47%
44	C	Medium	65%
45	D	Difficult	43%
46	A	Easy	91%
47	D	Medium	65%
48	D	Difficult	56%
49	A	Difficult	38%
50	C	Difficult	40%

Practice Test E – Reading

Question 1- 7

Hotels were among the earliest facilities that bound the United States together. They were both creatures and creators of communities, as well symptoms of the frenetic quest for community. Even in the first part of the nineteenth century, Americans were already forming the habit of gathering from all corners of the nation for both public and private, business and pleasure, purposes. Conventions were the new occasions, and hotels were distinctively American facilities making conventions possible. The first national convention of a major party to choose a candidate for President (that of the National Republican party, which met on December 12, 1831, and nominated Henry Clay for President) was held in Baltimore, at a hotel that was then reputed to be the best in the country. The presence in Baltimore of Barnum's City Hotel, a six-story building with two hundred apartments, helps explain why many other early national political conventions were held there.

In the longer run, American hotels made other national conventions not only possible but pleasant and convivial. The growing custom of regularly assembling from afar the representatives of all kinds of groups – not only for political conventions, but also for commercial, professional, learned, and avocations ones – in turn supported the multiplying hotels. By the mid-twentieth century, conventions accounted for over a third of the yearly room occupancy of all hotels in the nation; about eighteen thousand different conventions were held annually with a total attendance of about ten million persons.

Nineteenth-century American hotelkeepers, who were no longer the genial, deferential "hosts" of the eighteenth-century European inn, became leading citizens. Holding a large stake in the community, they exercised power to make it prosper. As owners or managers of the local "palace of the public," they were makers and shapers of a principal community attraction. Travelers from abroad were mildly shocked by this high social position.

1. The word "bound" in line 1 is closest in meaning to

   (A) led
   (B) protected
   (C) tied
   (D) strengthened

2. The National Republican party is mentioned in line 8 as an example of a group

   (A) from Baltimore
   (B) of learned people
   (C) owning a hotel
   (D) holding a convention

3. The word "assembling" in line 14 is closest in meaning to

   (A) announcing
   (B) motivating
   (C) gathering
   (D) contracting

4. The word "ones" in line 16 refers to

   (A) hotels
   (B) conventions
   (C) kinds
   (D) representatives

5. The word "it" in line 23 refers to

   (A) European inn
   (B) host
   (C) community
   (D) public

6. It can be inferred from the passage that early hotelkeepers in the United States were

   (A) active politicians
   (B) European immigrants
   (C) professional builders
   (D) influential citizens

7. Which of the following statements about early American hotels is NOT mentioned in the passage?

   (A) Travelers from abroad did not enjoy staying in them.
   (B) Conventions were held in them.
   (C) People used them for both business and pleasure.
   (D) They were important to the community

Questions 8-17

Beads were probably the first durable ornaments humans possessed, and the intimate relationship they had with their owners is reflected in the fact that beads are among the most common items found in ancient archaeological sites. In the past, as today, men, women, and children adorned themselves with beads. In some cultures still, certain beads are often worn from birth until death, and then are buried with their owners for the afterlife. Abrasion due to daily wear alters the surface features of beads, and if they are buried for long, the effects of corrosion can further change their appearance. Thus, interest is imparted to the bead both by use and the effects of time.

Besides their wearability, either as jewelry or incorporated into articles of attire, beads possess the desirable characteristics of every collectible: they are durable, portable, available in infinite variety, and often valuable in their original cultural context as well as in today's market. Pleasing to look at and touch, beads come in shapes, colors, and materials that almost compel one to handle them and to sort them.

Beads are miniature bundles of secrets waiting to be revealed: their history, manufacture, cultural context, economic role, and ornamental use are all points of information one hopes to unravel. Even the most mundane beads may have traveled great distances and been exposed to many human experiences. The bead researcher must gather information from many diverse fields. In addition to having to be a generalist while specializing in what may seem to be a narrow field, the researcher is faced with the problem of primary materials that have little or no documentation. Many ancient beads that are of ethnographic interest have often been separated from their original cultural context.

The special attractions of beads contribute to the uniqueness of bead research. While often regarded as the "small change of civilizations," beads are a part of every culture, and they can often be used to date archaeological sites and to designate the degree of mercantile, technological, and cultural sophistication.

8. What is the main subject of the passage?

(A) Materials used in making beads
(B) How beads are made
(C) The reasons for studying beads
(D) Different types of beads

9. The word "adorned" in line 4 is closest in meaning to

(A) protected
(B) decorated
(C) purchased
(D) enjoyed

10. The word "attire" in line 9 is Closest in meaning to

(A) ritual
(B) importance
(C) clothing
(D) history

11. All of the following are given as characteristics of collectible objects EXCEPT

(A) durability
(B) portability
(C) value
(D) scarcity

12. According to the passage, all of the following are factors that make people want to touch beads EXCEPT the

(A) shape
(B) color
(C) material
(D) odor

13. The word "unravel" in line 16 is closest in meaning to

(A) communicate
(B) transport
(C) improve
(D) discover

14. The word "mundane" in line 16 is closest in meaning to

(A) carved
(B) beautiful
(C) ordinary
(D) heavy

15. It is difficult to trace the history of certain ancient beads because they

(A) are small in size
(B) have been buried underground
(C) have been moved from their original locations
(D) are frequently lost

16. Knowledge of the history of some beads may be useful in the studies done by which of the following?

(A) Anthropologist
(B) Agricultural experts
(C) Medical researchers
(D) Economists

17. Where in the passage does the author describe why the appearance beads may change?

(A) Lines 3-4
(B) Lines 6-8
(C) Lines 12-13
(D) Lines 20-22

Questions 18-31

In the world of birds, bill design is a prime example of evolutionary fine-tuning. Shorebirds such as oystercatchers use their bills to pry open the tightly sealed shells of their prey; hummingbirds have stiletto-like bills to probe the deepest nectar-bearing flowers; and kiwis smell out earthworms thanks to nostrils located at the tip of their beaks. But few birds are more intimately tied to their source of sustenance than are crossbills. Two species of these finches, named for the way the upper and lower parts of their bills cross, rather than meet in the middle, reside in the evergreen forests of North America and feed on the seeds held within the cones of coniferous trees.

The efficiency of the bill is evident when a crossbill locates a cone. Using a lateral motion of its lower mandible, the bird separates two overlapping scales on the cone and exposes the seed. The crossed mandibles enable the bird to exert a powerful biting force at the bill tips, which is critical for maneuvering them between the scales and spreading the scales apart. Next, the crossbill snakes its long tongue into the gap and draws out the seed. Using the combined action of the bill and tongue, the bird cracks open and discards the woody seed covering and swallows the nutritious inner kernel. This whole process takes but a few seconds and is repeated hundreds of times a day.

The bills of different crossbill species and subspecies vary – some are stout and deep, others more slender and shallow. As a rule, large-billed crossbills are better at securing seeds from large cones, while small-billed crossbills are more deft at removing the seeds from small, thin-scaled cones. Moreover, the degree to which cones are naturally slightly open or tightly closed helps determine which bill design is the best.

One anomaly is the subspecies of red crossbill known as the Newfoundland crossbill. This bird has a large, robust bill, yet most of Newfoundland's conifers have small cones, the same kind of cones that the slender-billed white-wings rely on.

18. What does the passage mainly discuss?

(A) The importance of conifers in evergreen forests
(B) The efficiency of the bill of the crossbill
(C) The variety of food available in a forest
(D) The different techniques birds use to obtain food

19. Which of the following statements best represents the type of "evolutionary fine-tuning" mentioned in line 1?

(A) Different shapes of bills have evolved depending on the available food supply.
(B) White-wing crossbars have evolved from red crossbills.
(C) Newfoundland's conifers have evolved small cones.
(D) Several subspecies of crossbills have evolved from two species.

20. Why does the author mention oystercatchers, hummingbirds, and kiwis in lines 2-4?

(A) They are examples of birds that live in the forest.
(B) Their beaks are similar to the beak of the crossbill.
(C) They illustrate the relationship between bill design and food supply.
(D) They are closely related to the crossbill.

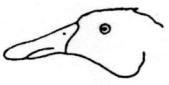
21. Crossbills are a type of

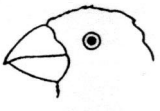
(A) shorebird
(B) hummingbird
(C) kiwi
(D) finch

22. Which of the following most closely resembles the bird described in lines 6-8?

(A)


(B)


(C)


(D)


23. The word "which" in line 12 refers to

(A) seed
(B) bird
(C) force
(D) bill

24. The word "gap" in line 13 is closest in meaning to

(A) opening
(B) flower
(C) mouth
(D) tree

25. The word "discards" in line 15 is closest in meaning to

(A) eats
(B) breaks
(C) finds out
(D) gets rid of

26. The word "others" in line 18 refers to

(A) bills
(B) species
(C) seeds
(D) cones

27. The word "deft" in line 19 is closest in meaning to

(A) hungry
(B) skilled
(C) tired
(D) pleasant

28. The word "robust" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) strong
(B) colorful
(C) unusual
(D) sharp

29. In what way is the Newfoundland crossbill an anomaly?

(A) It is larger than the other crossbill species.
(B) It uses a different technique to obtain food.
(C) The size of its bill does not fit the size of its food source.
(D) It does not live in evergreen forests.

30. The final paragraph of the passage will probably continue with a discussion of

(A) other species of forest birds
(B) the fragile ecosystem of Newfoundland
(C) what mammals live in the forests of North America
(D) how the Newfoundland crossbill survives with a large bill

31. Where in the passage does the author describe how a crossbill removed a seed from its cone?

(A) The first paragraph
(B) The second paragraph
(C) The third paragraph
(D) The fourth paragraph

Questions 32-38

If you look closely at some of the early copies of the Declaration or Independence, beyond the flourished signature of John Hancock and the other fifty-five men who signed it, you will also find the name of one woman, Mary Katherine Goddard. It was she, a Baltimore printer, who published the first official copies of the Declaration, the first copies that included the names of its signers and therefore heralded the support of all thirteen colonies.

Mary Goddard first got into printing at the age of twenty-four when her brother opened a printing shop in Providence, Rhode Island, in 1762. When he proceeded to get into trouble with his partners and creditors. it was Mary Goddard and her mother who were left to run the shop. In 1765 they began publishing the *Providence Gazette,* a weekly newspaper. Similar problems seemed to follow her brother as he opened businesses in Philadelphia and again in Baltimore. Each time Ms. Goddard was brought in to run the newspapers. After starting Baltimore's first newspaper, The *Maryland Journal,* in 1773, her brother went broke trying to organize a colonial postal service. While he was in debtor's prison, Mary Katherine Goddard's name appeared on the newspaper's masthead for the first time.

When the Continental Congress fled there from Philadelphia in 1776, it commissioned Ms. Goddard to print the first official version of the Declaration of Independence in January 1777. After printing the documents, she herself paid the post riders to deliver the Declaration throughout the colonies.

During the American Revolution, Mary Goddard continued to publish Baltimore's only newspaper, which one historian claimed was "second to none among the colonies." She was also the city's Postmaster from 1775 to 1789 – appointed by Benjamin Franklin – and is considered to be the first woman to hold a federal position.

32. With which of the following subjects is the passage mainly concerned?

(A) The accomplishments of a female publisher
(B) The weaknesses of the newspaper industry
(C) The rights of a female publisher
(D) The publishing system in colonial America

33. Mary Goddard's name appears on the Declaration of Independence because

(A) she helped write the original document
(B) she published the document
(C) she paid to have the document printed
(D) her brother was in prison

34. The word "heralded" in line 5 is closest in meaning to

(A) influenced
(B) announced
(C) rejected
(D) ignored

35. According to the passage, Mary Goddard first became involved in publishing when she

(A) was appointed by Benjamin Franklin
(B) signed the Declaration of Independence
(C) took over her brother's printing shop
(D) moved to Baltimore

36. The word "there" in line 17 refers to

(A) the colonies
(B) the print shop
(C) Baltimore
(D) Providence

37. It can be inferred from the passage that Mary Goddard was

(A) an accomplished businesswoman
(B) extremely wealthy
(C) a member of the Continental congress
(D) a famous writer

38. The word "position" in line 24 is closest in meaning to

(A) job
(B) election
(C) document
(D) location

Question 39-50

Galaxies are the major building blocks of the universe. A galaxy is a giant family of many millions of stars, and it is held together by its own gravitational field. Most of the material universe is organized into galaxies of stars, together with gas and dust.

There are three main types of galaxy: spiral, elliptical, and irregular. The Milky Way is a spiral galaxy: a flattish disc of star with two spiral arms emerging from its central nucleus. About one-quarter of all galaxies have this shape. Spiral galaxies are well supplied with the interstellar gas in which new stars form; as the rotating spiral pattern sweeps around the galaxy it compresses gas and dust, triggering the formation of bright young stars in its arms. The elliptical galaxies have a symmetrical elliptical or spheroidal shape with no obvious structure. Most of their member stars are very old and since ellipticals are devoid of interstellar gas, no new stars are forming in them. The biggest and brightest galaxies in the universe are ellipticals with masses of about 10^{13} times that of the Sun; these giants may frequently be sources of strong radio emission, in which case they are called radio galaxies. About two-thirds of all galaxies are elliptical. Irregular galaxies comprise about one-tenth of all galaxies and they come in many subclasses.

Measurement in space is quite different from measurement on Earth. Some terrestrial distances can be expressed as intervals of time: the time to fly from one continent to another or the time it takes to drive to work, for example. By comparison with these familiar yardsticks, the distances to the galaxies are incomprehensibly large, but they too are made more manageable by using a time calibration, in this case, the distance that light travels in one year. On such a scale the nearest giant spiral galaxy, the Andromeda galaxy, is two million light years away. The most distant luminous objects seen by telescopes are probably ten thousand million light years away. Their light was already halfway here before the Earth even formed. The light from the nearby Virgo galaxy set out when reptiles still dominated the animal world.

39. The word "major" in line 1 is closest in meaning to

(A) intense
(B) principal
(C) huge
(D) unique

40. What does the second paragraph mainly discuss?

(A) The Milky Way
(B) Major categories of galaxies
(C) How elliptical galaxies are formed
(D) Differences between irregular and spiral galaxies

41. The word "which" in line 7 refers to

(A) dust
(B) gas
(C) pattern
(D) galaxy

42. According to the passage, new stars are formed in spiral galaxies due to

(A) an explosion of gas
(B) the compression of gas and dust
(C) the combining of old stars
(D) strong radio emissions

43. The word "symmetrical" in line 9 is closest in meaning to

(A) proportionally balanced
(B) commonly seen
(C) typically large
(D) steadily growing

44. The word "obvious" in line 10 is closest in meaning to

(A) discovered
(B) apparent
(C) understood
(D) simplistic

45. According to the passage, which of the following is NOT true of elliptical galaxies?

(A) They are the largest galaxies.
(B) They mostly contain old stars.
(C) They contain a high amount of interstellar gas.
(D) They have a spherical shape.

46. Which of the following characteristics of radio galaxies is mentioned in the passage?

(A) They are a type of elliptical galaxy.
(B) They are usually too small to be seen with a telescope.
(C) They are closely related to irregular galaxies.
(D) They are not as bright as spiral galaxies.

47. What percentage of galaxies is irregular?

(A) 10%
(B) 25%
(C) 50%
(D) 75%

48. The word "they" in line 21 refers to

(A) intervals
(B) yardsticks
(C) distances
(D) galaxies

49. Why does the author mention the Virgo galaxy and the Andromeda galaxy in the third paragraph?

(A) To describe the effect that distance has on visibility
(B) To compare the ages of two relatively young galaxies
(C) To emphasize the vast distances of the galaxies from Earth
(D) To explain why certain galaxies cannot be seen by a telescope

50. The word "dominated" in line 26 is closest in meaning to

(A) threatened
(B) replaced
(C) were developing in
(D) were prevalent in

Practice Test E – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	C	M	75%
2	D	M	78%
3	C	M	75%
4	B	D	57%
5	C	D	50%
6	D	D	52%
7	A	E	84%
8	C	M	72%
9	B	M	66%
10	C	D	50%
11	D	E	83%
12	D	E	91%
13	D	M	65%
14	C	M	58%
15	C	M	70%
16	A	M	71%
17	B	M	74%
18	B	M	65%
19	A	M	69%
20	C	M	71%
21	D	D	51%
22	B	M	76%
23	C	D	49%
24	A	D	50%
25	D	M	53%
26	A	M	71%
27	B	E	79%
28	A	M	61%
29	C	D	46%
30	D	M	60%
31	B	M	66%
32	A	E	76%
33	B	M	67%
34	B	M	48%
35	C	E	73%
36	C	M	54%
37	A	M	51%
38	A	M	60%
39	B	M	69%
40	B	E	79%
41	B	M	64%
42	B	M	77%

43	A	M	65%
44	B	M	64%
45	C	M	55%
46	A	M	76%
47	A	M	77%
48	C	D	50%
49	C	M	56%
50	D	D	30%

Practice Test F – Reading

Questions 1 – 10

The growth of cities, the construction of hundreds of new factories, and the spread of railroads in the United States before 1850 had increased the need for better illumination. But the lighting in American homes had improved very little over that of ancient times.

Line Through the colonial period, homes were lit with tallow candles or with a lamp of the
(5) kind used in ancient Rome —a dish of fish oil or other animal or vegetable oil in which a twisted rag served as a wick. Some people used lard, but they had to heat charcoal underneath to keep it soft and burnable. The sperm whale provided a superior burning oil, but this was expensive. In 1830 a new substance called "camphene" was patented, and it proved to be an excellent illuminant. But while camphene gave a bright light it too
(10) remained expensive, had an unpleasant odor, and also was dangerously explosive.

Between 1830 and 1850 it seemed that the only hope for cheaper illumination in the United States was in the wider use of gas. In the 1840's American gas manufacturers adopted improved British techniques for producing illuminating gas from coal. But the expense of piping gas to the consumer remained so high that until midcentury gaslighting
(15) was feasible only in urban areas, and only for public buildings or for the wealthy.

In 1854 a Canadian doctor, Abraham Gesner, patented a process for distilling a pitchlike mineral found in New Brunswick and Nova Scotia that produced illuminating gas and an oil that he called "kerosene" (from "keros," the Greek word for wax, and "ene" because it resembled camphene). Kerosene, though cheaper than camphene, had an
(20) unpleasant odor, and Gesner never made his fortune from it. But Gesner had aroused a new hope for making an illuminating oil from a product coming out of North American mines.

1. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a reason why better lighting had become necessary by the mid-nineteenth century?
   (A) Development of railroads
   (B) Demand for better medical facilities
   (C) Increases in the number of new factories
   (D) Growth of cities

2. The phrase "served as" in line 6 is closest in meaning to
   (A) differed from
   (B) functioned as
   (C) rested upon
   (D) reacted to

3. The word "this" in line 8 refers to
   (A) lard
   (B) charcoal
   (C) wick
   (D) oil

4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a disadvantage of camphene?
   (A) High cost
   (B) Bad smell
   (C) Potential to explode
   (D) Greasy texture

5. What can be inferred about the illuminating gas described in the second paragraph?
   (A) It was first developed in the United States.
   (B) It was not allowed to be used in public buildings.
   (C) It was not widely available until midcentury.
   (D) It had an unpleasant smell.

6. The word "resembled" in line 19 is closest in meaning to
   (A) was similar to
   (B) cost the same as
   (C) was made from
   (D) sounded like

7. According to the passage, what advantage did the kerosene patented by Gesner have over camphene?
   (A) Kerosene had a more pleasant smell.
   (B) Kerosene was less expensive.
   (C) Kerosene burned more brightly.
   (D) Kerosene was safer to use.

8. The word "it" in line 20 refers to
   (A) fortune
   (B) odor
   (C) camphene
   (D) kerosene

9. Which of the following best describes the organization of the passage?
   (A) A description of events in chronological order
   (B) A comparison of two events
   (C) The statement of a theory and possible explanations
   (D) An analysis of scientific findings

10. Where in the passage does the author mention the origin of a word?
    (A) Lines 4-6
    (B) Lines 7-8
    (C) Lines 12-13
    (D) Lines 16-19

Questions 11 – 21

The penny press, which emerged in the United States during the 18-30's, was a powerful agent of mass communication. These newspapers were little dailies, generally four pages in length, written for the mass taste. They differed from the staid, formal presentation of the conservative press, with its emphasis on political and literary topics. The new papers were brief and cheap, emphasizing sensational reports of police courts and juicy scandals as well as human interest stories. Twentieth-century journalism was already foreshadowed in the penny press of the 1830's.

The *New York Sun,* founded in 1833, was the first successful penny paper, and it was followed two years later by the *New York Herald,* published by James Gordon Bennett. Not long after, Horace Greeley issued the *New York Tribune,* which was destined to become the most influential paper in America. Greeley gave space to the issues that deeply touched the American people before the Civil War —abolitionism, temperance, free homesteads, Utopian cooperative settlements, and the problems of labor. The weekly edition of the *Tribune,* with 100,000 subscribers, had a remarkable influence in rural areas, especially in Western communities.

Americans were reputed to be the most avid readers of periodicals in the world. An English observer enviously calculated that, in 1829, the number of newspapers circulated in Great Britain was enough to reach only one out of every thirty-six inhabitants weekly; Pennsylvania in that same year had a newspaper circulation which reached one out of every four inhabitants weekly. Statistics seemed to justify the common belief that Americans were devoted to periodicals. Newspapers in the United States increased from 1,200 in 1833 to 3,000 by the early 1860' s, on the eve of the Civil War. This far exceeded the number and circulation of newspapers in England and France.

11. What is the author's main point in the first paragraph?
    (A) The penny press was modeled on earlier papers.
    (B) The press in the nineteenth century reached only a small proportion of the population.
    (C) The penny press became an important way of disseminating information in the first half of the nineteenth century.
    (D) The penny press focused mainly on analysis of politics.

12. What does the author mean by the statement in lines 6-7 that twentieth-century journalism was foreshadowed by the penny press?
    (A) The penny press darkened the reputation of news writing.
    (B) Twentieth-century journalism is more important than nineteenth-century journalism.
    (C) Penny-press news reporting was more accurate than that in twentieth-century newspapers.
    (D) Modern news coverage is similar to that done by the penny press.

13. Which of the following would LEAST likely be in a penny-press paper?
    (A) A report of theft of union funds by company officials
    (B) An article about a little girl returning a large amount of money she found in the street
    (C) A scholarly analysis of an economic issue of national importance
    (D) A story about land being given away in the West

14. The word "it" in line 8 refers to
    (A) the New York Sun
    (B) the New York Herald
    (C) America
    (D) the Civil War

15. Who was Horace Greeley (line 10)?
    (A) The publisher of the first penny-press paper to make a profit
    (B) The founder of the penny-press paper that did the most to influence the thinking of the public
    (C) The most successful writer for the penny press
    (D) The man who took over James Gordon Bennett's penny-press paper and made it successful

16. The word "remarkable" in line 14 is closest in meaning to
    (A) significant
    (B) discussable
    (C) remote
    (D) uneven

17. The word "avid" in line 16 is closest in meaning to
    (A) intelligent
    (B) eager
    (C) critical
    (D) thrifty

18. The figures concerning newspaper circulation in Pennsylvania in 1829 are relevant because they
    (A) explain why so many different periodicals were published
    (B) prove that weekly periodicals were more successful than daily papers
    (C) show the difference between reading habits before and after the Civil War
    (D) support the belief that Americans were enthusiastic readers of periodicals

19. The word "justify" in line 20 is closest in meaning to
    (A) generate
    (B) calculate
    (C) modify
    (D) prove

20. The third paragraph is developed primarily by means of
    (A) descriptions
    (B) contrasts
    (C) ordering events in time sequence
    (D) analysis of a process

21. It can be inferred that penny-press newspapers were all of the following EXCEPT
    (A) inexpensive
    (B) informal
    (C) profitable
    (D) thorough

Questions 22 – 34

Broad-tailed hummingbirds often nest in quaking aspens, slender deciduous trees with smooth, gray-green bark found in the Colorado Rockies of the western United States. After flying some 2,000 kilometers north from where they have wintered in Mexico, the hummingbirds need six weeks to build a nest, incubate their eggs, and raise the chicks. A second nest is feasible only if the first fails early in the season. Quality, not quantity, is what counts in hummingbird reproduction.

A nest on the lowest intact branch of an aspen will give a hummingbird a good view, a clear flight path, and protection for her young. Male hummingbirds claim feeding territories in open meadows where, from late May through June, they mate with females coming to feed but take no part in nesting. Thus when the hen is away to feed, the nest is unguarded. While the smooth bark of the aspen trunk generally offers a poor grip for the claws of a hungry squirrel or weasel, aerial attacks, from a hawk, owl, or gray jay, are more likely.

The choice of where to build the nest is based not only on the branch itself but also on what hangs over it. A crooked deformity in the nest branch, a second, unusually close branch overhead, or proximity to part of a trunk bowed by a past ice storm are features that provide shelter and make for an attractive nest site. Scarcely larger than a halved golf ball, the nest is painstakingly constructed of spiderwebs and plant down, decorated and camouflaged outside with paper-like bits of aspen bark held together with more strands of spider silk. By early June it will hold two pea-sized eggs, which each weigh one-seventh of the mother's weight, and in sixteen to nineteen days, two chicks.

22. What aspect of broad-tailed hummingbird behavior does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) Migration routes
    (B) Mating habits
    (C) Caring for the young
    (D) Selection of nest sites

23. According to the passage, in what circumstances do hummingbirds build a second nest?
    (A) If the winter is unusually warm
    (B) If the chicks in the first nest hatch early
    (C) If there is an unusually large supply of food
    (D) If the eggs are destroyed early in the season

24. The word "counts" in line 6 is closest in meaning to
    (A) weighs
    (B) estimates
    (C) matters
    (D) numbers

25. The word "clear" in line 8 is closest in meaning to
    (A) bright
    (B) exact
    (C) unobstructed
    (D) transparent

26. The word "they" in line 9 refers to
    (A) male hummingbirds
    (B) territories
    (C) meadows
    (D) females

27. According to the passage, which of the following is true of the male broad-tailed hummingbird?
    (A) It finds food for the female and the chicks.
    (B) It protects the nest while the female searches for food.
    (C) It is not involved in caring for the chicks.
    (D) It shares nesting duties equally with the female.

28. It can be inferred from the passage that the broad-tailed hummingbirds' eggs and chicks are most vulnerable to attacks by
    (A) insects
    (B) humans
    (C) birds
    (D) squirrels

29. Which of the following would be a good location for a broad-tailed hummingbird to build its nest?
    (A) A branch near the top of a tree
    (B) The longest branch of a tree
    (C) A thick branch
    (D) A protected branch

30. The word "Scarcely" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) obviously
    (B) barely
    (C) consistently
    (D) needlessly

31. Which of the following was NOT mentioned in the passage as a nest-building material of the broad-tailed hummingbird?
    (A) Paper
    (B) Plant down
    (C) Spiderwebs
    (D) Tree bark

32. The author compares the size of the broad-tailed hummingbird's nest to
    (A) a pea
    (B) a golf ball
    (C) a spiderweb
    (D) an egg

33. According to the passage, how long does it take for broad-tailed hummingbird eggs to hatch?
    (A) Less than a week
    (B) Two to three weeks
    (C) One month
    (D) More than six weeks

34. Where in the passage does the author mention the number of eggs generally found in the nests of broad-tailed hummingbirds?
    (A) Line 5
    (B) Lines 10-11
    (C) Lines 15-17
    (D) Lines 20-22

Questions 35 – 40

The ice sheet that blanketed much of North America during the last glaciation was in the areas of maximum accumulation more than a mile thick. Everywhere the glacier lay, its work is evident today. Valleys were scooped out and rounded by the moving ice; peaks were scraped clean. Huge quantities of rock were torn from the northern lands and carried south. Long, high east-west ridges of this eroded debris were deposited by the ice at its melting southern margin. Furthermore, the weight of the huge mass of ice depressed the crust of the Earth in some parts of Canada by over a thousand feet. The crust is still rebounding from that depression.

In North America, perhaps the most conspicuous features of the postglacial landscape are the Great Lakes on the border between the United States and Canada. No other large freshwater body lies at such favorable latitudes. The history of the making of these lakes is long and complex.

As the continental ice sheet pushed down from its primary centers of accumulation in Canada, it moved forward in lobes of ice that followed the existing lowlands. Before the coming of the ice, the basins of the present Great Lakes were simply the lowest-lying regions of a gently undulating plain. The moving tongues of ice scoured and deepened these lowlands as the glacier made its way toward its eventual terminus near the present Ohio and Missouri rivers.

About 16,000 years ago the ice sheet stood for a long time with its edge just to the south of the present great Lakes. Erosional debris carried by the moving ice was dumped at the melting southern edge of the glacier and built up long ridges called terminal moraines. When the ice began to melt back from this position about 14,000 years ago, meltwater collected behind the dams formed by the moraines. The crust behind the moraines was still depressed from the weight of the ice it had borne, and this too helped create the Great Lakes. The first of these lakes drained southward across Illinois and Indiana, along the channels of the present Illinois and Wabash rivers.

35. With what topic is the passage primarily concerned?
    (A) The formation of the Great Lakes
    (B) How geographical structures develop
    (C) Damage done by the last ice age
    (D) How the last ice age developed

36. The glaciers discussed in this passage traveled
    (A) north to south
    (B) south to north
    (C) east to west
    (D) west to east

37. The word "its" in line 6 refers to
    (A) margin
    (B) ice
    (C) rock
    (D) valley

38. According to the passage, the weight of the ice had its greatest direct effect upon the continent's
    (A) crust
    (B) plain
    (C) rivers
    (D) peaks

39. In line 11, the word "lies" could best be replaced by which of the following?
    (A) reclines
    (B) is located
    (C) originates
    (D) expands

40. According to the passage, at the time of glacial movement the basins of the present Great Lakes were
    (A) low-lying
    (B) small
    (C) hilly
    (D) flat

Questions 41 – 50

In the two decades between 1929 and 1949, sculpture in the United States sustained what was probably the greatest expansion in sheer technique to occur in many centuries. There was, first of all, the incorporation of welding into sculptural practice, with the result that it was possible to form a new kind of metal object. For sculptors working with metal, earlier restricted to the dense solidity of the bronze cast, it was possible to add a type of work assembled from paper-thin metal sheets or sinuously curved rods. Sculpture could take the form of a linear, two-dimensional frame and still remain physically self-supporting. Along with the innovation of welding came a correlative departure: freestanding sculpture that was shockingly flat.

Yet another technical expansion of the options for sculpture appeared in the guise of motion. The individual parts of a sculpture were no longer understood as necessarily fixed in relation to one another, but could be made to change position within a work constructed as a moving object. Motorizing the sculpture was only one of many possibilities taken up in the 1930's. Other strategies for getting the work to move involved structuring it in such a way that external forces, like air movements or the touch of a viewer, could initiate motion. Movement brought with it a new attitude toward the issue of sculptural unity: a work might be made of widely diverse and even discordant elements; their formal unity would be achieved through the arc of a particular motion completing itself through time.

Like the use of welding and movement, the third of these major technical expansions to develop in the 1930's and 1940's addressed the issues of sculptural materials and sculptural unity. But its medium for doing so was the found object, an item not intended for use in a piece of artwork, such as a newspaper or metal pipe. To create a sculpture by assembling parts that had been fabricated originally for a quite different context did not necessarily involve a new technology. But it did mean a change in sculptural practice, for it raised the possibility that making sculpture might involve more a conceptual shift than a physical transformation of the material from which it is composed.

41. The word "innovation" in line 8 is closest in meaning to
    (A) limitation
    (B) important concept
    (C) use
    (D) new idea

42. It could be inferred that between 1929 and 1949 sculptors changed in what way?
    (A) They depended less on patrons to finance their work.
    (B) They were less imaginative in their designs.
    (C) They exhibited sculpture more often outside than in galleries.
    (D) They used a wider variety of materials and techniques.

43. It can be inferred that which of the following happened when sculptors began to use welding as a technique?
    (A) Some sculpture became lighter and thinner.
    (B) Sculpture became more expensive to create.
    (C) Sculptors took more time to complete their work.
    (D) Sculpture became more ornate.

44. The word "initiate" in line 16 is closest in meaning to
    (A) cause
    (B) alter
    (C) hinder
    (D) prolong

45. The word "it" in line 16 refers to
    (A) viewer
    (B) movement
    (C) attitude
    (D) issue

46. According to the passage, how did the use of motion affect sculpture?
    (A) It caused the old materials to be discarded.
    (B) It required sculptors to collaborate with engineers.
    (C) It changed the concept of sculptural unity.
    (D) It forced sculptors to weld all parts permanently.

47. The word "diverse" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) dissimilar
    (B) unappealing
    (C) unreliable
    (D) distinctive

48. What is the main idea of the third paragraph?
    (A) Found objects make unattractive sculptures.
    (B) Sculptors looked for found objects in garbage cans.
    (C) The use of found objects changed the way sculpture is created.
    (D) Sculptors who used found objects enjoyed great success.

49. The word "fabricated" in line 24 is closest in meaning to
    (A) enlarged
    (B) made
    (C) ordered
    (D) revealed

50. Which of the following was NOT a new technique developed during this period?
    (A) Creating sculptures that move
    (B) Welding metal pieces together
    (C) Including found objects in sculpture
    (D) Making a bronze cast

Practice Test F– Answers

Number	Answer
1	B
2	B
3	D
4	D
5	C
6	A
7	B
8	D
9	A
10	D
11	C
12	C
13	D
14	C
15	A
16	B
17	B
18	D
19	D
20	B
21	D
22	D
23	D
24	C
25	C
26	A
27	C
28	C
29	D
30	B
31	A
32	B
33	B
34	D
35	A
36	A
37	A
38	B
39	A
40	B

41	A
42	D
43	A
44	A
45	B
46	C
47	A
48	C
49	B
50	D

Practice Test G - Reading

Questions 1 – 11

The United States Constitution makes no provision for the nomination of candidates for the presidency. As the framers of the Constitution set up the system, the electors would, out of their own knowledge, select the "wisest and best" as President. But the rise of political parties altered that system drastically —and with the change came the need for nominations.

The first method that the parties developed to nominate presidential candidates was the congressional caucus, a small group of members of Congress. That method was regularly used in the elections of 1800 to 1824. But its closed character led to its downfall in the mid-1820's. For the election of 1832, both major parties turned to the national convention as their nominating device. It has continued to serve them ever since.

With the convention process, the final selection of the President is, for all practical purposes, narrowed to one of two persons: the Republican or the Democratic party nominee. Yet there is almost no legal control of that vital process.

The Constitution is silent on the subject of presidential nominations. There is, as well, almost no statutory law on the matter. The only provisions in federal law have to do with the financing of conventions. And in each state there is only a small body of laws that deal with issues related to the convention, such as the choosing of delegates and the manner in which they may cast their votes. In short, the convention is very largely a creation and a responsibility of the political parties themselves.

In both the Republican and Democratic parties, the national committee is charged with making the plans and arrangements for the national convention. As much as a year before it is held, the committee meets (usually in Washington, D.C.) to set the time and place for the convention. July has been the favored month; but each party has met in convention as early as mid-June and also as late as the latter part of August.

Where the convention is held is a matter of prime importance. There must be an adequate convention hall, sufficient hotel accommodations, plentiful entertainment outlets, and efficient transportation facilities.

1. Which of the following motivated a change in the original method of selecting a President of the United States?
   (A) The framers of the Constitution
   (B) The rise of the congressional caucus
   (C) The emergence of the party system
   (D) The establishment of national conventions

2. When was the congressional caucus used?
   (A) In the early 1800's
   (B) During the election of 1832
   (C) Throughout the nineteenth century
   (D) In several recent elections

3. What can be inferred about why the congressional caucus system was terminated?
   (A) It was too expensive.
   (B) It took too much time.
   (C) It did not conform to the Constitution.
   (D) It did not include enough citizens.

4. The word "them" in line 10 refers to
   (A) conventions
   (B) parties
   (C) elections
   (D) candidates

5. The word "Yet" in line 13 indicates that what follows is
   (A) an unexpected fact
   (B) a personal observation
   (C) a list
   (D) an example

6. The word "vital" in line 13 is closest in meaning to
   (A) extremely important
   (B) always accessible
   (C) political
   (D) optional

7. According to the passage, the only aspect of political conventions addressed by federal law involves
   (A) organization
   (B) choosing delegates
   (C) voting procedures
   (D) funding

8. In paragraph 4, the author compares
   (A) nominations and conventions
   (B) finances and the Constitution
   (C) delegates and candidates
   (D) federal and state laws

9. The words "charged with" in lines 20-21 are closest in meaning to
   (A) responsible for
   (B) excited about
   (C) blamed for
   (D) in favor of

10. The passage refers to all of the following as necessary in the city where the convention is held EXCEPT
    (A) an acceptable meeting place
    (B) politically aware citizens
    (C) an easy way of traveling around the city
    (D) sufficient amusement opportunities

11. Where in the passage does the author refer to the original method of selecting a president?
    (A) Lines 2-3
    (B) Lines 11-13
    (C) Lines 18-19
    (D) Lines 20-21

Questions 12 – 17

Several hundred million years ago, plants similar to modern ferns covered vast stretches of the land. Some were as large as trees, with giant fronds bunched at the top of trunks as straight as pillars. Others were the size of bushes and formed thickets of me undergrowth. Still others lived in the shade of giant club mosses and horsetails along the edges of swampy lagoons where giant amphibians swam.

A great number of these plants were true ferns, reproducing themselves without fruits or seeds. Others had only the appearance of ferns. Their leaves had organs of sexual reproduction and produced seeds. Although their "flowers" did not have corollas these false ferns (today completely extinct) ushered in the era of flowering plants.

Traces of these flora of the earliest times have been preserved in the form of fossils. Such traces are most commonly found in shale and sandstone rocks wedged between coal beds.

Today only tropical forests bear living proof of the ancient greatness of ferns. The species that grow there are no longer those of the Carboniferous period, but their variety and vast numbers, and the great size of some, remind us of the time when ferns ruled the plant kingdom.

12. What does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) Plant reproduction
    (B) How to locate fossils
    (C) An ancient form of plant life
    (D) Tropical plant life

13. The word "others" in line 3 refers to
    (A) plants
    (B) pillars
    (C) trees
    (D) fronds

14. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a characteristic of the plants described in the passage?
    (A) They once spread over large areas of land.
    (B) They varied greatly in size.
    (C) They coexisted with amphibians, mosses, and horsetails.
    (D) They clung to tree trunks and bushes for support

15. The word "true" in line 6 is closest in meaning to which of the following?
    (A) accurate
    (B) genuine
    (C) straight
    (D) dependable

16. The author states that fossils of early plant life are usually found in rocks located between deposits of
    (A) coal
    (B) shale
    (C) sandstone
    (D) corollas

17. The word "bear" in line 13 could best be replaced by which of the following?
    (A) call for
    (B) provide
    (C) tolerate
    (D) suffer

Questions 18 – 28

The economic expansion prompted by the Second World War triggered a spectacular population boom in the West. Of course, the region was no stranger to population booms. Throughout much of its history, western settlement had been characterized by spurts, rather than by a pattern of gradual and steady population growth, beginning with the gold and silver rushes of the 1850's and 1860's. The decade after the First World War —the 1920's —witnessed another major surge of people pouring into the West, particularly into urban areas. But the economic depression of the 1930's brought this expansion to a halt; some of the more sparsely settled parts of the region actually lost population as migrants sought work in more heavily industrialized areas. By 1941, when the United States entered the Second World War and began to mobilize, new job opportunities were created in the western part of the nation.

If the expansion of industries, such as shipbuilding and aircraft manufacturing, was most striking on the Pacific coast, it also affected interior cities like Denver, Phoenix, and Salt Lake City. Equally dramatic were the effects of the establishment of aluminum plants in Oregon and Washington and the burgeoning steel industry in Utah and California. The flow of people into these areas provided an enormous impetus to the expansion of the service industries —banks, health care services, and schools. Although strained to the limit by the influx of newcomers, western communities welcomed the vast reservoir of new job opportunities. At the same time, the unprecedented expansion of government installations in the West, such as military bases, created thousands of new civilian openings. As land had served as a magnet for western migrants in the late nineteenth century, so wartime mobilization set in motion another major expansion of population. Indeed, it could be said that the entire western United States became a giant boomtown during the Second World War. This was especially true of California. Of the more than eight million people who moved into the West in the decade after 1940, almost one-half went to the Pacific coast. In fact, between 1940 and 1950, California's population surged by more than three million people.

18. What is the main point of the passage?
    (A) California dominated the economic growth of the West during the Second World War.
    (B) Industrial growth during the 1940's attracted large numbers of people to the West.
    (C) The military drew people away from civilian jobs during the 1940's.
    (D) The West experienced gradual and steady economic growth from 1900 to 1940.

19. The word "triggered" in line 1 is closest in meaning to
    (A) was connected to
    (B) generated
    (C) interfered with
    (D) illuminated

20. Why does the author mention "the gold and silver rushes of the 1850's and 1860's" in the first paragraph?
    (A) As causes of gradual population growth
    (B) As contrasts to later patterns of population growth
    (C) As illustrations of a market economy
    (D) As examples of western population booms

21. Which of the following occurred in the West during the 1920's?
    (A) Gold and silver deposits were discovered.
    (B) The population density gradually increased.
    (C) The population of the cities increased significantly.
    (D) Many military bases were established.

22. According to the passage, the depression of the 1930's caused which of the following?
    (A) A lack of population growth in the West
    (B) The building of new suburbs
    (C) A creation of more job opportunities
    (D) A growth in immigration from abroad

23. Which of the following statements about the shipbuilding industry is suggested by the passage?
    (A) It came into being during the First World War.
    (B) Many new shipbuilding yards were established on the Pacific coast during the 1940's.
    (C) Denver was considered to be a poor location for shipbuilding factories.
    (D) Shipbuilding was the dominant industry in Oregon and Washington.

24. The word "it" in line 13 refers to
    (A) expansion
    (B) Denver
    (C) manufacturing
    (D) the Pacific coast

25. The word "enormous" in line 16 is closest in meaning to
    (A) unexpected
    (B) immense
    (C) adequate
    (D) important

26. The passage suggests that industrialization in the West led to all of the following EXCEPT
    (A) A reduction in the price of land
    (B) An increase in school construction
    (C) Improved access to doctors
    (D) An increase in the number of banks

27. According to the passage, what was one result of the building of new military bases in the West in the 1940's?
    (A) Military bases in other parts of the United States were closed.
    (B) Many settlers were forced off their land.
    (C) Many civilian jobs were created.
    (D) The cost of living rose sharply in California and other western states.

28. It can be inferred from the passage that the principal cause of California's population surge between 1940 and 1950 was
    (A) the increased availability of land
    (B) people's desire to live in a warm, coastal climate
    (C) the industrial mobilization necessitated by the Second World War
    (D) overcrowding in urban areas in other regions of the United States

Questions 29 – 39

For 150 years scientists have tried to determine the solar constant, the amount of solar energy that reaches the Earth. Yet, even in the most cloud-free regions of the planet, the solar constant cannot be measured precisely. Gas molecules and dust particles in the atmosphere absorb and scatter sunlight and prevent some wavelengths of the light from ever reaching the ground.

With the advent of satellites, however, scientists have finally been able to measure the Sun's output without being impeded by the Earth's atmosphere. Solar Max, a satellite from the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA), has been measuring the Sun's output since February 1980. Although a malfunction in the satellite's control system limited its observation for a few years, the satellite was repaired in orbit by astronauts from the space shuttle in 1984. Max's observations indicate that the solar constant is not really constant after all.

The satellite's instruments have detected frequent, small variations in the Sun's energy output, generally amounting to no more than 0.05 percent of the Sun's mean energy output and lasting from a few days to a few weeks. Scientists believe these fluctuations coincide with the appearance and disappearance of large groups of sunspots on the Sun's disk. Sunspots are relatively dark regions on the Sun's surface that have strong magnetic fields and a temperature about 2,000 degrees Fahrenheit cooler than the rest of the Sun's surface. Particularly large fluctuations in the solar constant have coincided with sightings of large sunspot groups. In 1980, for example, Solar Max's instruments registered a 0.3 percent drop in the solar energy reaching the Earth. At that time a sunspot group covered about 0.6 percent of the solar disk, an area 20 times larger than the Earth's surface.

Long-term variations in the solar constant are more difficult to determine. Although Solar Max's data have indicated a slow and steady decline in the Sun's output, some scientists have thought that the satellite's aging detectors might have become less sensitive over the years, thus falsely indicating a drop in the solar constant. This possibility was dismissed, however, by comparing Solar Max's observations with data from a similar instrument operating on NASA's Nimbus 7 weather satellite since 1978.

29. What does this passage mainly discuss?
    (A) The launching of a weather satellite
    (B) The components of the Earth's atmosphere
    (C) The measurement of variations in the solar constant
    (D) The interaction of sunlight and air pollution

30. Why does the author mention "gas" and "dust" in line 3?
    (A) They magnify the solar constant.
    (B) They are found in varying concentrations.
    (C) Scientific equipment is ruined by gas and dust.
    (D) They interfere with accurate measurement of the solar constant.

31. Why is it not possible to measure the solar constant accurately without a satellite?
    (A) The Earth is too far from the Sun.
    (B) Some areas on Earth receive more solar energy than others.
    (C) There is not enough sunlight during the day.
    (D) The Earth's atmosphere interferes with the sunlight.

32. The word "scatter" in line 4 is closest in meaning to
    (A) emit
    (B) capture
    (C) transform
    (D) disperse

33. The word "its" in line 10 refers to the
    (A) orbit
    (B) atmosphere
    (C) satellite
    (D) malfunction

34. The word "detected" in line 13 is closest in meaning to
    (A) estimated
    (B) disregarded
    (C) registered
    (D) predicted

35. According to the passage, scientists believe variations in the solar constant are related to
    (A) sunspot activity
    (B) unusual weather patterns
    (C) increased levels of dust
    (D) fluctuations in the Earth's temperature

36. The word "decline" in line 25 is closest in meaning to
    (A) fall
    (B) reversal
    (C) release
    (D) fluctuation

37. Why did scientists think that Solar Max might be giving unreliable information?
    (A) Solar Max did not work for the first few years.
    (B) The space shuttle could not fix Solar Max's instruments.
    (C) Solar Max's instruments were getting old.
    (D) Nimbus 7 interfered with Solar Max's detectors.

38. The phrase "This possibility" in line 27 refers to the likelihood that the
    (A) solar constant has declined
    (B) Nimbus 7 satellite is older than Solar Max
    (C) solar constant cannot be measured
    (D) instruments are providing inaccurate data

39. The attempt to describe the solar constant can best be described as
    (A) an ongoing research effort
    (B) an issue that has been resolved
    (C) a question that can never be answered
    (D) historically interesting, but irrelevant to contemporary concerns

Questions 40 – 50

Even before the turn of the century, movies began to develop in two major directions: the realistic and the formalistic. Realism and formalism are merely general, rather than absolute, terms. When used to suggest a tendency toward either polarity, such labels can be helpful, but in the end they are still just labels. Few films are exclusively formalist in style, and fewer yet are completely realist. There is also an important difference between realism and reality, although this distinction is often forgotten. Realism is a particular style, whereas physical reality is the source of all the raw materials of film, both realistic and formalistic. Virtually all movie directors go to the photographable world for their subject matter, but what they do with this material —how they shape and manipulate it — determines their stylistic emphasis.

Generally speaking, realistic films attempt to reproduce the surface of concrete reality with a minimum of distortion. In photographing objects and events, the filmmaker tries to suggest the copiousness of life itself. Both realist and formalist film directors must select (and hence emphasize) certain details from the chaotic sprawl of reality. But the element of selectivity in realistic films is less obvious. Realists, in short, try to preserve the illusion that their film world is unmanipulated, an objective mirror of the actual world. Formalists, on the other hand, make no such pretense. They deliberately stylize and distort their raw materials so that only the very naive would mistake a manipulated image of an object or event for the real thing.

We rarely notice the style in a realistic movie; the artist tends to be self-effacing. Some filmmakers are more concerned with what is being shown than how it is manipulated. The camera is used conservatively. It is essentially a recording mechanism that reproduces the surface of tangible objects with as little commentary as possible. A high premium is placed on simplicity, spontaneity, and directness. This is not to suggest that these movies lack artistry, however, for at its best the realistic cinema specializes in art that conceals art.

40. What does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) Acting styles
    (B) Film plots
    (C) Styles of filmmaking
    (D) Filmmaking 100 years ago

41. With which of the following statements would the author be most likely to agree?
    (A) Realism and formalism are outdated terms.
    (B) Most films are neither exclusively realistic nor formalistic.
    (C) Realistic films are more popular than formalistic ones.
    (D) Formalistic films are less artistic than realistic ones.

42. The phrase "this distinction" in line 6 refers to the difference between
    (A) formalists and realists
    (B) realism and reality
    (C) general and absolute
    (D) physical reality and raw materials

43. Whom does the author say is primarily responsible for the style of a film?
    (A) The director
    (B) The actors
    (C) The producer
    (D) The camera operator

44. The word "shape" in line 9 is closest in meaning to
    (A) specify
    (B) form
    (C) understand
    (D) achieve

45. The word "preserve" in line 15 is closest in meaning to
    (A) encourage
    (B) maintain
    (C) reflect
    (D) attain

46. The word 'They" in line 17 refers to
    (A) films
    (B) realists
    (C) formalists
    (D) raw materials

47. How can one recognize the formalist style?
    (A) It uses familiar images.
    (B) It is very impersonal.
    (C) It obviously manipulates images.
    (D) It mirrors the actual world.

48. The word "tangible" in line 23 is closest in meaning to
    (A) concrete
    (B) complex
    (C) various
    (D) comprehensible

49. Which of the following terms is NOT used to describe realism in filmmaking?
    (A) Simple
    (B) Spontaneous
    (C) Self-effacing
    (D) Exaggerated

50. Which of the following films would most likely use a realist style?
    (A) A travel documentary
    (B) A science fiction film
    (C) A musical drama
    (D) An animated cartoon

Practice Test G- Answers

Number	Answers
1	C
2	A
3	D
4	B
5	A
6	A
7	D
8	D
9	A
10	B
11	A
12	C
13	A
14	D
15	B
16	A
17	B
18	B
19	B
20	D
21	C
22	A
23	B
24	A
25	B
26	A
27	C
28	C
29	C
30	D
31	D
32	D
33	C
34	C
35	A
36	A
37	C
38	D
39	A
40	C

41	B
42	B
43	A
44	B
45	B
46	C
47	C
48	A
49	D
50	A

Practice Test H - Reading

Questions 1 - 10

The word laser was coined as an acronym for Light Amplification by the Stimulated Emission of Radiation. Ordinary light, from the Sun or a light bulb, is emitted spontaneously, when atoms or molecules get rid of excess energy by themselves, without any outside intervention. Stimulated emission is different because it occurs when an atom or molecule holding onto excess energy has been stimulated to emit it as light.

Albert Einstein was the first to suggest the existence of stimulated emission in a paper published in 1917. However, for many years physicists thought that atoms and molecules always were much more likely to emit light spontaneously and that stimulated emission thus always would be much weaker. It was not until after the Second World War that physicists began trying to make stimulated emission dominate. They sought ways by which one atom or molecule could stimulate many others to emit light, amplifying it to much higher powers.

The first to succeed was Charles H. Townes, then at Columbia University in New York. Instead of working with light, however, he worked with microwaves, which have a much longer wavelength, and built a device he called a "maser," for Microwave Amplification by the Stimulated Emission of Radiation. Although he thought of the key idea in 1951, the first maser was not completed until a couple of years later. Before long, many other physicists were building masers and trying to discover how to produce stimulated emission at even shorter wavelengths.

The key concepts emerged about 1957. Townes and Arthur Schawlow, then at Bell Telephone Laboratories, wrote a long paper outlining the conditions needed to amplify stimulated emission of visible light waves. At about the same time, similar ideas crystallized in the mind of Gordon Gould, then a 37-year-old graduate student at Columbia, who wrote them down in a series of notebooks. Townes and Schawlow published their ideas in a scientific journal, *physical Review Letters,* but Gould filed a patent application. Three decades later, people still argue about who deserves the credit for the concept of the laser.

1. The word "coined" in line 1 could best be replaced by
   (A) created
   (B) mentioned
   (C) understood
   (D) discovered

2. The word "intervention" in line 4 can best be replaced by
   (A) need
   (B) device
   (C) influence
   (D) source

3. The word “it” in line 5 refers to
   (A) light bulb
   (B) energy
   (C) molecule
   (D) atom

4. Which of the following statements best describes a laser?
   (A) A device for stimulating atoms and molecules to emit light
   (B) An atom in a high-energy state
   (C) A technique for destroying atoms or molecules
   (D) An instrument for measuring light waves

5. Why was Towne's early work with stimulated emission done with microwaves?
   (A) He was not concerned with light amplification.
   (B) It was easier to work with longer wavelengths.
   (C) His partner Schawlow had already begun work on the laser.
   (D) The laser had already been developed.

6. In his research at Columbia University, Charles Townes worked with all of the following EXCEPT
   (A) stimulated emission
   (B) microwaves
   (C) light amplification
   (D) a maser

7. In approximately what year was the first maser built?
   (A) 1917
   (B) 1951
   (C) 1953
   (D) 1957

8. The word “emerged” in line 20 is closest in meaning to
   (A) increased
   (B) concluded
   (C) succeeded
   (D) appeared

9. The word “outlining” in line 21 is closest in meaning to
   (A) assigning
   (B) studying
   (C) checking
   (D) summarizing

10. Why do people still argue about who deserves the credit for the concept of the laser?
    (A) The researchers' notebooks were lost.
    (B) Several people were developing the idea at the same time.
    (C) No one claimed credit for the development until recently.
    (D) The work is still incomplete.

Questions 11 – 21

Panel painting, common in thirteenth- and fourteenth-century Europe, involved a painstaking, laborious process. Wooden planks were joined, covered with gesso to prepare the surface for painting, and then polished smooth with special tools. On this perfect surface, the artist would sketch a composition with chalk, refine it with inks, and then begin the deliberate process of applying thin layers of egg tempera paint (egg yolk in which pigments are suspended) with small brushes. The successive layering of these meticulously applied paints produced the final, translucent colors.

Backgrounds of gold were made by carefully applying sheets of gold leaf, and then embellishing or decorating the gold leaf by punching it with a metal rod on which a pattern had been embossed. Every step in the process was slow and deliberate. The quick-drying tempera demanded that the artist know exactly where each stroke be placed before the brush met the panel, and it required the use of fine brushes. It was, therefore, an ideal technique for emphasizing the hard linear edges and pure, fine areas of color that were so much a part of the overall aesthetic of the time. The notion that an artist could or would dash off an idea in a fit of spontaneous inspiration was completed alien to these deliberately produced works.

Furthermore, making these paintings was so time-consuming that it demanded assistance. All such work was done by collective enterprise in the workshops. The painter or master who is credited with having created the painting may have designed the work and overseen its production, but it is highly unlikely that the artist's hand applied every stroke of the brush. More likely, numerous assistants, who had been trained to imitate the artist's style, applied the paint. The carpenter's shop probably provided the frame and perhaps supplied the panel, and yet another shop supplied the gold. Thus, not only many hands, but also many shops were involved in the final product.

In spite of problems with their condition, restoration, and preservation many panel paintings have survived, and today many of them are housed in museum collections.

11. What aspect of panel paintings does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) Famous examples
    (B) Different styles
    (C) Restoration
    (D) Production

12. According to the passage, what was the first step in making a panel painting?
    (A) Mixing the paint
    (B) Preparing the panel
    (C) Buying the gold leaf
    (D) Making ink drawings

13. The word "it" in line 4 refers to
    (A) chalk
    (B) composition
    (C) artist
    (D) surface

14. The word "deliberate" in line 5 is closest in meaning to
    (A) decisive
    (B) careful
    (C) natural
    (D) unusual

15. Which of the following processes produced the translucent colors found on panel paintings?
    (A) Joining wooden planks to form large sheets
    (B) Polishing the gesso
    (C) Applying many layers of paint
    (D) Covering the background with gold leaf

16. What characteristic of tempera paint is mentioned in the passage?
    (A) It dries quickly.
    (B) It is difficult to make.
    (C) It dissolves easily.
    (D) It has to be applied directly to wood.

17. The word "demanded" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) ordered
    (B) reported
    (C) required
    (D) questioned

18. The "collective enterprise" mentioned in line 18 includes all of the following EXCEPT
    (A) supplying the gold leaf
    (B) building the panels
    (C) applying the paint
    (D) selling the painting

19. The word "imitate" in line 22 is closest in meaning to
    (A) copy
    (B) illustrate
    (C) promote
    (D) believe in

20. The author mentions all of the following as problems with the survival of panel paintings EXCEPT
    (A) condition
    (B) theft
    (C) preservation
    (D) restoration

21. The word "them" in line 27 refers to
    (A) problems
    (B) condition, restoration, preservation
    (C) panel paintings
    (D) museum collections

Questions 22 - 32

Crows are probably the most frequently met and easily identifiable members of the native fauna of the United States. The great number of tales, legends, and myths about these birds indicates that people have been exceptionally interested in them for a long time. On the other hand, when it comes to substantive —particularly behavioral —information, crows are less well known than many comparably common species and, for that matter, not a few quite uncommon ones: the endangered California condor, to cite one obvious example. There are practical reasons for this.

Crows are notoriously poor and aggravating subjects for field research. Keen observers and quick learners, they are astute about the intentions of other creatures, including researchers, and adept at avoiding them. Because they are so numerous, active, and monochromatic, it is difficult to distinguish one crow from another. Bands, radio transmitters, or other identifying devices can be attached to them, but this of course requires catching live crows, who are among the wariest and most untrappable of birds.

Technical difficulties aside, crow research is daunting because the ways of these birds are so complex and various. As preeminent generalists, members of this species ingeniously exploit a great range of habitats and resources, and they can quickly adjust to changes in their circumstances. Being so educable, individual birds have markedly different interests and inclinations, strategies and scams. For example, one pet crow learned how to let a dog out of its kennel by pulling the pin on the door. When the dog escaped, the bird went into the kennel and ate its food.

22. What is the main topic of the passage?
    (A) The ways in which crows differ from other common birds
    (B) The myths and legends about crows
    (C) The characteristics that make crows difficult to study
    (D) The existing methods for investigating crow behavior

23. According to the first paragraph, what evidence is there that crows have interested people for a long time?
    (A) The large number of stories about crows
    (B) The frequency with which crows are sighted
    (C) The amount of research that has been conducted on crows
    (D) The ease with which crows are identified

24. The word "comparably" in line 5 is closest in meaning to
    (A) interestingly
    (B) similarly
    (C) otherwise
    (D) sometimes

25. In line 6, the author mentions the endangered California condor as an example of a species that is
    (A) smaller than the crow
    (B) easily identifiable
    (C) featured in legends
    (D) very rare

26. The word "them" in line 10 refers to
    (A) crows
    (B) subjects
    (C) intentions
    (D) researchers

27. According to the second paragraph crows are poor subjects for field research for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:
    (A) They can successfully avoid observers.
    (B) They are hard to distinguish from one another.
    (C) They can be quite aggressive.
    (D) They are difficult to catch.

28. In the second paragraph, the author implies that using radio transmitters would allow a researcher who studies crows to
    (A) identify individual crows
    (B) follow flocks of crows over long distances
    (C) record the times when crows are most active
    (D) help crows that become sick or injured

29. According to the third paragraph, which of the following is true about crows?
    (A) They seldom live in anyone place for very long.
    (B) They thrive in a wide variety of environments.
    (C) They have marked preferences for certain kinds of foods.
    (D) They use up the resources in one area before moving to another.

30. In line 19, the word "inclinations" is closest in meaning to
    (A) tricks
    (B) opportunities
    (C) preferences
    (D) experiences

31. In lines 19-21, the author mentions a pet crow to illustrate which of the following?
    (A) The clever ways that crows solve problems
    (B) The differences between pet crows and wild crows
    (C) The ease with which crows can be tamed
    (D) The affection that crows show to other creatures

32. Which of the following statements is supported by the passage?
    (A) Crows have relatively long lives.
    (B) Crows have keen vision.
    (C) Crows are usually solitary.
    (D) Crows are very intelligent.

Questions 33 – 41

In the early days of the United States, postal charges were paid by the recipient, and charges varied with the distance carried. In 1825, the United States Congress permitted local postmasters to give letters to mail carriers for home deli very, but these carriers received no government salary and their entire compensation depended on what they were paid by the recipients of individual letters.

In 1847 the United States Post Office Department adopted the idea of a postage stamp, which of course simplified the payment for postal service but caused grumbling by those who did not like to prepay. Besides, the stamp covered only delivery to the post office and did not include carrying it to a private address. In Philadelphia, for example, with a population of 150,000, people still had to go to the post office to get their mail. The confusion and congestion of individual citizens looking for their letters was itself enough to discourage use of the mail. It is no wonder that, during the years of these cumbersome arrangements, private letter-carrying and express businesses developed. Although their activities were only semilegal, they thrived, and actually advertised that between Boston and Philadelphia they were a half-day speedier than the government mail. The government postal service lost volume to private competition and was not able to handle efficiently even the business it had.

Finally, in 1863, Congress provided that the mail carriers who delivered the mail from the post offices to private addresses should receive a government salary, and that there should be no extra charge for that delivery. But this delivery service was at first confined to cities, and free home deli very became a mark of urbanism. As late as 1887, a town had to have 10,000 people to be eligible for free home delivery. In 1890, of the 75 million people in the United States, fewer than 20 million had mail delivered free to their doors. The rest, nearly three-quarters of the population, still received no mail unless they went to their post office.

33. What does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) The increased use of private mail services
    (B) The development of a government postal system
    (C) A comparison of urban and rural postal services
    (D) The history of postage stamps

34. The word "varied" in line 2 could best be replaced by
    (A) increased
    (B) differed
    (C) returned
    (D) started

35. Which of the following was seen as a disadvantage of the postage stamp?
    (A) It had to be purchased by the sender in advance.
    (B) It increased the cost of mail delivery .
    (C) It was difficult to affix to letters.
    (D) It was easy to counterfeit.

36. Why does the author mention the city of Philadelphia in line 9?
    (A) It was the site of the first post office in the United States.
    (B) Its postal service was inadequate for its population.
    (C) It was the largest city in the United States in 1847.
    (D) It was commemorated by the first United States postage stamp.

37. The word "cumbersome" in line 13 is closest in meaning to
    (A) burdensome
    (B) handsome
    (C) loathsome
    (D) quarrelsome

38. The word "they" in line 15 refers to
    (A) Boston and Philadelphia
    (B) businesses
    (C) arrangements
    (D) letters

39. The private postal services of the nineteenth century claimed that they could do which of the following better than the government?
    (A) Deliver a higher volume of mail.
    (B) Deliver mail more cheaply.
    (C) Deliver mail faster.
    (D) Deliver mail to rural areas.

40. In 1863 the United States government began providing which of the following to mail carriers?
    (A) A salary
    (B) Housing
    (C) Transportation
    (D) Free postage stamps

41. The word "confined" in line 21 is closest in meaning to
    (A) granted
    (B) scheduled
    (C) limited
    (D) recommended

Questions 42 – 50

Archaeology has long been an accepted tool for studying prehistoric cultures. Relatively recently the same techniques have been systematically applied to studies of the more immediate past. This has been called "historical archaeology," a term that is used in the United States to refer to any archaeological investigation into North American sites that postdate the arrival of Europeans.

Back in the 1930's and 1940's, when building restoration was popular, historical archaeology was primarily a tool of architectural reconstruction. The role of archaeologist was to find the foundations of historic buildings and then take a back seat to architects.

The mania for reconstruction had largely subsided by the 1950' sand 1960' s. Most people entering historical archaeology during this period came out of university anthropology departments, where they had studied prehistoric cultures. They were, by training, social scientists, not historians, and their work tended to reflect this bias. The questions they framed and the techniques they used were designed to help them understand, as scientists, how people behaved. But because they were treading on historical ground for which there was often extensive written documentation, and because their own knowledge of these periods was usually limited, their contributions to American history remained circumscribed. Their reports, highly technical and sometimes poorly written, went unread.

More recently, professional archaeologists have taken over. These researchers have sought to demonstrate that their work can be a valuable tool not only of science but also of history, providing fresh insights into the daily lives of ordinary people whose existences might not otherwise be so well documented. This newer emphasis on archaeology as social history has shown great promise, and indeed work done in this area has lead to a reinterpretation of the United States past.

In Kingston, New York, for example, evidence has been uncovered that indicates that English goods were being smuggled into that city at a time when the Dutch supposedly controlled trading in the area. And in Sacramento an excavation at the site of a fashionable nineteenth-century hotel revealed that garbage had been stashed in the building's basement despite sanitation laws to the contrary.

42. What does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) Why historical archaeology was first developed
    (B) How the methods and purpose of historical archaeology have changed
    (C) The contributions architects make to historical archaeology
    (D) The attitude of professional archaeologists toward historical archaeology

43. According to the first paragraph, what is a relatively new focus in archaeology?
    (A) Investigating the recent past
    (B) Studying prehistoric cultures
    (C) Excavating ancient sites in what is now the United States
    (D) Comparing findings made in North America and in Europe

44. According to the passage, when had historical archaeologists been trained as anthropologists?
    (A) Prior to the 1930's
    (B) During the 1930's and 1940's
    (C) During the 1950' sand 1960's
    (D) After the 1960's

45. The word "framed" in line 13 is closest in meaning to
    (A) understood
    (B) read
    (C) avoided
    (D) posed

46. In the third paragraph, the author implies that the techniques of history and the techniques of social science are
    (A) quite different from each other
    (B) equally useful in studying prehistoric cultures
    (C) usually taught to students of archaeology
    (D) both based on similar principles

47. The phrase "their contributions" in line 16 refers to the contributions of
    (A) social scientists
    (B) prehistoric cultures
    (C) historians
    (D) documentation and knowledge

48. The author mentions an excavation at the site of a hotel in Sacramento in order to give an example of
    (A) a building reconstruction project
    (B) the work of the earliest historical archaeologists
    (C) a finding that conflicts with written records
    (D) the kind of information that historians routinely examine

49. The word "supposedly" in line 26 is closest in meaning to
    (A) ruthlessly
    (B) tightly
    (C) barely
    (D) seemingly

50. The word "sanitation" in line 29 is closest in meaning to
    (A) city
    (B) housing
    (C) health
    (D) trade

Practice Test H – Answers

Number	Answers
1	A
2	C
3	B
4	A
5	B
6	C
7	C
8	D
9	D
10	B
11	D
12	B
13	B
14	B
15	C
16	A
17	C
18	D
19	A
20	B
21	C
22	C
23	A
24	B
25	D
26	D
27	C
28	A
29	B
30	C
31	A
32	D
33	B
34	B
35	A
36	B
37	A
38	B
39	C
40	A

41	C
42	B
43	A
44	C
45	D
46	A
47	A
48	C
49	D
50	C

Practice Test I - Reading

Questions 1 - 8

It is commonly believed in the United States that school is where people go to get an education. Nevertheless, it has been said that today children interrupt their education to go to school. The distinction between schooling and education implied by this remark is important.

Education is much more open-ended and all-inclusive than schooling. Education knows no bounds. It can take place anywhere, whether in the shower or on the job, whether in a kitchen or on a tractor. It includes both the formal learning that takes place in schools and the whole universe of informal learning. The agents of education can range from a revered grandparent to the people debating politics on the radio, from a child to a distinguished scientist. Whereas schooling has a certain predictability, education quite often produces surprises. A chance conversation with a stranger may lead a person to discover how little is known of other religions. People are engaged in education from infancy on. Education, then, is a very broad, inclusive term. It is a lifelong process, a process that starts long before the start of school, and one that should be an integral part of one's entire life.

Schooling, on the other hand, is a specific, formalized process, whose general pattern varies little from one setting to the next. Throughout a country, children arrive at school at approximately the same time, take assigned seats, are taught by an adult, use similar textbooks, do homework, take exams, and so on. The slices of reality that are to be learned, whether they are the alphabet or an understanding of the workings of government, have usually been limited by the boundaries of the subject being taught. For example, high school students know that they are not likely to find out in their classes the truth about political problems in their communities or what the newest filmmakers are experimenting with. There are definite conditions surrounding the formalized process of schooling.

1. What does the author probably mean by using the expression "children interrupt their education to go to school" (lines 2-3)?
   (A) Going to several different schools is educationally beneficial.
   (B) School vacations interrupt the continuity of the school year.
   (C) Summer school makes the school year too long.
   (D) All of life is an education.

2. The word "bounds" in line 6 is closest in meaning to
   (A) rules
   (B) experiences
   (C) limits
   (D) exceptions

3. The word "chance" in line 11 is closest in meaning to
   (A) unplanned
   (B) unusual
   (C) lengthy
   (D) lively

4. The word "integral" in line 15 is closest in meaning to
   (A) an equitable
   (B) a profitable
   (C) a pleasant
   (D) an essential

5. The word "they" in line 20 refers to
   (A) slices of reality
   (B) similar textbooks
   (C) boundaries
   (D) seats

6. The phrase "For example," line 22, introduces a sentence that gives examples of
   (A) similar textbooks
   (B) the results of schooling
   (C) the workings of a government
   (D) the boundaries of classroom subjects

7. The passage supports which of the following conclusions?
   (A) Without formal education, people would remain ignorant.
   (B) Education systems need to be radically reformed.
   (C) Going to school is only part of how people become educated.
   (D) Education involves many years of professional training.

8. The passage is organized by
   (A) listing and discussing several educational problems
   (B) contrasting the meanings of two related words
   (C) narrating a story about excellent teachers
   (D) giving examples of different kinds of schools

Questions 9 - 17

The hard, rigid plates that form the outermost portion of the Earth are about 100 kilometers thick. These plates include both the Earth's crust and the upper mantle.

The rocks of the crust are composed mostly of minerals with light elements, like aluminum and sodium, while the mantle contains some heavier elements, like iron and magnesium. Together, the crust and upper mantle that form the surface plates are called the lithosphere. This rigid layer floats on the denser material of the lower mantle the way a wooden raft floats on a pond. The plates are supported by a weak, plastic layer of the lower mantle called the asthenosphere. Also like a raft on a pond, the lithospheric plates are carried along by slow currents in this more fluid layer beneath them.

With an understanding of plate tectonics, geologists have put together a new history for the Earth's surface. About 200 million years ago, the plates at the Earth's surface formed a "supercontinent" called Pangaea. When this super continent started to tear apart because of plate movement, Pangaea first broke into two large continental masses with a newly formed sea that grew between the land areas as the depression filled with water. The southern one —which included the modern continents of South America, Africa, Australia, and Antarctica —is called Gondwanaland. The northern one —with North America, Europe, and Asia —is called Laurasia. North America tore away from Europe about 180 million years ago, forming the northern Atlantic Ocean.

Some of the lithospheric plates carry ocean floor and others carry land masses or a combination of the two types. The movement of the lithospheric plates is responsible for earthquakes, volcanoes, and the Earth's largest mountain ranges. Current understanding of the interaction between different plates explains why these occur where they do. For example, the edge of the Pacific Ocean has been called the "Ring of Fire" because so many volcanic eruptions and, earthquakes happen there. Before the 1960' s, geologists could not explain why active volcanoes and strong earthquakes were concentrated in that region. The theory of plate tectonics gave them an answer.

9. With which of the following topics is the passage mainly concerned?
   (A) The contributions of the theory of plate tectonics to geological knowledge
   (B) The mineral composition of the Earth's crust
   (C) The location of the Earth's major plates
   (D) The methods used by scientists to measure plate movement

10. According to the passage, the lithospheric plates are given support by the
   (A) upper mantle
   (B) ocean floor
   (C) crust
   (D) asthenosphere

11. The author compares the relationship between the lithosphere and the asthenosphere to which of the following?
    (A) Lava flowing from a volcano
    (B) A boat floating on the water
    (C) A fish swimming in a pond
    (D) The erosion of rocks by running water

12. The word "one" in line 16 refers to
    (A) movements
    (B) masses
    (C) sea
    (D) depression

13. According to the passage, the northern Atlantic Ocean was formed when
    (A) Pangaea was created
    (B) plate movement ceased
    (C) Gondwanaland collided with Pangaea
    (D) parts of Laurasia separated from each other

14. The word "carry" in line 20 could best be replaced by
    (A) damage
    (B) squeeze
    (C) connect
    (D) support

15. In line 27, the word "concentrated" is closest in meaning to which of the following?
    (A) Allowed
    (B) Clustered
    (C) Exploded
    (D) Strengthened

16. Which of the following can be inferred about the theory of plate tectonics?
    (A) It is no longer of great interest to geologists.
    (B) It was first proposed in the 1960's.
    (C) It fails to explain why earthquakes occur.
    (D) It refutes the theory of the existence of a supercontinent.

17. The paragraph following the passage most probably discusses
    (A) why certain geological events happen where they do
    (B) how geological occurrences have changed over the years
    (C) the most unusual geological developments in the Earth's history
    (D) the latest innovations in geological measurement

Questions 18 - 27

In the United States in the early 1800' s, individual state governments had more effect on the economy than did the federal government. States chartered manufacturing, banking, mining, and transportation firms and participated in the construction of various internal improvements such as canals, turnpikes, and railroads. The states encouraged internal improvements in two distinct ways: first, by actually establishing state companies to build such improvements; second, by providing part of the capital for mixed public-private companies setting out to make a profit.

In the early nineteenth century, state governments also engaged in a surprisingly large amount of direct regulatory activity, including extensive licensing and inspection programs. Licensing targets reflected both similarities in and differences between the economy of the nineteenth century and that of today: in the nineteenth century, state regulation through licensing fell especially on peddlers, innkeepers, and retail merchants of various kinds. The perishable commodities of trade generally came under state inspection, and such important frontier staples as lumber and gunpowder were also subject to state control. Finally, state governments experimented with direct labor and business regulation designed to help the individual laborer or consumer, including setting maximum limits on hours of work and restrictions on price-fixing by businesses.

Although the states dominated economic activity during this period, the federal government was not inactive. Its goals were the facilitation of western settlement and the development of native industries. Toward these ends the federal government pursued several courses of action. It established a national bank to stabilize banking activities in the country and, in part, to provide a supply of relatively easy money to the frontier, where it was greatly needed for settlement. It permitted access to public western lands on increasingly easy terms, culminating in the Homestead Act of 1862, by which title to land could be claimed on the basis of residence alone. Finally, it set up a system of tariffs that was basically protectionist in effect, although maneuvering for position by various regional interests produced frequent changes in tariff rates throughout the nineteenth century.

18. What does the passage mainly discuss?
    (A) States' rights versus federal rights
    (B) The participation of state governments in railroad, canal, and turnpike construction
    (C) The roles of state and federal governments in the economy of the nineteenth century
    (D) Regulatory activity by state governments

19. The word "effect" in line 2 is closest in meaning to
    (A) value
    (B) argument
    (C) influence
    (D) restraint

20. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as areas that involved state governments in the nineteenth century EXCEPT
    (A) mining
    (B) banking
    (C) manufacturing
    (D) higher education

21. The word "distinct" in line 5 is closest in meaning to
    (A) separate
    (B) innovative
    (C) alarming
    (D) provocative

22. It can be inferred from the first paragraph that in the nineteenth century canals and railroads were
    (A) built with money that came from the federal government
    (B) much more expensive to build than they had been previously
    (C) built predominantly in the western part of the country
    (D) sometimes built in part by state companies

23. The regulatory activities of state governments included all of the following EXCEPT
    (A) licensing of retail merchants
    (B) inspecting materials used in turnpike maintenance
    (C) imposing limits on price fixing
    (D) control of lumber

24. The word "setting" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) discussing
    (B) analyzing
    (C) establishing
    (D) avoiding

25. The word "ends" in line 20 is closest in meaning to
    (A) benefits
    (B) decisions
    (C) services
    (D) goals

26. According to the passage, which of the following is true of the Homestead Act of 1862?
    (A) It made it increasingly possible for settlers to obtain land in the West.
    (B) It was a law first passed by state governments in the West.
    (C) It increased the money supply in the West.
    (D) It established tariffs in a number of regions.

27. Which of the following activities was the responsibility of the federal government in the nineteenth century?
    (A) Control of the manufacture of gunpowder
    (B) Determining the conditions under which individuals worked
    (C) Regulation of the supply of money
    (D) Inspection of new homes built on western lands

Questions 28 - 37

Life originated in the early seas less than a billion years after the Earth was formed. Yet another three billion years were to pass before the first plants and animals appeared on the continents. Life's transition from the sea to the land was perhaps as much of an evolutionary challenge as was the genesis of life.

What forms of life were able to make such a drastic change in lifestyle? The traditional view of the first terrestrial organisms is based on megafossils —relatively large specimens of essentially whole plants and animals. Vascular plants, related to modern seed plants and ferns, left the first comprehensive megafossil record. Because of this, it has been commonly assumed that the sequence of terrestrialization reflected the evolution of modern terrestrial ecosystems. In this view, primitive vascular plants first colonized the margins of continental waters, followed by animals that fed on the plants, and lastly by animals that preyed on the plant-eaters. Moreover, the megafossils suggest that terrestrial life appeared and diversified explosively near the boundary between the Silurian and the Devonian periods, a little more than 400 million years ago.

Recently, however, paleontologists have been taking a closer look at the sediments below this Silurian-Devonian geological boundary. It turns out that some fossils can be extracted from these sediments by putting the rocks in an acid bath. The technique has uncovered new evidence from sediments that were deposited near the shores of the ancient oceans —plant microfossils and microscopic pieces of small animals. In many instances the specimens are less than one-tenth of a millimeter in diameter. Although they were entombed in the rocks for hundreds of millions of years, many of the fossils consist of the organic remains of the organism.

These newly discovered fossils have not only revealed the existence of previously unknown organisms, but have also pushed back these dates for the invasion of land by multicellular organisms. Our views about the nature of the early plant and animal communities are now being revised. And with those revisions come new speculations about the first terrestrial life-forms.

28. The word "drastic" in line 5 is closest in meaning to
    (A) widespread
    (B) radical
    (C) progressive
    (D) risky

29. According to the theory that the author calls "the traditional view," what was the first form of life to appear on land?
    (A) Bacteria
    (B) Meat-eating animals
    (C) Plant-eating animals
    (D) Vascular plants

30. According to the passage, what happened about 400 million years ago?
    (A) Many terrestrial life-forms died out.
    (B) New life-forms on land developed at a rapid rate.
    (C) The megafossils were destroyed by floods.
    (D) Life began to develop in the ancient seas.

31. The word "extracted" in line 18 is closest in meaning to
    (A) located
    (B) preserved
    (C) removed
    (D) studied

32. What can be inferred from the passage about the fossils mentioned in lines 17-20 ?
    (A) They have not been helpful in understanding the evolution of terrestrial life.
    (B) They were found in approximately the same numbers as vascular plant fossils.
    (C) They are older than the megafossils.
    (D) They consist of modem life-forms.

33. The word "instances" in line 21 is closest in meaning to
    (A) methods
    (B) processes
    (C) cases
    (D) reasons

34. The word "they" in line 22 refers to
    (A) rocks
    (B) shores
    (C) oceans
    (D) specimens

35. The word "entombed" in line 22 is closest in meaning to
    (A) crushed
    (B) trapped
    (C) produced
    (D) excavated

36. Which of the following resulted from the discovery of microscopic fossils?
    (A) The time estimate for the first appearance of terrestrial life-forms was revised.
    (B) Old techniques for analyzing fossils were found to have new uses.
    (C) The origins of primitive sea life were explained.
    (D) Assumptions about the locations of ancient seas were changed.

37. With which of the following conclusions would the author probably agree?
    (A) The evolution of terrestrial life was as complicated as the origin of life itself.
    (B) The discovery of microfossils supports the traditional view of how terrestrial life evolved.
    (C) New species have appeared at the same rate over the course of the last 400 million years.
    (D) The technology used by paleontologists is too primitive to make accurate determinations about ages of fossils.

Questions 38 - 50

What we today call American folk art was, indeed, art of, by, and for ordinary, everyday "folks" who, with increasing prosperity and leisure, created a market for an of all kinds, and especially for portraits. Citizens of prosperous, essentially middle-class republics —whether ancient Romans, seventeenth-century Dutch burghers, or nineteenth-century Americans —have always shown a marked taste for portraiture. Starting in the late eighteenth century, the United States contained increasing numbers of such people, and of the artists who could meet their demands.

The earliest American folk art portraits come, not surprisingly, from New. England —especially Connecticut and Massachusetts —for this was a wealthy and populous region and the center of a strong craft tradition. Within a few decades after the signing of the Declaration of Independence in 1776, the population was pushing westward, and portrait painters could be found at work in western New York, Ohio, Kentucky, Illinois, and Missouri. Midway through its first century as a nation, the United States's population had increased roughly five times, and eleven new states had been added to the original thirteen. During these years the demand for portraits grew and grew, eventually to be satisfied by the camera. In 1839 the daguerreotype was introduced to America, ushering in the age of photography, and within a generation the new invention put an end to the popularity of painted portraits. Once again an original portrait became a luxury, commissioned by the wealthy and executed by the professional.

But in the heyday of portrait painting —from the late eighteenth century until the 1850's —anyone with a modicum of artistic ability could become a limner, as such a portraitist was called. Local craftspeople —sign, coach, and house painters —began to paint portraits as a profitable sideline; sometimes a talented man or woman who began by sketching family members gained a local reputation and was besieged with requests for portraits; artists found it worth their while to pack their paints, canvases, and brushes and to travel the countryside, often combining house decorating with portrait painting.

38. In lines 4-5 the author mentions seventeenth-century Dutch burghers as an example of a group that
    (A) consisted mainly of self-taught artists
    (B) appreciated portraits
    (C) influenced American folk art
    (D) had little time for the arts

39. The word "marked" in line 5 is closest in meaning to
    (A) pronounced
    (B) fortunate
    (C) understandable
    (D) mysterious

40. According to the passage, where were many of the first American folk art portraits painted?
    (A) In western New York
    (B) In Illinois and Missouri
    (C) In Connecticut and Massachusetts
    (D) In Ohio

41. The word "this" in line 9 refers to
    (A) a strong craft tradition
    (B) American folk art
    (C) New England
    (D) western New York

42. How much did the population of the United States increase in the first fifty years following independence?
    (A) It became three times larger.
    (B) It became five times larger.
    (C) It became eleven times larger.
    (D) It became thirteen times larger.

43. The phrase "ushering in" in line 17 is closest in meaning to
    (A) beginning
    (B) demanding
    (C) publishing
    (D) increasing

44. The relationship between the daguerreotype (line 16) and the painted portrait is similar to the relationship between the automobile and the
    (A) highway
    (B) driver
    (C) horse-drawn carriage
    (D) engine

45. According to the passage, which of the following contributed to a decline in the demand for painted portraits?
    (A) The lack of a strong craft tradition
    (B) The westward migration of many painters
    (C) The growing preference for landscape paintings
    (D) The invention of the camera

46. The word "executed" in line 19 is closest in meaning to
    (A) sold
    (B) requested
    (C) admired
    (D) created

47. The author implies that most limners (line 22)
    (A) received instruction from traveling teachers
    (B) were women
    (C) were from wealthy families
    (D) had no formal art training

48. The word "sketching" in line 25 is closest in meaning to
    (A) drawing
    (B) hiring
    (C) helping
    (D) discussing

49. Where in the passage does the author provide a definition?
    (A) Lines 3-6
    (B) Lines 8-10
    (C) Lines 13-15
    (D) Lines 21-23

50. The phrase "worth their while" in line 26 is closest in meaning to
    (A) essential
    (B) educational
    (C) profitable
    (D) pleasurable

Practice Test I – Answers

Number	Answers
1	D
2	C
3	A
4	D
5	A
6	D
7	C
8	B
9	A
10	D
11	B
12	B
13	D
14	D
15	B
16	B
17	A
18	C
19	C
20	D
21	A
22	D
23	B
24	C
25	D
26	A
27	C
28	B
29	D
30	B
31	C
32	C
33	C
34	D
35	B
36	A
37	A
38	B
39	A
40	C

41	C
42	B
43	A
44	C
45	D
46	D
47	D
48	A
49	D
50	C

Practice Test A - Structure

1. Dairy farming is _____ leading agricultural activity in the United States.

   (A) a
   (B) at
   (C) then
   (D) none

2. Although thunder and lightening are produced at the same time, light waves travel faster _____, so we see the lightening before we hear the thunder.

   (A) than sound waves do
   (B) than sound waves are
   (C) do sound waves
   (D) sound waves

3. Beef cattle _____ of all livestock for economic growth in certain geographic regions.

   (A) the most are important
   (B) are the most important
   (C) the most important are
   (D) that are the most important

4. The discovery of the halftone process in photography in 1881 made it _____ photographs in books and newspapers.

   (A) the possible reproduction
   (B) possible to reproduce
   (C) the possibility of reproducing
   (D) possibly reproduce

5. Flag Day is a legal holiday only in the state of Pennsylvania, _____ Betsy Ross sewed the first American flag.

   (A) which
   (B) where
   (C) that
   (D) has

6. _____ vastness of the Grand Canyon, it is difficult to capture it in a single photograph.

   (A) While the
   (B) The
   (C) For the
   (D) Because of the

7. Speciation, _____, results when an animal population becomes isolated by some factor, usually geographic.

   (A) form biological species
   (B) biological species are formed
   (C) which forming biological species
   (D) the formation of biological species

8. In its pure state antimony has no important uses, but _____ with other substances, it is extremely useful metal.

   (A) when combined physically or chemically
   (B) combined when physically or chemically
   (C) the physical and chemical combination
   (D) it is combined physically and chemically

9. The dawn redwood appears _____ some 100 million years ago in northern forests around the world.

(A) was flourished
(B) having to flourished
(C) to have flourished
(D) have flourished

10. Beginning in the Middle Ages, composers of Western music used a system of notating their compositions _____ be performed by musicians.

(A) will
(B) that
(C) and when to
(D) so they could

11. Civil Rights are the freedoms and rights _____ as a member of a community, state, or nation.

(A) may have a person
(B) may have a person who
(C) a person may have
(D) and a person may have

12. Richard Wright enjoyed success and influence _____ among Black American writers of his era.

(A) were unparalleled
(B) are unparalleled
(C) unparalleled
(D) the unparalleled

13. _____ of large mammals once dominated the North American Prairies: the American bison and the pronghorn antelope.

(A) There are two species
(B) With two species
(C) Two species are
(D) Two species

14. Franklin D. Roosevelt was _____ the great force of radio and the opportunity it provided for taking government policies directly to the people.

(A) as the first President he understood fully
(B) the first President that, to fully understand
(C) the first President fully understand
(D) the first President to understand fully

15. During the late fifteenth century, _____ of the native societies of America had professions in the fields of arts and crafts.

(A) only a few
(B) a few but
(C) few, but only
(D) a few only

Practice Test A – Written Expression

16. The firstly naval battle of the Revolutionary War was fought off the coast of Machias, Maine, in June 1775.

17. The public ceremonies of the Plains Indians are lesser elaborate than those of the Navajo in the Southwest.

18. In some species of fish, such the three-spined stickleback, the male, not the female, performs the task of caring for the young.

19. When she retires in September 1989, tennis champion Christine Evert was the most famous woman athlete in the United States.

20. The ancient Romans used vessels equipped with sails and banks of oars to transporting their armies.

21. Dinosaurs are traditionally classified as cold-blooded reptiles, but recent evidence based on eating habits, posture, and skeletal structural suggests some may have been warm-blooded.

22. Since the Great Depression of the 1930' s, social programs such as Social Security have been built into the economy to help avert severity business declines.

23. In the 1970' s consumer activities succeeded in promoting laws that set safety standards for automobiles, children' s clothing, and a widely range of household products.

24. Zoos in New Orleans, San Diego, Detroit, and the Bronx have become biological parks where animals roams free and people watch from across a moat.

25. In human beings, as in other mammals, hairs around the eyes are ears and in the nose prevent dust, insects, and other matter from entering these organs.

26. The Rocky Mountains were explored by fur traders during the early 1800' s in a decades preceding the United States Civil War.

27. The works of the author Herman Melville are literary creations of a high order, blending fact, fiction, adventure, and subtle symbolic.

28. Each chemical element is characterized to the number of protons that an atom of that element contains, called its atomic number.

29. The body structure that developed in birds over millions of years is well designed for flight, being both lightly in weight and remarkably strong.

30. From 1905 to 1920, American novelist Edith Wharton was at the height of her writing career, publishing of her three most famous novels.

31. In the early twentieth century, there was considerable interesting among sociologists in the fact that in the United States the family was losing its traditional roles.

32. Although pure diamond is colorless and transparent, when contaminated with other material it may appear in various color, ranging from pastels to opaque black.

33. Comparative anatomy is concerned to the structural differences among animal forms.

34. A seismograph records oscillation of the ground caused by seismic waves, vibrations that travel from its point of origin through the Earth or along its surface.

35. Electric lamps came into widespread use during the early 1900' s and have replaced other type of fat, gas, or oil lamps for almost every purpose.

36. Located in Canada, the Columbia Icefield covers area of 120 square miles and is 3,300 feet thick in some places.

37. Composer Richard Rodgers and lyricist Oscar Hammerstein II brought to the musical *Oklahoma!* extensive musical and theatrical backgrounds as well as familiar with the traditional forms of Operetta and musical comedy.

38. Because of its vast tracts of virtually uninhabited northern forest, Canada has one of the lowest population density in the world.

39. Rice, which it still forms the staple diet of much of the world' s population, grows best in hot, wet lands.

40. Government money appropriated for art in the 1930' s made possible hundreds of murals and statues still admiration in small towns all over the United States.

Practice Test A – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	A	Easy	93%
2	A	Easy	84%
3	B	Easy	93%
4	B	Easy	83%
5	B	Medium	78%
6	D	Easy	82%
7	D	Medium	76%
8	A	Medium	67%
9	C	Medium	65%
10	D	Medium	66%
11	C	Difficult	54%
12	C	Medium	62%
13	D	Difficult	41%
14	D	Difficult	45%
15	A	Easy	95%
16	A	Easy	90%
17	B	Easy	83%
18	B	Medium	81%
19	A	Easy	86%
20	D	Easy	86%
21	C	Medium	72%
22	D	Medium	75%
23	D	Medium	73%
24	C	Medium	73%
25	A	Medium	72%
26	C	Medium	72%
26	D	Medium	67%
28	B	Medium	58%
29	D	Medium	70%
30	C	Medium	68%
31	A	Medium	66%
32	D	Medium	60%
33	A	Medium	65%
34	C	Difficult	45%
35	B	Medium	63%
36	A	Difficult	43%
37	C	Difficult	37%
38	D	Difficult	30%
39	A	Difficult	50%
40	C	Medium	67%

Practice Test B – Structure

1. The ponderosa pine is _____ of the most of the timber used by forest-product firms in the Black Hills of South Dakota.

   (A) the source
   (B) as source
   (C) the source which
   (D) because the source

2. Computers that once took up entire rooms are now _____ to put on desktops and into wristwatches.

   (A) small enough
   (B) smaller than
   (C) so small
   (D) as small as

3. According to some educators, the goal of teaching is to help students learn what _____ to know to live a well-adjusted and successful life.

   (A) do they need
   (B) they need
   (C) they are needed
   (D) as they may need

4. The sapphire' s transparency to ultraviolet and infrared radiation makes _____ in optical instruments.

   (A) it is of use
   (B) it uses
   (C) it a useful
   (D) it useful

5. _____ initial recognition while still quite young.

   (A) Most famous scientists achieve
   (B) That most famous scientists achieved
   (C) Most famous scientists who achieved
   (D) For most famous scientists to achieve

6. Mango trees, _____ densely covered with glossy leaves and bear small fragrant flowers, grow rapidly and can attain heights of up to 90 feet.

   (A) whose
   (B) which are
   (C) are when
   (D) which

7. _____ the Canadian composer Barbara Pentland wrote four symphonies, three concertos, and an opera, among other works.

   (A) An artist who, prolific
   (B) Is a prolific artist
   (C) Prolific an artist
   (D) A prolific artist

8. The Chisos Mountains in Big Bend National park in Texas were created by volcanic eruptions that occurred _____.

   (A) the area in which dinosaurs roamed
   (B) when dinosaurs roamed the area
   (C) did dinosaurs roam the area
   (D) dinosaurs roaming the area

9. In bas-relief sculpture, a design projects very slightly from its background, _____ some coins.

(A) as on
(B) because
(C) the way that
(D) similarly

10. Alaska found the first years of its statehood costly because it had to take over the expense of services _____ previously by the federal government.

(A) to provide
(B) be provided
(C) providing
(D) provided

11. With age, the mineral content of human bones decreases, _____ them more fragile.

(A) make
(B) and to make
(C) thereby making
(D) which it makes

12. Not until Kentucky' s Mammoth Cave had been completely explored in 1972.

(A) when was its full extent realized
(B) that its full extent was realized
(C) was its full extent realized
(D) the realization of its full extent

13. The first explorer _____ California by land was Jedediah Strong Smith, a trapper who crossed the southwestern deserts of the United States in 1826.

(A) that he reached
(B) reached
(C) to reach
(D) reaching it

14. Written to be performed on a _____, Thornton Wilder' s play *Our Town* depicts life in a small New England community.

(A) stage scenery of bare
(B) bare of stage scenery
(C) scenery bare of stage
(D) stage bare of scenery

15. _____ many copper mines in the state of Arizona, a fact which contributes significantly to the state' s economy.

(A) They are
(B) There are
(C) Of the
(D) The

Practice Test B – Written Expression

16. Margaret Mead studied many different cultures and she was one of the first anthropologists to photograph hers subjects.

17. Talc, a soft mineral with a variety of uses, sold is in slabs or in powdered form.

18. During the 1870' s iron workers in Alabama proved they could produce iron by burning iron ore with coke, instead than with charcoal.

19. Geologists at the Hawaiian Volcano Observatory rely on a number of instruments to studying the volcanoes in Hawaii.

20. Underlying aerodynamics and all other branches of theoretical mechanics are the laws of motion who were developed in the seventeenth century.

21. Was opened in 1918, the Philips Collection in Washington, D.C., was the first museum in the United States devoted to modern art.

22. A mortgage enables a person to buy property without paying for it outright; thus more people are able to enjoy to own a house.

23. Alike ethnographers, ethnohistorians make systemic observations, but they also gather data from documentary and oral sources.

24. Basal body temperature refers to the most lowest temperature of a healthy individual during waking hours.

25. Research in the United States on acupuncture has focused on it use in pain relief and anesthesia.

26. The Moon’ s gravitational field cannot keep atmospheric gases from escape into space.

27. Although the pecan tree is chiefly value for its fruit, its wood is used extensively for flooring, furniture, boxes, and crates.

28. Born in Texas in 1890, Katherine Anne Porter produced three collection of short stories before publishing her well-known novel *Ship of Fools* in 1962.

29. Insulation from cold, protect against dust and sand, and camouflage are among the functions of hair for animals.

30. The notion that students are not sufficiently involved in their education is one reason for the recently surge of support for undergraduate research.

31. As secretary of transportation from 1975 to 1977, William Coleman worked to help the bankrupt railroads in the northeastern United States solved their financial problems.

32. Faults in the Earth’ s crust are most evidently in sedimentary formations, where they interrupt previously continuous layers.

33. Many flowering plants benefit of pollination by adult butterflies and moths.

34. A number of the American Indian languages spoken at the time of the European arrival in the New World in the late fifteen century have become extinct.

35. George Gershwin was an American composer whose concert works joined the sounds of jazz with them of traditional orchestration.

36. One of the problems of United States agriculture that has persisted during the 1920' s until the present day is the tendency of farm income to lag behind the costs of production.

37. Volcanism occurs on Earth in several geological setting, most of which are associated with the boundaries of the enormous, rigid plates that make up the lithosphere.

38. Early European settlers in North America used medicines they made from plants native to treat colds, pneumonia, and ague, an illness similar to malaria.

39. Some insects bear a remarkable resemblance to dead twigs, being long, slenderness, wingless, and brownish in color.

40. A food additive is any chemical that food manufacturers intentional add to their products.

Practice Test B – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	A	Easy	89%
2	A	Medium	80%
3	B	Easy	86%
4	D	Easy	89%
5	A	Medium	80%
6	B	Easy	81%
7	D	Easy	88%
8	B	Medium	71%
9	A	Medium	68%
10	D	Medium	63%
11	C	Difficult	43%
12	C	Difficult	34%
13	C	Difficult	36%
14	D	Difficult	32%
15	B	Easy	86%
16	D	Easy	94%
17	C	Easy	86%
18	D	Medium	80%
19	D	Easy	88%
20	D	Easy	87%
21	A	Easy	85%
22	D	Medium	80%
23	A	Easy	81%
24	B	Easy	84%
25	C	Medium	72%
26	C	Medium	76%
26	B	Medium	72%
28	B	Medium	71%
29	A	Medium	70%
30	C	Medium	62%
31	C	Medium	67%
32	A	Medium	65%
33	B	Medium	57%
34	D	Medium	59%
35	D	Medium	57%
36	B	Difficult	41%
37	B	Difficult	52%
38	C	Medium	57%
39	C	Difficult	37%
40	C	Difficult	36%

Practice Test C – Structure

1. After quartz, calcite is the _____ in the crust of the Earth.

   (A) mineral is most abundant
   (B) mineral that most abundant
   (C) most abundant mineral that
   (D) most abundant mineral

2. Regarded as the world' s foremost linguistic theorist, Noam Chomsky continues _____ new theories about language and language learning.

   (A) for creating
   (B) by creation
   (C) to create
   (D) create

3. _____ any area receives more water than the ground can absorb, the excess water flows to the lowest level, carrying loose mineral.

   (A) Being
   (B) Whenever
   (C) When might
   (D) Is

4. In 1935 seismologist Charles F. Richter devised _____ for rating the strength of earthquakes.

   (A) for the numerical scale
   (B) the scale is numerical
   (C) a numerical scale
   (D) a scale of numerical

5. After the Second World War the woman wage earner _____ a standard part of middle-class life in the United States.

   (A) who became
   (B) becoming that which
   (C) became
   (D) to become

6. Celluloid and plastics have largely replaced genuine ivory in the manufacture _____ buttons, billiard balls, and piano keys.

   (A) of such things as
   (B) as of such things
   (C) such things as of
   (D) things as of such

7. One of the tenets of New Criticism is that a critic need not tell readers _____ about a story.

   (A) which thinking
   (B) what to think
   (C) that thinking
   (D) to think what

8. The outer ear, _____ the fleshy pinna and the auditory canal, picks up and funnels sound waves toward the eardrum.

   (A) includes
   (B) which it includes
   (C) which includes
   (D) of which includes

9. The chair may be the oldest type of furniture, _____ its importance has varied from time to time and from country to country.

(A) but when
(B) until then
(C) in spite of
(D) although

10. When wood, natural gas, oil, or any other fuel burns, _____ with oxygen in the air to produce heat.

(A) combining substances in the fuel
(B) substances in the fuel that combine
(C) substances in the fuel combine
(D) a combination of substances in the fuel

11. Deserts are arid land areas where _____ through evaporation than is gained through precipitation.

(A) the loss of more water
(B) loses more water
(C) is more water lost
(D) more water is lost

12. When goshawk chicks are young, _____ parents share in the hunting duties and in guarding the nest.

(A) the both
(B) both
(C) both of
(D) and both

13. Not only _____ among the largest animals that ever lived, but they are also among the most intelligent.

(A) are whales
(B) whales
(C) some whales
(D) they are whales

14. Fish are the most ancient form of vertebrate life, and _____ all other vertebrates.

(A) from them evolved
(B) evolved them
(C) to evolve
(D) they are evolved

15. _____ 350 species of sharks, and although they are all carnivorous, only a few species will attack people.

(A) About
(B) Where about
(C) There are about
(D) About the

Practice Test C – Written Expression

16. The dandelion plant has a straight, smoothly, and hollow stem that contains a white, milky juice.

17. Of the much factors that contributed to the growth of international tourism in the 1950' s, one of the most important was the advent of jet travel in 1958.

18. The Canadian province of Alberta it is believed to have some of the richest oil deposits in the world.

19. Elizabeth Bishop' s poems are frequently long and carefully constructed, uses elaborate rhyme or half-rhymes.

20. California has more land under irrigation than any another state.

21. Thomas Moran' s magnificent, colorful paintings onto Wyoming landscapes captured the spirit of the western wilderness in the late nineteenth century.

22. Emily Dickinson, among the greatest women poets in the English language, died with all of hers poems unpublished, except for seven that appeared in publications of limited circulation.

23. Protecting Florida' s coral reefs in difficult because some of the corals are very fragile: even the touch of a diver' s hand can kill it.

24. Martin Luther King, Jr., is well known for organize the huge human rights march that took place in Washington in 1963.

25. A lightning flash produces electromagnetic waves that may travels along the Earth' s magnetic field for long distances.

26. One of the earliest plants domesticated in the Western Hemisphere, manioc was introduced to Europe by Spaniards returning from the New World.

27. Besides the age of nine and fifteen, almost all young people undergo a rapid series of physiological changes.

28. The frequency of meteors in the Earth' s atmosphere increases when the Earth passes through a swarm of particle generated by the breakup of a comet.

29. Ponds are noted for their rich and varied types of plant and animal life, all maintain in a delicate ecological balance.

30. In the 1920' s cinema became an important art form and one of the ten largest industry in the United States.

31. To improvise effectively, a musician must thorough understand the conventions of a given musical style.

32. During the Jurassic period plant life was abundance, providing herbivores in particular with a plentiful supply of food.

33. Some maple trees are raised for their sap, which has a high sugar content for yields sugar and syrup.

34. Long before boats became important in recreation, they were valuable to people for many essential tasks, included transportation and fishing.

35. Asteroids may be fragments of a planet shattered long ago or from material the nuclei of old comets.

36. The first Native Americans to occupy what is now the southwestern United States were the Big-Game Hunters, which appeared about 10,000 B.C.

37. Some hangers, buildings used to hold large aircraft, are very tall that rain occasionally falls from clouds that form along the ceilings.

38. Most sand dunes are always in motion as wind pushes sand upward one side of each dune, over the top, and down the other side.

39. Farms of maize, beans, and tobacco, the Wendat, Native American tribes that inhabited present-day Michigan, lived a sedentary life in densely populated villages.

40. Recently scientists have apply new tools of biochemistry and molecular biology to investigate the structure of human hair.

Practice Test A – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	D	Easy	91%
2	C	Easy	83%
3	B	Easy	83%
4	C	Easy	85%
5	C	Easy	84%
6	A	Medium	79%
7	B	Medium	70%
8	C	Medium	76%
9	D	Medium	67%
10	C	Medium	60%
11	D	Medium	59%
12	B	Medium	57%
13	A	Medium	56%
14	A	Difficult	29%
15	C	Easy	85%
16	B	Easy	90%
17	A	Easy	94%
18	B	Easy	82%
19	C	Medium	79%
20	D	Easy	89%
21	B	Medium	70%
22	C	Easy	81%
23	D	Medium	75%
24	B	Medium	76%
25	C	Medium	75%
26	B	Medium	70%
26	A	Medium	69%
28	C	Medium	65%
29	C	Medium	65%
30	D	Medium	65%
31	B	Medium	64%
32	A	Medium	64%
33	D	Medium	57%
34	C	Medium	59%
35	D	Difficult	45%
36	D	Difficult	30%
37	B	Difficult	34%
38	B	Difficult	39%
39	A	Difficult	35%
40	A	Medium	79%

Practice Test D – Structure

1. Some snakes lay eggs, but others _____ birth to live offspring.

   (A) give
   (B) giving
   (C) they give
   (D) to have given

2. Because it was so closely related to communication, _____ art form to develop.

   (A) drawing was probably the earliest
   (B) to draw early was probably
   (C) early drawing probably
   (D) the earliest draw

3. Halley's Comet had its first documented sighting in 240 B.C. in China and _____ it has been seen from the Earth 29 times.

   (A) after
   (B) because of
   (C) since then
   (D) that is

4. _____ that managers commit in problem solving is jumping to a conclusion about the cause of a given problem.

   (A) Major errors
   (B) Since the major error
   (C) The major error
   (D) Of the major errors

5. Algonkian-speaking Native Americans greeted the Pilgrims _____ settled on the eastern shores of what is now New England.

   (A) to whom
   (B) of which
   (C) who
   (D) which

6. The best known books of Ross Macdonald, _____ writer of detective novels, feature the character Lew Archer, a private detective.

   (A) is the
   (B) is an
   (C) they are by
   (D) the

7. The first building to employ steel skeleton construction, _____.

   (A) Chicago, Illinois, the home of the Home Insurance Company Building completed in 1885
   (B) the Home Insurance Company Building in Chicago, Illinois, was completed in 1885
   (C) because the Home Insurance Company Building in Chicago, Illinois, was completed in 1885
   (D) the Home Insurance Company Building in Chicago, Illinois, in 1885

8. During the course of its growth, a frog undergoes a true metamorphosis _____ with a fishlike larval stage.

   (A) begin
   (B) began
   (C) beginning
   (D) is begun

9. Mahalia Jackson, _____ combined powerful vitality with great dignity, was one of the best-known gospel singers in the United States.

(A) it was her singing
(B) which songs
(C) who sang
(D) whose singing

10. Precious metals, gems, and ivory have been used to make buttons, but most buttons are made of _____ wood, glass, or plastic.

(A) such materials that
(B) materials as such
(C) such materials as
(D) such materials

11. Outside the bright primary rainbow, _____ much fainter secondary rainbow may be visible.

(A) so
(B) a
(C) since
(D) still

12. Any critic, teacher, librarian, or poet who hopes to broaden poetry's audience faces the difficult challenge of persuading skeptical readers _____.

(A) that poetry is important today
(B) for poetry to be important today
(C) to be important poetry today
(D) poetry that is important today

13. Following the guidelines for speaking and voting established by the book *Robert's Rules of Order,* _____ during meetings.

(A) and avoid large decision-making organizations' procedural confusion
(B) large decision-making organizations avoid procedural confusion
(C) is procedural confusion avoided by large decision-making organizations
(D) are avoiding procedural contusion in large decision-making organizations

14. Indigo is a vat color, -—called because it does not dissolve in water.

(A) which it
(B) it is
(C) but
(D) so

15. Associated with the Denishawn company from 1916 until 1923, Martha Graham developed a powerful, ------- that was integral to the foundations of modern dance.

(A) expressively stylish
(B) a style expressive
(C) stylishly expressive
(D) expressive style

Practice Test D – Written Expression

16. According to most psychological studies, body language expresses a speaker's emotions and attitudes, and it also tends to affect the emotions and attitudes of the listen.

17. The dachshund is a hardy, alert dog with a well sense of smell.

18. Quasars, faint celestial objects resembling stars, are perhaps the most distant objects know.

19. The importance of environmental stimuli in the development of coordination between sensory input and motor response varies lo species to species.

20. A smile can be observed, described, and reliably identify; it can also be elicited and manipulated under experimental conditions.

21. A musical genius, John Cage is noted for his highly unconventional ideas, and he respected for his unusual compositions and performances.

22. Chocolate is prepared by a complexity process of cleaning, blending, and roasting cocoa beans, which must be ground and mixed with sugar.

23. Several million points on the human body registers either cold, heat, pain, or touch.

24. In the 1800's store owners sold everything from a needle to a plow, trust everyone, and never took inventory.

25. Although they reflect a strong social conscience, Arthur Miller's stage works are typical more concerned with individuals than with systems.

26. While highly prized for symbolizing good luck, the four-leaf clover is rarity found in nature.

27. An involuntary reflex, an yawn is almost impossible to slop once the mouth muscles begin the stretching action.

28. Elected to serve in the United States House of Representatives in 1968, Shirley Chisholm was known for advocacy the interests of the urban poor.

29. A mirage is an atmospheric optical illusion in what an observer sees a nonexistent body of water or an image of some object.

30. Turquoise, which found in microscopic crystals, is opaque with a waxy luster, varying in color from greenish gray to sky blue.

31. *Homo erectus* is the name commonly given into the primate species from which humans are believed to have evolved.

32. Today modern textile mills can manufacture as much fabrics in a few seconds as it once took workers weeks to produce by hand.

33. The Hopi, the westernmost tribe of Pueblo Indians, have traditionally lived large multilevel structures clustered in towns.

34. Exploration of the Solar System is continuing, and at the present rate of progress all the planets will have been contacted within the near 50 years.

35. Since their appearance on farms in the United Stales between 1913 and 1920, trucks have changed patterns of production and market of farm products.

36. Antique collecting became a significant pastime in the 1800's when old object began to be appreciated for their beauty as well as for their historical importance.

37. American painter Georgia 0' Keeffe is well known as her large paintings of flowers in which single blossoms are presented as if in close-up.

38. Despite television is the dominant entertainment medium for United States households, Garrison Keillor' s Saturday night radio show of folk songs and stories is heard by millions of people.

39. The work which the poet Emma Lazarus is best known is "The New Colossus," which is inscribed on the pedestal of the Statue of Liberty.

40. In the New England colonies, Chippendale designs were adapted to locally tastes, and beautiful furniture resulted.

Practice Test D – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	A	E	93%
2	A	E	84%
3	C	E	84%
4	C	E	80%
5	C	M	72%
6	D	M	69%
7	B	M	78%
8	C	M	61%
9	D	M	60%
10	C	E	80%
11	B	D	43%
12	A	M	58%
13	B	D	48%
14	D	D	40%
15	D	D	51%
16	D	E	90%
17	C	M	76%
18	D	E	83%
19	D	E	87%
20	B	M	79%
21	C	E	83%
22	A	E	81%
23	C	M	74%
24	C	M	76%
25	B	M	74%
26	D	M	70%
26	A	M	66%
28	C	M	67%
29	B	M	57%
30	A	M	57%
31	B	M	57%
32	A	D	42%
33	C	D	53%
34	D	D	56%
35	D	D	52%
36	C	D	54%
37	A	D	50%
38	A	D	45%
39	A	D	51%
40	B	M	55%

Practice Test E – Structure

1. Portland, Maine, is _____ the poet Henry Wadsworth Longfellow spent his early years.

   (A) where
   (B) it where
   (C) where is
   (D) which is where

2. As consumers' response to traditional advertising techniques declines, businesses are beginning _____ new methods of reaching customers.

   (A) the development that
   (B) it developing
   (C) develop
   (D) to develop

3. The knee is _____ most other joints in the body because it cannot twist without injury.

   (A) more likely to be damaged than
   (B) likely to be more than damaged
   (C) more than likely to be damaged
   (D) to be damaged more than likely

4. The quince is an attractive shrub or small tree _____ closely related to the apple and pear trees.

   (A) is
   (B) that is
   (C) that it is
   (D) is that which

5. Many gases, including the nitrogen and oxygen in air, _____ color or odor.

   (A) have no
   (B) which have no
   (C) not having
   (D) they do not have

6. The American Academy of Poets, _____ the 1930's, provides financial assistance to support working poets.

   (A) when it was founded
   (B) was founded
   (C) which was founded in
   (D) was founded in

7. During the Pleistocene glacial periods _____ portions of the Earth where plant and animal life flourished, making it possible for people to subsist.

   (A) the
   (B) it was
   (C) there were
   (D) have there been

8. The photographs of Carrie Mae Weems, in which she often makes her family members _____, are an affectionate and incisive representation of the African American experience.

   (A) are her subjects
   (B) her subjects
   (C) are subjects
   (D) which her subjects

9. Hubble's law states that the greater the distance between any two galaxies, _____ is their relative speed of separation.

(A) the greatest
(B) the greater
(C) greater than
(D) as great as

10. The onion is characterized by an edible bulb composed of leaves rich in sugar and a pungent oil, _____ the vegetable's strong taste.

(A) which the source of
(B) that the source is
(C) the source of
(D) of the source is

11. A regional writer with a gift for dialect, _____ her fiction with the eccentric, comic, but vital inhabitants of rural Mississippi.

(A) and Eudora Welty is peopling
(B) Eudora Welty peoples
(C) because Eudora Welty peoples
(D) Eudora Welty, to people

12. Relative humidity is the amount of water vapor the air contains at a certain temperature _____ with the amount it could hold at that temperature.

(A) to compare
(B) compared
(C) comparing
(D) compares

13. Scientists believe the first inhabitants of the Americas arrived by crossing the land bridge that connected Siberia and _____ more than I 0,000 years ago.

(A) this is Alaska now
(B) Alaska is now
(C) is now Alaska
(D) what is now Alaska

14. Fibers of hair and wool are not continuous and must normally be spun into thread _____ woven into textile fabrics.

(A) as are they
(B) when to be
(C) that they are
(D) If they are to be

15. Margaret Brent, because of her skill in managing estates, became _____ largest landholders in colonial Maryland.

(A) what the
(B) one of the
(C) who the
(D) the one that

Practice Test E – Written Expression

16. The Armory Show, held in New York in 1913, was a important exhibition of modern European art.

17. Ripe fruit is often stored in a place who contains much carbon dioxide so that the fruit will not decay too rapidly.

18. In 1852 Massachusetts passed a law requiring all children from four to eighteen years of old to attend school.

19. The main purpose of classifying animals is to show the most probable evolutionary relationship of the different species to each another.

20. Matthew C. Perry, a United States naval commander, gained fame not in war and through diplomacy

21. One of the most impressive collections of nineteenth-century European paintings in the United States can be found to the Philadelphia Museum of Art.

22. Three of every four migrating water birds in North America visits the Gulf of Mexico's winter wetlands.

23. Charleston, West Virginia, was named for Charles Clendenin who son George acquired land at the junction of tile Elk and Kanawha rivers in 1787.

24. Financier Andrew Mellon donated most of his magnificent art collection to the National Gallery of Art, where it is now locating.

25. Soil temperatures in Death Valley, California, near the Nevada border, have been known to reach 90 of degrees Celsius.

26. When the Sun, Moon, and Earth are alignment and the Moon crosses the Earth's orbital plane, a solar eclipse occurs.

27. Mary Cassatt's paintings of mothers and children are known for its fine linear rhythm, simple modelings, and harmonies of clear color.

28. Plants synthesize carbohydrates from water and carbon dioxide with the aid of energy is derived from sunlight.

29. The best American popular music balances a powerful emotions of youth with tenderness, grace, and wit.

30. In the nineteenth century, women used quilts to inscribe their responses to social, economic, and politics issues.

31. Fossils in 500-inillion-year-old rocks demonstrate that life forms in the Cambrian period were mostly marine animals capability of secreting calcium to form shells.

32. Rainbows in the shape of complete circles are sometimes seen from airplanes because they are not cutting off by the horizon.

33. Hot at the equator causes the air to expand, rise, and flow toward the poles.

34. Although research has been ongoing since 1930, the existence of ESP – perception and communication without the use of sight, hear, taste, touch, or smell – is still disputed.

35. As many as 50 percent of the income from motion pictures produced in the United States comes from marketing the films abroad.

36. Sleep is controlled by the brain and associated by characteristic breathing rhythms.

37. The walls around the city of Quebec, which was originally a fort military, still stand, making Quebec the only walled city in North America.

38. The manufacture of automobile was extremely expensive until assembly-line techniques made them cheaper to produce

39. The ballad is characterized by informal diction, by a narrative largely dependent on action and dialogue, by thematic intense, and by stress on repetition.

40. Eleanor Roosevelt set the standard against which the wives of all United States Presidents since have evaluated.

Practice Test E – Answers

Question Number	Answer	Level of Difficulty	Answered Correctly
1	A	Easy	91%
2	D	Easy	86%
3	A	Easy	82%
4	B	Easy	78%
5	A	Easy	81%
6	C	Medium	77%
7	C	Medium	68%
8	B	Medium	71%
9	B	Medium	60%
10	C	Medium	59%
11	B	Difficult	54%
12	B	Difficult	49%
13	D	Easy	42%
14	D	Easy	41%
15	B	Easy	98%
16	B	Easy	85%
17	C	Easy	94%
18	D	Easy	87%
19	D	Easy	84%
20	C	Easy	80%
21	D	Easy	81%
22	C	Easy	82%
23	B	Medium	75%
24	D	Medium	71%
25	D	Medium	78%
26	B	Medium	71%
27	B	Medium	68%
28	C	Medium	71%
29	B	Medium	63%
30	D	Medium	65%
31	D	Medium	61%
32	C	Medium	59%
33	A	Medium	58%
34	D	Difficult	55%
35	A	Difficult	51%
36	C	Difficult	45%
37	B	Difficult	45%
38	A	Difficult	40%
39	C	Difficult	26%
40	D	Medium	62%

Practice Test F – Structure

1. _____ is helping to break new ground in drug research.

   (A) Computers are being used more if
   (B) The increasing use of the computer
   (C) If an increase in the use of the computer
   (D) Computers are being used more

2. An elephant _____ vigorously when it is overheated.

   (A) flapping its ears
   (B) its ears flap
   (C) flaps its ears
   (D) ears flap it

3. Broadway musical comedy has been called _____ of the United States to modern theater.

   (A) the major contribution that
   (B) what is the major contribution
   (C) the major contribution
   (D) to the major contribution

4. _____ in 1968 as a nonprofit agency to finance the growth of noncommercial radio and television in the United States.

   (A) The Corporation for Public Broadcasting established
   (B) The Corporation for Public Broadcasting was established
   (C) When the Corporation for Public Broadcasting was established
   (D) Even though the Corporation for Public Broadcasting was established

5. Cold temperatures; short growing seasons, and heavy snows prevent _____ at high elevations.

   (A) grow trees
   (B) the growth of trees
   (C) trees are growing
   (D) and growth of trees

6. Usually, the more skilled an athlete _____ the more effortless the athlete's movements appear to be.

   (A) what is
   (B) that is
   (C) that it is
   (D) is

7. Trilobites, a group of spineless animals, flourished in the oceans for several hundred million years _____ some 200 million years ago.

   (A) until they became extinct
   (B) and their extinction
   (C) that were extinct
   (D) because their extinction

8. Recent engineering developments have made _____ to recycle plastic soda bottles into polyester fabric.

   (A) possible, and
   (B) it is possible
   (C) the possible
   (D) it possible

9. _____, bottle-nosed dolphins become talented performers at many aquariums.

(A) When to train
(B) Are training
(C) When trained
(D) To train them

10. The art of the 1970's was characterized by diversity and by the independence of artists _____ main affinities were more often sociopolitical than stylistic.

(A) whose
(B) that
(C) they have
(D) of which

11. Flower oils are _____ of the ingredients used in making perfume.

(A) among expensive
(B) among the most expensive
(C) being most expensive
(D) expensive

12. A quilt that looks ordinary _____ may become a work of abstract art when it is hung on a white wall.

(A) lying on a bed
(B) lies on a bed
(C) to be lying on a bed
(D) to lie on a bed

13. _____, the hummingbird gets its name from the sound that its wings make during flight.

(A) Has a brilliant color
(B) The brilliant color
(C) Which is brilliantly colored
(D) Brilliantly colored

14. Except for the Sun, all stars are too far from the Earth for their distances _____ in miles or kilometers.

(A) to be conveniently measured
(B) which conveniently measured
(C) to measure conveniently
(D) conveniently measured

15. Many technological innovations, such as the telephone, _____ the result of sudden bursts of inspiration in fact were preceded by many inconclusive efforts.

(A) whose appearance
(B) that appear to be
(C) and appear to be
(D) are appearing

16. Corporations, companies owned by much stockholders rather than by a single proprietor, began to play an important economic role in the late nineteenth century.

17. Diamonds have the unique ability to allow the passage of neither infrared and visible light.

18. Gilbert Newton Lewis, a chemist, helped to develop the modern electron theory of valence, a theory what explains the forces holding atoms together in molecules.

19. The first women governor in United States history was Nellie Tayloe Ross, who was elected governor of Wyoming in 1925.

20. Because of a high birthrate and considerable immigration, the United States population in the late nineteenth century increased tremendously into 31 million in 1860 to 76 million in 1900.

21. In laboratory experiments, an investigator often begins by work out different conditions for two groups of subjects.

22. In Florida, when the temperature drops below freezing, citrus growers keep young tree warm by constantly showering them with water.

23. The pitch of a musical instrument is defined as the relative highness or low of the sound it produces.

24. The delicious of chocolate depends not only on the quality of the cacao but also on a complex process of grinding, heating, and blending.

25. Scientists have found that occasional exposure to bright light can be help a person get used to working the night shift.

26. Rocks have forming, wearing away and re-forming ever since the Earth took shape.

27. For most of their history, especially since the 1860's, New York City has been undergoing major ethnic population changes.

28. The dramatic first-floor gallery of the New Britain Museum of American Art is devoted to Thomas Benton's series of five oversized mural.

29. Although color is a minor factor in soil composition, it is excellent characteristic by which to distinguish different soil layers.

30. Eagles are predatory birds that have large, heavy, hooked bills and strong, sharp claws called as "talons."

31. Cotton is one of the most popular fiber used to make clothes.

32. Turreted mansions decorated with elaborate wooden ornamentation became a mark of wealthy and elegance in the United States in the late nineteenth century.

33. Most of our ideas of what ancient people looked and dressed come from the works of Renaissance artists.

34. Plants require much less moist in cold weather than in warm weather.

35. All nations may have to make fundamental changes in their economic, political, and the technological institutions if they are to preserve the environment.

36. Massachusetts was first explored in the late sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries, and the first permanent settlement at Plymouth in 1620.

37. Sarah Vaughan had a voice like a perfect instrument, and it was an instrument that she knew how to use it with the utmost skill.

38. During early nineteenth century, the building of canals and railroads strengthened the state of Indiana's links with the eastern United States.

39. Maryland, even though a southern state, remained loyalty to the Union during the Civil War.

40. A monsoon is an enormous cycle of air set in motion by differences temperature over land and sea.

Practice Test F – Answers

Number	**Answer**
1	B
2	C
3	C
4	B
5	B
6	D
7	A
8	D
9	C
10	A
11	B
12	A
13	D
14	A
15	B
16	B
17	C
18	C
19	A
20	D
21	B
22	C
23	C
24	A
25	B
26	A
27	A
28	D
29	C
30	D
31	C
32	D
33	A
34	C
35	C
36	D
37	C
38	A
39	C
40	C

Practice Test G – Structure

1. In 1879, _____, Alice Freeman Palmer became head of the history department at Wellesley College.

   (A) twenty-four years
   (B) at the age of twenty-four
   (C) age twenty-four
   (D) of twenty-four years

2. United States spends more money on advertising _____ country in the world.

   (A) other
   (B) other than
   (C) than any other
   (D) while other

3. Penicillin, probably _____, came into widespread use after the Second World War.

   (A) an antibiotic of known
   (B) was known the antibiotic
   (C) the best-known antibiotic
   (D) known best antibiotic

4. Although Emily Dickinson is now a well-known American poet, only seven of her poems _____ while she was alive.

   (A) publishing
   (B) to publish
   (C) have published
   (D) were published

5. Thomas Jefferson served as president of the American Philosophical Society, an organization that encouraged of scientific and intellectual research.

   (A) ranging wide
   (B) a wide range
   (C) which ranged widely
   (D) a widely ranging

6. Part of the Great Plains, Kansas is famous for ____ fields of wheat.

   (A) its seemingly endless
   (B) it seems endless
   (C) it is seemingly endless
   (D) it is endless it seems

7. Skimming along the surface of the ocean or rising from its depths like delicate balloons, _____ to their aquatic habitat.

   (A) the perfect adaptation of jellyfish
   (B) jellyfish are perfectly adapted
   (C) jellyfish are adapted to perfectly
   (D) and the adaption is perfect for jellyfish

8. The sidereal day is the period _____ the Earth completes one rotation on its axis.

   (A) when does it
   (B) while it
   (C) during which
   (D) in that

9. _____ rainfall in the desert is low, it is one of the most important climatic factors in the formation of desert erosion features.

   (A) Although
   (B) Why
   (C) Despite
   (D) Due to

10. A strong swimmer, _____.

   (A) that fish and seal are eaten chiefly by the polar bear
   (B) the polar bear eats chiefly fish and seal
   (C) the polar bear eating chiefly fish and seal
   (D) eating fish and seal chiefly by the polar bear

11. Helicopters can rise or descend vertically, hover, and move forward, backward,____.

   (A) they move laterally
   (B) and are lateral
   (C) or lateral motion
   (D) or laterally

12. The Dallas Theater Center presents plays in two buildings,_____ was designed by the internationally renowned architect, Frank Lloyd Wright.

   (A) which
   (B) which one
   (C) that which
   (D) one of which

13. _____ stem from the everyday life of common people, the most popular themes are love, jealousy, revenge, disaster, and adventure.

   (A) Because folk ballads
   (B) There are folk ballads
   (C) With folk ballads
   (D) Folk ballads to

14. _____ around us gives us vital information about our environment.

   (A) The sounds are heard
   (B) That the hearing of sounds
   (C) Hearing the sounds
   (D) Whatever the sounds are heard

15. Located in Boston, _____ in the United States was founded in 1852.

   (A) the first public library was free
   (B) the first free public library
   (C) was the first free public library
   (D) where the first free public library was

16. A goose's neck is a little longer that than of a duck, and not so gracefully curved as a swan's.

17. The introduction of new species of plants into the Hawaiian islands offers an opportunity to study the responsively of a natural system to stress.

18. At 1939, television programs were being broadcast in the United States, and the World's Fair of that year featured demonstrations of this advance in technology.

19. Nathaniel Hawthorne often complained of how few material his life provided for his fiction.

20. The United States capital in Washington, D.C., developed slow, assuming its present gracious aspect, with wide avenues and many parks, only in the twentieth century.

21. Soapberry trees and shrubs thrive in tropical regions, and being ornamental plants in California and Florida.

22. Throughout her length career, Grace Paley has been known for her ability to capture the distinct rhythms of New York speech in her short stories.

23. Scientists usually character the disease leukemia as an overabundance of white blood cells in the bloodstream.

24. Energy research, medicinal, tourism, and copper and molybdenum mining are important to the economy of Butte, Montana.

25. The New Deal was President Franklin D. Roosevelt's program to pull the United States out the Great Depression in the 1930's.

26. Anyone rowing a boat in a strong wind knows it is much easy to go with the wind than against it.

27. From the monitoring of earthquake waves it is evidence that the Earth's outer core is liquid, whereas the inner core is solid.

28. Dictionaries frequently explain the origin of the defined word, state its part of speech, and indication its correct use.

29. The Caldecott Medal, awarded annual to the best illustrated children's book, is one award that identifies excellent books.

30. In the spring the woodcock builds a simple nest of leaves and grass in a dry, quiet spots and lays four multicolored eggs.

31. For centuries the aromatic spices of the Far East has been in demand by the people of the East and West.

32. Linseed oil is used as a drying oil in paints and varnishes and as making linoleum, oilcloth, and certain inks.

33. Phoenix, Arizona, stands where the Hohokam Indians built a canal system and carried on irrigated farming before long the time of Columbus.

34. Knowledge of the rate at which a ship is traveling through the water is important if the navigator need to estimate the time of arrival.

35. The wood of the tulip tree, sometimes referred to as American whitewood, is one of the most valuable timber product in the United States.

36. The foot is used primary for locomotion, but some primates, notably the apes, also use their feet for grasping and picking up objects.

37. Although best known for her prose works, Maya Angelou was also published several collections of poetry.

38. Founded by the Spanish as Yerba Buena in 1835, what is now San Francisco was taken over by the United States in 1846 and later renamed it.

39. Human hair grows at rate of about one-half to one inch a month.

40. Composed of heavy-textured clay soil, adobe has great elasticity when moist, but when dry is able of holding its shape.

Practice Test G- Answers

Number	Answers
1	B
2	C
3	C
4	D
5	B
6	A
7	B
8	C
9	A
10	B
11	D
12	D
13	A
14	C
15	B
16	B
17	C
18	A
19	B
20	A
21	C
22	A
23	A
24	A
25	D
26	C
27	B
28	D
29	A
30	D
31	C
32	C
33	D
34	D
35	D
36	A
37	C
38	D
39	A
40	D

Practice Test H – Structure

1. A microscope can reveal vastly _____ detail than is visible to the naked eye.

   (A) than
   (B) than more
   (C) more than
   (D) more

2. Narcissus bulbs _____ at least three inches apart and covered with about four inches of well-drained soil.

   (A) should be planted
   (B) to plant
   (C) must planting
   (D) should plant

3. Industrialization has been responsible for _____ most radical of the environmental changes caused by humans.

   (A) a
   (B) the
   (C) some of which
   (D) which are the

4. In many areas the slope and topography of the land _____ excess rainfall to run off into a natural outlet.

   (A) neither permit
   (B) without permitting
   (C) nor permitting
   (D) do not permit

5. Color and light, taken together, _____ the aesthetic impact of the interior of a building.

   (A) very powerfully influence
   (B) very influence powerfully
   (C) powerfully very influence
   (D) influence powerfully very

6. _____ that Rachel Carson's 1962 book *Silent Spring* was one of the chief sources of inspiration for the development of nontoxic pesticides.

   (A) There is likely
   (B) Likely to be
   (C) It is likely
   (D) Likely

7. Total color blindness, _____, is the result of a defect in the retina.

   (A) a rare condition that
   (B) a rare condition
   (C) that a rare condition
   (D) is a rare condition

8. _____ no conclusive evidence exists, many experts believe that the wheel was invented only once and then diffused to the rest of the world.

   (A) Even
   (B) But
   (C) Although
   (D) So

9. Wherever there is plenty of rain during the growing season, life is _____ in various forms.

   (A) abundant
   (B) the abundance
   (C) an abundant
   (D) it abundant

10. Most of _____ archaeologists know about prehistoric cultures is based on studies of material remains.

    (A) these
    (B) what
    (C) which
    (D) their

11. In her time, Isadora Duncan was _____ today a liberated woman.

    (A) calling what we would
    (B) who would be calling
    (C) what we would call
    (D) she would call it

12. _____ around stones that are sun warmed, even the smallest of stones creates tiny currents of warm air.

    (A) The cool air
    (B) If the air is cool
    (C) That the air cools
    (D) The cooler the air

13. According to some critics, the novels of William Burroughs demonstrate the major hazard of absurd literature, _____ tendency toward overembellishment and incoherence.

    (A) notwithstanding
    (B) besides
    (C) is a
    (D) its

14. Despite its wide range of styles and instrumentation, country music has certain common features _____ its own special character.

    (A) give it that
    (B) that give it
    (C) give that
    (D) that gives it to

15. Coinciding with the development of jazz in New Orleans in the 1920's _____ in blues music.

    (A) was one of the greatest periods
    (B) one of the greatest periods
    (C) was of the greatest periods
    (D) the greatest periods

16. *Gone With the Wind*, the epic novel about life in the South during the Civil War period, took ten years write.

17. None two butterflies have exactly the same design on their wings.

18. To save the California condor from extinction, a group of federal, local, and privately organizations initiated a rescue program.

19. A coral reef, a intricate aquatic community of plants and animals, is found only in warm, shallow, sunlit seas.

20. Carnegie Hall was the first building in New Y ark designed special for orchestral music.

21. Since it lives in the desert, the collared lizard depends from insects for water as well as for food.

22. The Texas Panhandle region, in the northwestern part of the state, produces more wheat, cotton, and grain sorghum than any of other area of Texas.

23. Light rays what enter the eye must be focused onto a point on the retina In order for a clear visual image to form.

24. The orangutan's hands and feet are designed for holding and grasping branches, and its powerful immensely arms enable it to climb and swing in trees without difficulty.

25. The extraordinary beautiful of orchids makes them the basis of a multimillion dollar floral industry.

26. The Vermont Elementary Science Project, according to its founders, are designed to challenge some of the most widely held beliefs about teaching.

27. The number 8½ is an example of a "mixed number" because it is composing of an integer and a fraction.

28. If it is kept dry, a seed can still sprout up to forty years after their formation.

29. In *The Sociology of Science,* now considered a classic, Robert Merton discusses cultural, economy, and social forces that contributed to the development of modem science.

30. Bacteria lived in the soil play a vital role in recycling the carbon and nitrogen needed by plants.

31. Some snakes have hollow teeth are called fangs that they use to poison their victims.

32. Stars derive their energy from thermonuclear reactions that take place in their heat interiors.

33. Carrie Chapman Catt organized the League of Women Voters after successfully campaign for the constitutional amendment that gave women the right to vote.

34. Any group that conducting its meetings using parliamentary rules will encounter situations where prescribed procedures cannot be applied.

35. The strongly patriotic character of Charles Sangster's poetry is credited about greatly furthering the cause of confederation in Canada.

36. Jessamyn West's first and most famous novel, *The Friendly Persuasion,* describes the life of a Quaker farmed family in the mid-1800's.

37. One inventor that Thomas Edison can take credit for is the light bulb.

38. Electric motors range in size from the tiny mechanisms that operate sewing machine to the great engines in heavy locomotives.

39. The nitrogen makes up over 78 percent of the Earth's atmosphere, the gaseous mass surrounding the planet.

40. The Mississippi, the longest river in the United States, begins as small, clear stream in northwestern Minnesota.

Practice Test H – Answers

Numbers	Answers
1	D
2	A
3	B
4	D
5	A
6	C
7	B
8	C
9	A
10	B
11	C
12	B
13	D
14	B
15	A
16	D
17	A
18	C
19	A
20	C
21	C
22	D
23	A
24	C
25	A
26	B
27	B
28	D
29	B
30	A
31	B
32	D
33	C
34	B
35	C
36	D
37	A
38	C
39	A
40	B

Practice Test I - Structure

1. Clinical psychologist Dr. Carl Rogers found that 80 _____ percent verbal communication involved five types of responses: evaluative, interpretive, supportive, probing, and understanding.

   (A) all
   (B) is the
   (C) with
   (D) of all

2. The early feminist leader Susan B. Anthony became increasingly aware through her work in the temperance movement _____ the same rights as men.

   (A) women were not granted that
   (B) that women were not granted
   (C) not granted women that were
   (D) that were not granted women

3. DNA, _____, is found in the cell nucleus in the form of very long and thin molecules consisting of two spiral strands.

   (A) inherits material
   (B) is inheritance material
   (C) material is inherited
   (D) the material of inheritance

4. _____ plants, which manufacture their own food, animals obtain nourishment by acquiring and ingesting their food.

   (A) Unlike
   (B) Different
   (C) Whereas
   (D) As much

5. The Hawaiian alphabet, introduced by missionaries in the 1820's, _____ and only seven consonants.

   (A) the five vowels consist of
   (B) consisting of five vowels
   (C) that consists of five vowels
   (D) consists of five vowels

6. Working like a telescope, _____ the size of objects at great distances.

   (A) which magnifies a telephoto lens
   (B) a telephoto lens magnifies
   (C) a telephoto lens which magnifies
   (D) and magnifying a telephoto lens

7. Volcanoes are divided into three main groups, based on their shape and the type of material they_____.

   (A) are made
   (B) made of
   (C) are made of
   (D) made for

8. _____ to inanimate objects, such as machines, is a form of animism.

   (A) When attributing emotion
   (B) Attributing emotion
   (C) Emotion is attributed
   (D) If emotion is attributed

9. _____, dolphins have no sense of smell.

(A) As known as far
(B) Known thus far as
(C) It is known as far
(D) As far as is known

10. The growth of psychobiology owes _____ to major conceptual advances in the way people think about the brain.

(A) much
(B) as much as
(C) much which
(D) there is so much

11. In 1938 Pearl S. Buck became the first American woman _____ the Nobel Prize for Literature.

(A) receive
(B) received
(C) to receive
(D) she received

12. Now considered an art form, quilt making originated as a means of fashioning bed covers from bits of fabric that otherwise _____.

(A) not use
(B) were no use
(C) had no use
(D) it was not used

13. The early years of the United States government were characterized by a debate concerning _____ or individual states should have more power.

(A) whether the federal government
(B) either the federal government
(C) that the federal government
(D) the federal government

14. Beneath the streets of a modem city _____ of walls, columns, cables, pipes, and tunnels required to satisfy the needs of its inhabitants.

(A) where exists the network
(B) the existing network
(C) the network's existence
(D) exists the network

15. The province of Newfoundland has _____ than any other region of North America in which the first language is English.

(A) its longer history
(B) a longer history
(C) the longer the history
(D) the history is longer

16. The antique collector must be able to distinguish real antiques from later imitations, which can be either reproductions nor fakes.

17. Paint must be stirred and sometimes dilution before it is applied.

18. A great aviation pioneer, Amelia Earhart was already famous when she sets out on her ill-fated attempt to circle the globe in 1937.

19. Although apples do not grow during the cold season, apple trees must have a such season in order to flourish.

20. Two unique features of the Arctic they are lack of precipitation and permanently frozen ground.

21. Faced with petroleum shortages in the 1970's, scientists and engineers in the United States stepped up its efforts to develop more efficient heating systems and better insulation.

22. Rabbits have large front tooth, short tails, and hind legs and feet adapted for running and jumping.

23. Dentistry is a branch of medicine that has developed very dramatic in the last twenty years.

24. The ease of solving a jigsaw puzzle depends the number of pieces, their shapes and shadings, and the design of the picture.

25. Plants range in size to tiny, single-celled, blue-green algae, invisible to the naked eye, to giant sequoias, the largest living plants.

26. During the 1940's science and engineering had an impact on the way music reach its audience and even influenced the way in which it was composed.

27. By 1860 the railroads of the United States had 3,000 miles of track, three-quarters of which it was east of the Mississippi River and north of the Ohio River.

28. Ballads were early types of poetry and may have been among a first kinds of music.

29. The thin outer layer of the skin is called the epidermis, while the layer inner, which is slightly thicker, is called the dermis.

30. With the incorporation of jazz history into current academic curricula, leading jazz musicians are now founding on the faculties of several universities.

31. Humus, a substance found in soil, is soft and spongy and enables plant roots to send out tiny hairs through that they absorb water and food.

32. Although flies live longest in cool temperatures, it breed prolifically when temperatures are warm, food is abundant, and humidity is moderate.

33. Alaska's vast areas of untamed wilderness attracts many people who enjoy the outdoors.

34. The giant panda closely resembles the bear, but account of certain anatomical features it is placed in the raccoon family.

35. The ode was original a ceremonial poem written to celebrate public occasions or exalted subjects.

36. Even as he wrote copiously on such diverse topic as education, politics, and religion, Lewis Mumford remained active in city and regional planning.

37. Oscillation is a electronic function that changes direct current to the signal of desired frequency.

38. Papier-mâché figures by Stephen Hensen, which they cheerfully depicted life in the Information Age, were the focus of an exhibit at the Museum of American History.

39. Pharmacist fill drug prescriptions, keeping records of the drugs their patients are taking to make sure that harmful combinations are not prescribed.

40. Great technical advances in aerial and satellite photography have been made since end of the Second World War.

Practice Test I – Answers

Number	Answers
1	D
2	B
3	D
4	A
5	D
6	B
7	C
8	B
9	D
10	A
11	C
12	C
13	A
14	D
15	B
16	D
17	C
18	C
19	C
20	B
21	B
22	B
23	D
24	B
25	B
26	B
27	D
28	C
29	D
30	D
31	D
32	B
33	C
34	C
35	A
36	B
37	A
38	A
39	A
40	D